SATURDAY, JULY 4, 2026

The Indian EXPRESS

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 24 PAGES

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राजस्थान सरकार

श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी
माननीय प्रधानमंत्री

विकास के पथ पर
गतिमान राजस्थान

माननीय प्रधानमंत्री
श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी
के कर कमलों द्वारा

श्री भजनलाल शर्मा
माननीय मुख्यमंत्री

1 लाख 5 हजार करोड़ रुपए के कार्यों का शिलान्यास/ उद्घाटन/ लोकार्पण

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सूचना एवं जनसम्पर्क विभाग, राजस्थान

DD NEWS डीडी न्यूज़ पर कार्यक्रम का सीधा प्रसारण देखें

राजस्थान संवाद

THE INDIAN EXPRESS

The World

SATURDAY, JULY 4, 2026

NATO leaders to gather in Ankara, aim to ease tensions with Trump

Andrew Gray
Brussels, July 3

NATO LEADERS gather next week in Ankara, where Europeans aim to set aside strife with US President Donald Trump over Iran and Greenland and show they are stepping up to defend the continent as Washington cuts back on its commitments to the alliance.

NATO Secretary General Mark Rutte says the gathering next Tuesday and Wednesday will show Europeans are honouring pledges to hike defence spending to deter Russia from any attack, with arms deals worth tens of billions of dollars to be signed.

Leaders are also expected to vow to keep funding weapons for Ukraine's fight against Russia's invasion. Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy will attend a dinner hosted by Turkish President Tayyip Erdogan, who will also hold bilateral talks with Trump.

European officials say they hope Trump's strong relationships with Erdogan and Rutte will ensure a smooth summit but cannot be sure, given lingering transatlantic bitterness over the Iran war and the US president's frequent criticism of NATO.

In a Truth Social post on Thursday, Trump complained the United States was spending money to protect NATO members "without getting any benefit from so doing".

Rutte and other NATO leaders have insisted the alliance contributes to the United States' own security and that Europeans are heeding Trump's longstanding calls to spend more on their own defence. REUTERS

UK's health service to reward people for 20-minute daily walks

Press Trust of India
London, July 3

THE UK's state-funded National Health Service (NHS) on Friday unveiled plans for a nationwide walking challenge that will reward people for completing the equivalent of a marathon over a month.

The "Movement 26.2" challenge, due to launch by January 2027, aims to sign up around 100,000 participants.

It aims to encourage participants to log their walks of a minimum of 20 minutes a day. Over a month, that would roughly add up to 26.2 miles (around 42 km) - the distance of a marathon.

"What I love about Movement 26.2 is its simplicity," said British PM Keir Starmer. "Walking 20 minutes a day, which adds up to a marathon over a month, is exactly that a simple, achievable challenge that has meaningful benefits," he said.

Participants will be able to log their walks online or through their phones and smartwatches. Those who complete the challenge will be eligible for rewards such as discount vouchers and other incentives.

SUPREME LEADER WILL BE BURIED IN MASHHAD ON JULY 9

Ali Khamenei lies in state as Iran starts week of funeral ceremonies

Parisa Hafezi & Jana Choukeir
Dubai, July 3

THE BODY of Ayatollah Ali Khamenei lay in state in a vast hall in Tehran on Friday as clerics, officials, foreign dignitaries and other mourners paid their respects to Iran's late Supreme Leader, slain by US and Israeli bombs.

Iran is staging a week of mass funeral processions for Khamenei, whose 37-year reign was brought to an end in February by the first airstrike of the war, in a show of public devotion to the Islamic Republic's theocratic state and revolutionary zeal.

Khamenei's body was expected to be taken to Qom, Najaf and Kerbala, the great Shi'ite centres of Iran and Iraq, before being laid to rest on Thursday in Mashhad, home to the country's holiest pilgrim shrine.

His coffin was unveiled late on Thursday to a throng of sobbing supporters, swaying and beating their heads in time to a sung lament as flowers were thrown from the bier into the crowd. On Friday the coffin — and those of family members killed with him — was laid in state in the great prayer hall built to honour his predecessor, Ayatollah Ruhollah Khomeini.

(From left) Member of the Assembly of Experts Mohsen Qomi, Adviser to Supreme Leader Mohsen Rezaei, Foreign Minister Abbas Araqchi, Chief Justice of Iran Gholam-Hossein Mohseni Ejei, Iran's parliament speaker Mohammad Baqer Qalibaf and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian attend the farewell ceremony for Iran's late Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei in Tehran on Friday. REUTERS

The funeral is taking place at a critical moment for Iran, where the clerical rulers backed by the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps are riding high from surviving what they saw as an existential war against their greatest and most powerful foes.

But nearly five decades after the 1979 revolution, and for all the official proclamations of national unity in the run-up to Khamenei's funeral, the Islamic Republic has rarely been so internally fractured.

Support for the clerical leadership is paper thin, analysts say, and the new Supreme Leader, Khamenei's son Mojtaba Khamenei, has not been seen in any new image since being wounded in the strike that killed his father.

Years of crippling sanctions have paralysed the economy as accelerating bouts of mass nationwide protests have been put down by security forces with increasing force — culminating in the killing of thousands of demonstrators in January.

Those deep problems have been brushed aside this week, with the authorities mounting a display of state power and mass support, mobilising what they hope will be millions of mourners to take part in the funeral. Tehran streets were tightly controlled, with military and police vehicles lining the major roads and police and members of the black-shirted volunteer Basij paramilitary force patrolling on motorbikes. Iran warned the United States and Israel against any attacks during the funeral.

After the coffins arrived on Friday, borne high across the upraised hands of a waiting crowd, they were laid in the prayer hall on a white, stepped, dais before a high, intricately tiled, arched recess, flanked by national and black mourning flags. REUTERS

Putin shrugs off fuel shortage as Russian forces intensify attacks on Ukraine

Associated Press
Kyiv, July 3

DESPITE SEVERE fuel shortages across Russia, President Vladimir Putin appears unbothered by Ukraine's increasing attacks on his country's oil refineries. He has shrugged off the setback for one of the world's leading oil-producing nations as "not critical," dismissed ceasefire proposals and insisted the war will continue until his goals are met.

Putin has described the attacks on Russian energy as an effort by Ukraine to distract attention from its losses on the battlefield, although analysts say the advance of Russian forces has been stymied in recent months. The Russian leader appears to believe his government can keep the fuel crisis from eroding his authority and support for the war he launched more than four years ago.

The Russian military unleashed a massive 11-hour barrage on the Ukrainian capital overnight into Thursday morning that killed at least 30 people. It was one of the deadliest attacks on Kyiv since the start of Russia's full-scale invasion.

There have been more than 50 reported Ukrainian attacks on oil refineries and other energy facilities in Russia and occupied Crimea since March — a barrage Ukrainian leaders have said is intended to pressure Moscow to end the war.

At the very least, the attacks have brought the war home even more poignantly for millions of Russians, shattering Putin's narrative of the conflict as something that doesn't affect the lives of ordinary people in his country.

Municipal workers sweep the damaged site after Russia's missile attack in Kyiv on Friday. AP

An estimated one-third of Russia's refining capacity has been cut off, according to Chris Weafer, CEO of the consultancy Macro-Advisory. The attacks have inflicted lasting damage that will be costly to fix.

Despite significant air defenses protecting Russia's capital, a top refinery in Moscow has been hit twice. The second strike on June 18 set it ablaze, damaging key equipment that will reportedly take until the end of the year to repair.

With gasoline production in Russia reduced by roughly 17% to 850,000 barrels a day, according to government statistics, rationing has been introduced in many regions, and motorists have had to wait in line for hours to refuel.

In an effort to ease fuel deficit, the government has allowed production of lower quality gasoline with higher sulfur content through the year's end.

Deaths surged 29% in France amid record June heat: Health agency

John Leicester
Paris, July 3

DEATHS SURGED by nearly a third in France during the hottest week of a record heat wave last month, the country's public health authority said Friday, reporting at least 2,000 more deaths than in the previous week when temperatures were already climbing and filling emergency wards with heat victims.

The new and still incomplete figures from Public Health France doubled its first preliminary estimate of at least 1,000 additional deaths that it gave last Sunday. That earlier estimate covered just three of the hottest days of extreme, deadly heat.

In Paris, funeral service directors have said they've struggled to find places to store bodies before burial or cremation, with some mortuaries saying they were full and having to turn bodies away.

Parisians bathe in the Canal Saint-Martin. FILE/AP

The updated tally of deaths from Public Health France spans the week of June 22 to June 28, during which France saw its hottest-ever days and records shattered for peak daytime and nighttime temperatures in many cities and towns across the country. The heat also broke temperature records in many other parts of Europe.

Public Health France said it has counted 8,973 deaths so far for that week, cautioning that the number is still only partial. It said the preliminary total was 29% more than the 6,948 deaths registered for the previous week of June 15 to June 21, when the heat wave started.

The difference between the two sets of figures — a total so far of 2,025 — is therefore considered to be additional deaths from one week to the next, from all causes and covering all age groups, it said. AP

Rescue op launched to save NASA telescope that's falling back to Earth

Marcia Dunn
Florida, July 3

A THREE-ARMED spacecraft rocketed into orbit Friday to rescue a NASA telescope that's in danger of crashing back to Earth. Northrop Grumman launched Katalyst Space Technologies' Link spacecraft from the Marshall Islands in the Pacific. The Pegasus rocket blasted off from the belly of a modified airplane, putting Link on course to reach and capture NASA's Swift Observatory in about a month.

Launched in 2004, Swift is sinking faster than ever because of recent solar storms. NASA is paying $30 million for Katalyst to capture the telescope and boost its orbit so it can continue tracking some of the biggest explosions in the universe, like gamma ray bursts and exploding stars.

If all goes well, Swift could be back scanning the cosmos by September. Observations are currently on hold to preserve the telescope's orbit as long as possible.

NASA's Hubble Space Telescope could be a candidate for a similar salvage operation in a few years. It's also slipping in altitude because of increased atmospheric drag caused by the sun's outbursts.

The 1.6-tonne (1.4-metric tonne) Swift currently is circling 224 miles (360 kilometers) above Earth. Katalyst aims to raise the telescope's altitude by 150 miles (240 kilometers), back to where it all began. Link's thrusters will fire to boost Swift slowly, so there's no heavy jostling.

Katalyst threw the mission together in just nine months. NASA insisted on a rush job because the telescope will be too low to recover by the fall. Without a boost, it's predicted to plunge to its demise in October. AP

• BRIEFLY

MOLDOVA

PM steps down, triggers his government's resignation

Moldova's Prime Minister Alexandru Munteanu. AP

MOLDOVA'S PRIME Minister Alexandru Munteanu announced Friday that he's stepping down, in a surprise move that automatically triggers the government's resignation. Munteanu did not give a clear reason for his departure, which comes less than a year after he was sworn in to lead the European Union candidate country's pro-Western government following a tense election widely viewed as a choice between East and West. "Today I end my term as prime minister," Munteanu wrote in a statement posted on social media. "The moment I understand that I can no longer exercise my mandate in accordance with my principles and beliefs, I choose to walk away." AP

ARMENIA

Voting rights for citizens living abroad restricted

ARMENIA'S PARLIAMENT passed a law on Friday that raises the bar for citizens based abroad to be able to come home and vote, following reported efforts by Moscow to use Armenians living in Russia to influence an election last month. A landlocked former Soviet republic, Armenia has a population of roughly 3 million and a sizable diaspora abroad, including in Russia, which says more than 2 million work there. AP

SRI LANKA

Ex-commander of Navy held for 'corruption'

SRI LANKAN anti-graft agency on Friday arrested a former commander of the Navy over the irregular appointment of ex-president Mahinda Rajapaksa's son in the force. Wasantha Karannagoda, a former commander of the Sri Lanka Navy, was arrested by the Commission to Investigate Bribery or Corruption , according to a statement. Karannagoda is accused of enlisting Yoshitha Rajapaksa, the second son of the former president Rajapaksa. PTI

Rescue workers at the site where a passenger bus plunged from a highway into a rocky ravine in Dana Sar on Friday. AP

40 killed after bus falls into ravine in Pak's KPK

Press Trust of India
Peshawar, July 3

AT LEAST 40 people, including women and children, were killed when a bus they were travelling in fell into a ravine in northwest Pakistan's Khyber Pakhtunkhwa on Friday, officials said.

The Peshawar-bound bus departed from Quetta in Balochistan. The accident took place after it reached Dera Ismail Khan district in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, officials said.

Preliminary investigation suggests that the brakes of the bus failed, causing the driver to lose control while navigating a difficult bend on the mountainous terrain. The bus skid off the road and fell into the ravine.

However, an investigation has been initiated to further examine the cause, officials said.

"According to initial reports, 40 people have been killed and eight others injured in the accident," said Shahid Rind, who is Balochistan Chief Minister Sarfraz Bugti's aide for media and political affairs.

"District administrations from both provinces, rescue and other relevant departments are providing assistance to the affected persons," he said.

According to the 1122 rescue team, there were 48 people on board when the incident happened. *The Dawn* newspaper reported that 36 people were in the bus when it departed from Quetta, and the others boarded it on the way.

Deputy Commissioner of Sherani district Wali Khan Kakar said identification of the deceased and those who are injured is underway.

Road accidents are common and often fatal in the mountainous regions of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa because of a combination of factors like treacherous terrain, extreme weather, frequent traffic violations, poor road conditions, poor vehicle conditions and untrained drivers.

• OFFICIALS SAY THEIR BIGGEST CONCERN IS THAT NEIL'S POPULARITY COULD LEAD TO ILL-ADVISED HUMAN-SEAL ENCOUNTERS THAT ARE DANGEROUS FOR BOTH SIDES

Australian officials ask fans to respect privacy of 1-tonne seal who respects nothing

Charlotte Graham-Mclay
Wellington, July 3

LIKE PLENTY of local boys before him, Neil has come home to the stretch of Australian coast where he was born. Unlike most of them, he trails fame, fans and property damage in his wake. He is also a 1,000 kg elephant seal.

In June, the bellowing and blubbery 5-year-old mammal hauled himself onto land for his twice-yearly tour of beachside towns in southern Tasmania state after months of feeding at sea. That's posing problems now that he weighs as much as a small car and has a social media following more than double Tasmania's human population.

His rampage through local infrastructure has claimed bent traffic bollards, a sign warning the public about seals and a fence that did not survive Neil's attempt to vault it. The rest of the time he lies placidly any place he likes, which is sometimes the middle of the road, bringing towns he visits to a standstill.

But officials say their biggest concern is that Neil's popularity could lead to ill-advised human-seal encounters that are dangerous for both sides.

Neil, the only male elephant seal to visit Tasmania in years, has commanded an enthralled TikTok following of 1.4 million in part because he acts like kind of a jerk. During this visit to shore, his 12th, his crimes have included picking fights with parked cars and smashing through barriers erected to keep him off roads. Those antics have prompted some online to hail Neil as a kind of anti-authoritarian hero. But experts say it's normal experimentation for a growing seal.

Juvenile male elephant seals need to practice for dominance battles in which adults rear up and crash their chests together as they compete for breeding opportunities, said Sophia Volzke, an elephant seal scientist based at the University of Tasmania in Hobart. With no other juveniles to practice with, Neil can only rehearse on Toyotas.

Neil, the seal, plays with a traffic cone in Tasmania. AP

Local officials fear that Neil is the latest wild animal whose social media stardom has outgrown what's good for him.

"Neil's fame is a bit of a double-edged sword," said Kris Carlyon from Tasmania's Department of Natural Resources and Environment, at a news conference in Hobart on Thursday in which he asked the seal's fans to give him privacy.

"We have had some pretty silly behaviour, instances with people carrying their small babies up close to him and simply trying to get that shot for Instagram," he said.

Officials have urged the public to refrain from identifying the town Neil is currently delighting or terrorizing, depending on who you speak to. They fear a disastrous encounter between the seal and an admirer could force rangers into a risky operation to move him elsewhere.

Carlyon also warned of worse. In a 2023 episode, a walrus known as Freya who drew huge crowds in Norway was euthanized after officials cited a growing risk to human safety.

"There is a risk here of essentially loving Neil to death," Carlyon said. It's usual for seals to return biannually to the place they were born to rest, fast and shed fur. Many species roam inland during visits to shore, sometimes leading them into beachside towns. What's unusual about Neil is that he's the only male elephant seal hauling ashore in Tasmania.

Sub-Antarctic islands south of Tasmania are home to breeding populations of elephant seals and Neil's mother would have arrived from one of them to give birth, Volzke said. Females have been spotted ashore in Tasmania before, but topping out at the size Neil reached when he was a year or two old, they don't cause the same kind of chaos, she added.

"Humans got rid of those animals and now maybe they are coming back and repopulating areas that they were previously seen in," she said. "We do need to find a way to coexist."

That could prove tricky for Neil, and for the rangers, police officers and security guards who follow in his wake. If he survives to adulthood, Neil could measure up to 5 meters in length and weigh triple what he does now. AP

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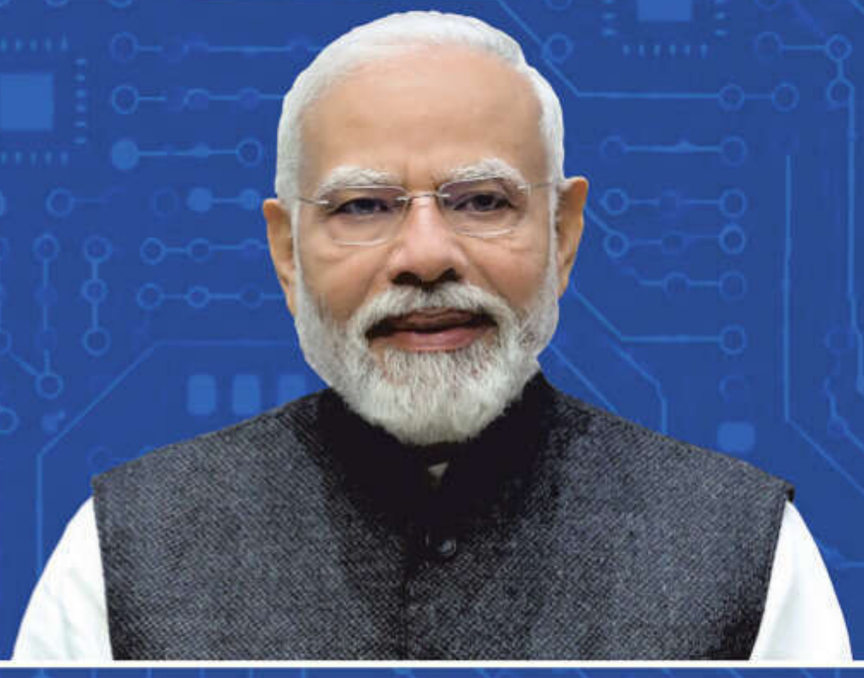

Building the Nation, Chip by Chip

Commencement of Commercial Production of CG SEMI OSAT Facility

by

Shri Narendra Modi

Hon'ble Prime Minister

In the august presence of

Shri Ashwini Vaishnaw
Hon'ble Union Minister for Railways, Information & Broadcasting, and Electronics & Information Technology

Shri Bhupendrabhai Patel
Hon'ble Chief Minister of Gujarat

Time: 4:00 PM I 4th July 2026 I CG Semi, Sanand, Gujarat

Welcome by
Vellayan Subbiah
Chairman, CG Power and Industrial Solutions

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THE INDIAN EXPRESS

Explained

SATURDAY, JULY 4, 2026

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to

explained@indianexpress.com

• WILDLIFE

Govt's plan to revive struggling tiger reserves

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, July 3

AN EVENT marking the 18th anniversary of tiger reintroductions at the Sariska Tiger Reserve in Alwar, Rajasthan, last month saw the Centre release two new assessments. The first was a road map to manage tigers going forward and the second reflected on the lessons learnt from 12 reintroduction initiatives in India.

It has been argued that beyond simply counting overall numbers, the focus should be on national parks and reserves with a low number of tigers. To aid the recovery of big cats, parks with poor habitats and prey availability have also been included. This, the Centre said, will also aid the dispersal of tigers from places which have reached peak carrying capacity towards newer habitats.

Numbers rise, but only in pockets

India's tiger population has risen steadily. From 1,411 in 2006, there are now 3,682 tigers in 2022 across 58 tiger reserves, spread across 85,000 sq km. The numbers, however, do not reveal the full story.

Of the 58, 10-12 reserves alone account for about 36% of the population. There are 12 tiger reserves with less than three tigers inside and of them, three — Kawal, Kamlang and Dampa — have zero tigers.

As the density of tigers increases, they disperse to buffer areas, territorial divisions and mixed-use land. This often puts them in conflict with humans while increasing their dependency on livestock on these fringes, besides elevating the risk of poaching, and mortality while crossing railways, roads and canals.

Parks with low tigers, however, may have intact forests but are also low on prey. Neither situation is ideal.

The unevenness between "source populations" (where habitat, prey and tiger numbers are high) and "sink populations" (where there are no breeding tigers or connectivity with healthier forest) poses a challenge for long-term conservation.

The Centre's latest assessment calls for consolidating "source populations" in 13 tiger reserves such as Corbett, Bandipur and Kaziranga. It has suggested the need for priority interventions in at least 25 reserves, including reintroductions where less than five tigers remain.

Need for 'recipient sites'

Tiger population growth has sustained at 6% annually. Uneven growth, however, means that regions with high density are facing the pressure of managing dispersing tigers outside forests, human-wildlife conflict and poaching pressures. This comes even as vast forests are bereft of tigers. This situation arises due to the fragmentation of forested areas, tigers being discouraged to move across long distances, poor prey in sink areas forcing tigers to vacate them and external pressure from human activities. A well-connected landscape of forests across tiger reserves, territorial forests, mixed-use areas is key for establishing a metapopulation, helping in genetic exchange and reducing extinction risk in the long-term.

The assessment notes that long-term recovery of tiger populations depends on the interplay of prey abundance, habitat quality and colonisation by tigers themselves.

A MIXED RECORD

- Sariska, which had previously lost all its tigers, was the first to undertake reintroduction in 2008. Panna in MP followed suit in 2009 — 10 more reserves have done so since then.
- The Centre acknowledged failure in Odisha's Satkosia owing to rejection by local communities, besides slow and lethargic progress in Rajasthan's Mukundara Hills.

Drishti IAS

IAS GS Foundation Course
Offline & Live Online Batches

Centre	हिंदी माध्यम	English Medium
Karol Bagh	10 जुलाई | सुबह 11:30 बजे	13 July | 8:00 AM
Noida	15 जुलाई | दोपहर 3:00 बजे	10 July | 6:00 PM
Indore	27 जुलाई | शाम 5:30 बजे	27 July | 8:00 AM
Lucknow	29 जून | शाम 6:00 बजे	29 June | 8:00 AM
Prayagraj	13 जुलाई | सुबह 11:15 बजे	9 July | 11:30 AM
Ranchi	10 जुलाई | सुबह 11:30 बजे	7 July | 5:30 PM
Patna	एडमिशन आरंभ	29 June | 5:30 PM
Jaipur	24 जून | सुबह 11:00 बजे	6 July | 8:00 AM

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• HEALTH

Antibiotics to creams: The perils of combination meds

Ingredients in fixed-dose combination drugs may not work better together. Worse, they can expose patients to risks and fuel antimicrobial resistance

EXPERT EXPLAINS
KAMINI WALIA
SENIOR SCIENTIST AT INDIAN COUNCIL OF MEDICAL RESEARCH

THE GOVERNMENT has banned 16 fixed-dose combination (FDC) drugs, including certain antibiotic combinations and a range of dermatological products containing aloe vera and other herbal ingredients, because their supposedly amplified benefits lack scientific justification.

FDCs contain two or more active ingredients in a single formulation and are commonly prescribed for conditions ranging from infections to pain and skin ailments. While some combinations are evidence-based and improve patient outcomes, others are considered "irrational" because there is little or no scientific evidence that the ingredients work better together than when used separately. "Public health experts have long warned that irrational combinations can expose patients to unnecessary drugs, increase costs and, in the case of antibiotics, contribute to antimicrobial resistance. The last is a growing public health problem because bacteria, viruses, fungi, and parasites no longer respond to the medicines designed to kill them," **Dr Kamini Walia**, senior scientist at the Indian Council of Medical Research, tells **Rinku Ghosh**.

What is an 'irrational' FDC?

An FDC is considered irrational when the ingredients do not have a scientifically established rationale for being combined in a single product. For a combination to be considered rational, each component should contribute meaningfully to the intended therapeutic effect, have compatible pharmacological properties and demonstrate additional clinical benefit compared to using the individual medicines separately. In many cases, there is little to no evidence from clinical trials to support the combination.

One of the banned products combines amoxicillin and serratiopeptidase. Why have experts objected to this?

Serratiopeptidase is a proteolytic enzyme, which breaks down proteins. The evidence supporting its use alongside antibiotics is extremely limited. The enzyme is acid-labile, meaning it can be degraded in the stomach before reaching the bloodstream. There is no evidence that shows adequate therapeutic concentrations reach infected tissues. No peer-reviewed randomised controlled trial has shown that adding serratiopeptidase improves bacterial clearance, increases cure rates or reduces the amount of antibiotic required.

Some proponents argue that it may help antibiotics penetrate biofilms or inflamed tissues more effectively. However, this hypothesis is largely based on laboratory studies and has not been convincingly demonstrated in human clinical studies. No major treatment guideline currently recommends serratiopeptidase as an adjunct to antibiotics for managing infections.

What about popular combination drugs in use?

Take the case of the antibiotic Norflox TZ (a combination of norfloxacin and tinidazole). If you have purely bacterial diarrhoea, taking tinidazole is pointless. Conversely, if you have amoebic dysentery, norfloxacin provides zero benefit. Patients rarely suffer from bacterial and protozoal infections simultaneously. But exposure unnecessarily promotes bacterial resistance.

Doctors often caution against the misuse of Augmentin 625 (a combination of amoxicillin and clavulanic acid). The clavulanic acid acts as a barrier to block enzymes that certain resilient bacteria produce to destroy amoxicillin. But if the specific bacteria causing your infection are not resistant, the clavulanic acid is useless.

Could such antibiotic combinations contribute to antimicrobial resistance?

When combinations are marketed as being more effective without sufficient evidence, they may encourage unnecessary or prolonged antibiotic use. This increases antibiotic exposure in the community and creates selective pressure on bacteria, allowing resistant organisms to survive and multiply. From a public health perspective, antibiotic use should be as targeted and evidence-based as possible.

Many aloe vera-based dermatological combinations have also been banned. Why were these products considered irrational despite being sold for years?

Longevity in the market does not establish scientific validity. Many of the banned dermatological combinations contain multiple ingredients such as aloe vera extracts, vitamin E, jojoba oil, olive oil, tea tree oil and other moisturising or herbal components. The key question is whether combining these ingredients provides a measurable clinical benefit compared with using them individually. In many cases, robust scientific evidence demonstrating superior efficacy is lacking. Take the case of combination creams containing both a steroid and an antifungal. While they provide temporary relief from itching and redness, steroids suppress the skin's local immune response, which can cause the underlying fungal infection to worsen, spread, or become resistant to treatment. Regulatory decisions are based on scientific evidence and risk-benefit assessments, not how long a product has been available commercially.

What risks do patients face when using irrational FDCs?

Patients may be exposed to unnecessary drugs, increasing the possibility of adverse effects, drug interactions and allergic reactions. Fixed combinations can also make it difficult for doctors to adjust the dose of individual ingredients according to a patient's needs. If a doctor wants to increase the dose of one medication, they cannot do so without overdosing on the other. Besides, such drugs may mask an underlying complication, reducing precision treatment.

What should patients, doctors and pharmacists do now that these products have been banned?

Patients should understand that a medicine containing multiple ingredients is not necessarily more effective than a targeted treatment. In fact, a simpler medicine supported by strong evidence is often the safer and more effective option. Patients currently using any of the banned products should consult their doctor about appropriate alternatives. Stopping an irrational FDC does not mean stopping treatment; safer and evidence-based alternatives are available.

For doctors, the focus should be on de-escalating patients to rational therapies and prescribing medicines supported by clinical evidence. Pharmacists should remain aware of the drug regulator's list of banned FDCs, flag irrational prescriptions where appropriate and educate patients about available alternatives.

Should we team up vitamins and probiotics with antibiotics?

There is no definitive evidence of them being indispensable. While probiotics may be advised by doctors on a case-specific basis, vitamins may not be needed, except by those in a vulnerable group. Antibiotics have a limited dosage; you may not need vitamins for a short spell. Consult your doctor.

• HOW FDCs ARE REGULATED AROUND THE WORLD

U.S.: All FDCs require a new drug application with clinical evidence of superiority or convenience over mono-components.

WHO: WHO explicitly cautions against irrational FDCs. Those in the essential medicines list are evidence-based.

INDIA (PRE-REFORM): Thousands of FDCs were approved by state licencing authorities without central review, exploiting a regulatory loophole in the Drugs & Cosmetics Act.

INDIA (POST-2016): Around 6,000 FDCs were reviewed by a committee; bans have been initiated.

EUROPEAN UNION: Full scientific review of FDCs; they can be justified only with clinical data.

Some popular combination drugs

NORFLOX TZ (combination of norfloxacin and tinidazole)

- If you just have bacterial diarrhoea, taking tinidazole is pointless.
- If you have amoebic dysentery, norfloxacin provides zero benefit.
- Patients rarely suffer from bacterial and protozoal infections simultaneously. But exposure unnecessarily promotes bacterial resistance.

AUGMENTIN 625 (combination of amoxicillin and clavulanic acid)

- Clavulanic acid blocks enzymes that certain resilient bacteria produce to destroy amoxicillin.
- But if the bacteria causing your infection are not resistant, the clavulanic acid is useless.

COMBINATION CREAMS (combining a steroid and an anti-fungal)

- While they provide temporary relief from itching and redness, steroids suppress the skin's local immune response.
- This can cause the underlying fungal infection to worsen, spread, or become resistant to treatment.

- DR KAMINI WALIA

What are FDCs?

FDCs, or fixed-dose combination drugs, contain two or more ingredients in one formulation. They claim to amplify benefits.

•

Some combinations do improve patient outcomes. But FDCs are called 'irrational' when there is little evidence that the ingredients work better together than when used separately.

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• LEGAL

Madras HC bans cow slaughter; TN laws mandate only regulation

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, July 3

THE TAMIL Nadu government has moved the Supreme Court against a Madras High Court order directing authorities to ensure that "no cow or calf is slaughtered on the eve of Bakrid or on any other day". The state has argued that the HC imposed a "blanket ban" even though the petition before it was confined to preventing cow slaughter in public places. Tamil Nadu also contended that the order was contrary to the state's statutory framework, which "only provides for regulation and not prohibition".

What Madras HC said

A member of an unregistered outfit filed a representation on May 18 asking authorities to prevent cow slaughter "in public places" during Bakrid. Later, a writ petition was filed seeking a direction to consider that representation and act against slaughter in public places. A single judge sent the matter to a division bench of Justices G R Swaminathan and V Lakshminarayanan, treating it as a PIL.

Police told the court in a counter-affidavit that a temporary shed had already been set up for *qurbani* "in a non-public area", without obstructing traffic or offending the religious sentiments of other communities. The bench read this as a concession that the arrangements were compliant.

But the order went further, with the bench holding that sacrificing a cow was not obligatory for Bakrid. It read out the Tamil Nadu Animal Preservation Act of 1958 which permits slaughter only with a certificate showing that the animal is "over ten years of age and is unfit for work and breeding". It also invoked a Tamil Nadu Government Order (GO) banning cow slaughter in slaughterhouses to increase milk production. The bench held that "the authorities cannot permit slaughter of any animal in a place other than designated slaughter houses" and that "no cow or calf is slaughtered on the eve of Bakrid or on any other day" — creating a blanket direction.

State's appeal

The petition argued that the HC's order arose from a petition seeking only a direction to prevent the slaughter of cows in public places. The court, nevertheless, imposed "an absolute and blanket ban on the slaughter of cows and calves" — relief that was not sought by the petitioner.

The appeal also pointed to what it called an inconsistency within the judgment — one part recognises that slaughter may take place in designated slaughterhouses, while another part prohibits it altogether.

The plea noted that the GO previously referred to was never relied upon by the original petitioner. This GO, incidentally, was passed in August 1976 when the state was under President's Rule.

Tamil Nadu's plea said of the order: "An executive instruction/government order cannot be in contravention or inconsistent with the statutory provisions" and cannot override legislation enacted by the legislature. The appeal also took issue with the HC's discussion of whether cow sacrifice is required during Bakrid, saying it was "wholly extraneous" in relation to the current case. The petition pointed to the economic consequences of a blanket ban on licensed traders and allied sectors.

Conditional permit

- The Tamil Nadu Animal Preservation Act of 1958 permits slaughter of certain bovine animals after the issuance of a certificate.
- The animal must be 'over ten years of age and... unfit for work and breeding'.

Tamil Nadu's laws

Section 4 of the Tamil Nadu Animal Preservation Act, 1958, says certain animals cannot be slaughtered unless a competent authority issues a certificate for it, subject to certain conditions. The government's petition argues that "from the scheme of the Act, it is crystal clear that what is contemplated is only the regulation of animal slaughter, and that there is no ban on animal slaughter". It also cited municipal laws, such as The Tamil Nadu Urban Local Bodies Act, 1998, which requires local authorities to provide slaughterhouses, as proof of regulation and not prohibition under the law.

Tamil Nadu also relied on central legislation. Under the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, 1960, the Animal Welfare Board is empowered to advise governments and local authorities on the design, maintenance and operation of slaughterhouses. "The very fact that the Central Government has framed an exhaustive set of Rules for the purpose of regulating the practice of animal slaughter and the recognition of slaughterhouses shows that animal slaughter is not a prohibited activity," the petition stated.

• CULTURE

The story of the 'Chandigarh chair': From govt office to junkyard to global icon

Manraj Grewal Sharma
Chandigarh, July 3

FOR YEARS, the Chandigarh administration has been fighting to stop the city's iconic furniture from disappearing into private collections overseas. Late last month, it stopped the auction of two original "Pierre Jeanneret chairs" in France. The episode puts the spotlight on the legendary piece of furniture, also called Chandigarh chair, that once gathered dust in government storerooms but today sells for millions at international auctions.

What is the Chandigarh chair?

Popularly recognised by its distinctive inverted V-shaped, or compass, legs, the Chandigarh chair is an iconic piece of furniture designed in the 1950s by Pierre Jeanneret, the cousin and collaborator of Charles-Édouard Jeanneret — better known as Le Corbusier, the Swiss-French architect who, along with his team, designed Chandigarh from scratch in the early 1950s.

Pierre Jeanneret served as the city's first resident chief architect from 1951 to 1965. After his death in 1967, his ashes were scattered in Sukhna Lake, in keeping with his wish. While Le Corbusier focused on the city's overall layout and landmark buildings, Jeanneret designed much of its furniture and everyday civic infrastructure.

Rajnish Wattas, former principal of the Chandigarh College of Architecture, says the city's modernist architecture, with its clean lines and exposed concrete, demanded furniture that matched its aesthetic. "You couldn't have had Victorian chairs in such buildings, so Jeanneret designed these very elegant, functional and comfortable chairs," Wattas told *The Indian Express*.

Jeanneret worked with a team of architects popularly called the Chandigarh Collective. One of its key members was the then 28-year-old Urmila Eulie Chowdhury, the daughter of an Indian diplomat who was fluent in French and English. She helped adapt the furniture to Indian proportions and everyday needs.

WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

These chairs were designed in the 1950s by Pierre Jeanneret, the cousin of Le Corbusier

The chairs were mass-produced by local carpenters in government workshops using teak wood and cane (*rattan*), materials well-suited to the Indian climate. Designed to provide good back support, they soon became a common sight in government offices, hospitals, educational institutions and public buildings across Chandigarh.

Not all Chandigarh chairs were the same. Versions made for the Capitol Complex featured bright yellow or red leather upholstery with padding and rounded armrests; some can still be seen in the Haryana Assembly foyer. The chairs made for Panjab University — whose iconic lotus-shaped Gandhi Bhavan was also designed by Jeanneret — had modified armrests that allowed users to take notes comfortably.

French designer Joseph Dirand famously described them as "simple, so minimal, so strong".

How did they become collectibles?

For decades, Chandigarh residents took the chairs for granted. After years of use, many were replaced by steel furniture and pushed into storerooms or junkyards.

Europe "discovered" them around the early 2000s. Beginning in the late 1990s, Parisian antique dealers, including Eric Touchaleaume (Galerie 54), François Laffanour (Galerie Downtown) and Patrick Seguin (Galerie Patrick Seguin), began buying them at throwaway prices from scrap dealers and government auctions. At the time, many local officials and residents regarded them as little more than outdated junk.

The Indian Express has reported in the past about French dealers, including one trio, who even offered to give new Godrej chairs for old Chandigarh furniture.

The chairs first found favour in French restaurants before attracting celebrities such as the Kardashians. Today, original Chandigarh chairs are part of the permanent collections of the Victoria and Albert Museum in London and the Museum of Modern Art in New York.

When did they reach auction houses?

In 2004, Sotheby's auctioned a collection of Chandigarh furniture. Christie's followed with a similar sale three years later. Prices have soared ever since. Starting bids that were once around Rs 14 lakh per chair have climbed dramatically. A pair was once sold for about Rs 42.5 lakh at an auction in Chicago, while Parisian auction houses have fetched as much as Rs 78 lakh or more.

Has government acted?

Over the years, the Chandigarh administration, which has a heritage protection cell, has formally recognised this furniture as part of the city's listed heritage. Sumit Kaur, Chandigarh's chief architect from 2008 to 2014, told *The Indian Express* that in the early 2000s, government departments were sensitised and asked to prepare detailed inventories. "We sent out letters to various embassies requesting them to stop auctions of heritage furniture," she said.

A Ministry of Home Affairs order from 2011, prohibits the export of Chandigarh heritage articles outside India and restricts their transfer, even between government buildings, without authorisation.

The Ideas Page: American Declaration will remain universal, revolutionary; America may not 9

SATURDAY, JULY 4, 2026

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Happening today

- **IRAN WILL BEGIN** the public funeral ceremonies for Ayatollah Ali Khamenei in Tehran. The processions will proceed to other areas before reaching Mashhad, where the final burial is scheduled for July 9.
- **BJP CHIEF NITIN NABIN** will visit UP to review preparations for the Assembly polls.

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Business as Usual

By EP UNNY

SANGH CALLS FOR 'CORRECTIVE MEASURES' BY TEMPLE TRUST, STATE S.I.T.

RSS breaks silence on Ayodhya row: Theft condemnable, Trust must act

Punish the guilty, Trust must ensure faith of devotees is not shaken, says RSS general secretary Dattatreya Hosabale

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, July 3

BREAKING ITS silence on the alleged theft of donated money at the Ram temple in Ayodhya, the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) said Friday it was natural for the Hindu society, including the RSS, to expect that the Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust will treat the episode as an "extraordinary matter" and take effective steps so that the faith of crores of devotees remains unbroken.

In a statement, RSS Sarkaryavah Dattatreya Hosabale said the "highly condemnable" incident had deeply hurt the sentiments of Ram devotees and asserted that the prevailing "confusion and uncertainty" surrounding the episode must end through corrective measures by the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

NATION

BADRINATH TEMPLE TO PROBE DONATION THEFT CLAIMS PAGE 11

Probe shows pilferage surged as footfall rose during Maha Kumbh

Maulshree Seth
Ayodhya, July 3

THE ONGOING investigation into the alleged theft of donated money at the Ram temple in Ayodhya has revealed that while small instances of pilferage were overlooked earlier, the operation became more organised during the Maha Kumbh last year when footfall and donations surged and more hands were added to the cash-counting process, highly placed sources in the temple administration and police have told *The Indian Express*.

Sources said that on any given day, the average footfall at the temple is between 84,000 and 1 lakh. During the 45-day festival in 2025, which began on January 13 and ended on February 26, it had increased up to 10 to 12 lakh on peak days.

Sources said extra staff were

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

The UP Special Investigation Team probing the alleged theft arrives at the Ram temple in Ayodhya, Friday. ANI

Four Chinese firms with factories in India cleared to bid for power projects

Finance says exemption should not be treated as precedent for other companies

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, July 3

THE FINANCE Ministry has allowed four Chinese power equipment manufacturing companies with factories in India to participate in government tenders for critical power projects.

The four firms — TBEA Energy, Nanjing Electric India, New Northeast Electric India and Taikai Electric (India) — have been exempted from the provisions of the public procurement rules. These rules require entities from countries sharing a land border with India to register with the relevant Indian authority to be eligible to bid in the procurement of goods, services, or works.

The June 24 order, issued by the expenditure department in the Ministry of Finance, however, clarified this exemption would be valid for two years from the date of issuance and "may not be considered as a precedent".

The Ministry of Power had in January this year sought the exemption for certain entities with manufacturing units in India for critical power projects from participating in government procurement.

Queries sent to the Ministry of Finance and Ministry of Power did not elicit a response.

The exemption was given after deliberation by the committee of secretaries (CoS) and was based on recommendation of the 'registration committee' constituted under the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) that vets and clears the registration process for applications after restrictions were placed on Chinese entities.

These restrictions were introduced in 2020 in the aftermath

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

RAISING COMPENSATION

Adani power infra: Gujarat agrees to key demands of protesting farmers

Ritu Sharma
Ahmedabad, July 3

THE GUJARAT government on Friday agreed to several key demands of the farmers who have been protesting in Jetpar village in Morbi for higher compensation for use of their land for power infrastructure being erected by Adani Energy Solutions Ltd (AESL).

The government announced its decision on the day *The Indian Express* reported on the farmers' protest that has been ongoing for more than three weeks, and a day before Prime Minister Narendra Modi is scheduled to travel to Gujarat to inaugurate a semiconductor facility in Sanand.

The government has agreed to take the market price of the farmers' land as the baseline instead of the *jantri* (circle) rate, and to award them double that amount as compensation.

This is a significant concession, even though this compensation is still less than what the farmers have been demanding. The farmers said on Friday that the agitation would continue until a Government Resolution (GR) was issued conceding their demands.

The farmers in Jetpar have been protesting against the installation of a 756 kV DC line by Halvad Transmission Limited over a distance of 246 km from the KPS-2 Pooling Station in Khavda, Kutch, to a new switching station at Halvad in Morbi. Halvad Transmission Ltd is a Special Purpose Vehicle of AESL, the country's largest private-sector power transmission and distribution company.

Gujarat Agriculture Minister and government spokesperson Jitu Vaghani said on Friday that the government, after

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

• The Adani project

'Don't think polarisation needed in Assam, I controlled the menace'

Manipur conflict can only be settled by communities involved: Assam CM

Liz Mathew
New Delhi, July 3

ASSAM NEEDED a "polarising figure" in order to restore the confidence of the state's indigenous population and, now that "people feel that there is a government which will not take care of just one community", there is no need for polarisation, said Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma.

Responding to questions on a wide range of issues at The Indian Express Idea Exchange Friday, Sarma also spoke about the conflict in Manipur, saying it could only be settled by the communities involved.

Speaking about the Congress, he accused Rahul Gandhi of pushing the main opposition party from its traditional "centrist" politics towards a Left-influenced, caste-focused line "borrowed" from JNU.

Asked whether a moderate face of Sarma would be seen in the next five years after his re-election in May, he said: "I do not think polarisation is required in Assam. I have controlled that menace. Now nobody can put a finger on Assamese people. No one has the guts to encroach on the land of temples, nobody has the guts to pick up a girl without her consent. Now people have been streamlined, people have become law abiding. Once everyone abides by

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma at Idea Exchange, Friday. RENUKA PURI

1991 Act doesn't bar takeover of worship place for public use: Allahabad HC

Apurva Vishwanath
New Delhi, July 3

THE PLACES of Worship (Special Provisions) Act, 1991 does not bar the government from acquiring places of worship for public purposes, the Allahabad High Court said Thursday while dismissing a writ challenging the acquisition of six mosques in Varanasi's Dalmandi Street for expansion of the Kashi Vishwanath Dham Corridor.

A bench of Justice J J Munir and Justice Arun Kumar said, "The Act of 1991 does not prohibit the Government from acquiring religious land for larger public purposes. Under the Act of 2013, the Government has the sovereign power to acquire any property, including religious property, for public

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

E-rickshaws outside a Metro station in New Delhi, Friday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Disable 7 apps, Govt tells Apple, Google after e-rickshaw shutdown videos

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, July 3

THE GOVERNMENT Friday directed Apple and Google to take down seven apps following reports that these were being misused to remotely switch off some e-rickshaws, triggering cybersecurity concerns and passenger safety risks.

The move follows the circulation of video clips on social media showing individuals connecting to nearby e-rickshaws through Bluetooth and disabling their battery management systems or BMS while the vehicles were in motion.

The apps that have been directed to be blocked include BAT-BMS, Lossigy, Epoch Lion, and Smart BMS, among others. At least a couple of them are of Chinese-origin.

A battery management system essentially tracks the state of a battery, with the primary aim of eliminating variations in performance of individual battery cells to allow them to work uniformly inside a battery pack. This system is incorporated in an EV powered with a large-capacity lithium ion battery, and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

THE CITY PAGE 4

DRIVERS FACE LOSS: SOME ASK US FOR MONEY TO RESTART

Revising Ladakh talks record, Centre gives elected leaders control over UT bureaucracy

Deeptiman Tiwary & Srirupa Goswami
New Delhi, July 3

DAYS AFTER Ladakh observed a shutdown over what its leaders alleged were omissions in the official record of their talks with the Centre, the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA), moving to address concerns over the government's commitment to its assurances, has incorporated key provisions in the final minutes of the May 22 meeting that resulted in a breakthrough after months of protests and negotiations.

The revised minutes, endorsed at a follow-up meeting in Leh Friday, include a clause stating that the proposed elected executive body for Ladakh will exercise "control and supervision, including Annual Performance Appraisal Report (APAR)" over civil servants handling subjects under the jurisdiction of the proposed Union Territory-level elected body — one of the principal demands raised by the Apex Body, Leh (ABL) and Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA).

The inclusion marks a

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Ladakh Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena inaugurates an indoor sports facility at Chuchot Gongma, Friday. PTI

THE BIG PICTURE

A 22-YEAR-OLD WHO CROSSED THE LoC FOR LOVE, AND A TALE OF LONGING, WAITING P 12

• U.S. OFFICIALS FEARED ANY ASSASSINATION BY ISRAEL WOULD DERAIL PEACE TALKS WITH IRAN, ASKED REGIONAL PARTNERS TO WARN TEHRAN

Plane carrying Ghalibaf made emergency landing after alert on Israel plot to kill

Julian E Barnes & Farnaz Fassihi
Washington, July 3

US OFFICIALS believed that Israel might have been plotting to kill Iran's top negotiators while Washington was engaged with Tehran in delicate talks this spring to reach an interim peace deal, according to current and former US officials.

Killing senior Iranian leaders had been part of Israel's strategy from the start of the war. But America's concerns about the targeting of two particular Iranian officials — Abbas Araghchi, Iran's Foreign Minister, and Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf, the Speaker of Parliament — spiked during delicate ceasefire negotiations that began in April. Fearful that an Israeli assassination effort would doom the negotiations, the US, according to some of the officials, went so far as to ask other countries in the region to warn Iran about the possibility Israel could target the two officials.

During the negotiations, Iran has taken precautions aimed at making it more difficult for Israel to strike at senior officials.

In April, Ghalibaf was set to travel to Islamabad to meet with US Vice President J D Vance. But Iranian security officials were concerned that Israel would use the opportunity to assassinate Ghalibaf or Araghchi to derail the talks, the officials said. Iranians sought guarantees from the US, through Pakistani and Qatari intermediaries, that Israel would not carry out any covert operations targeting the Iranian delegation, the officials said.

Pakistani fighter jets escorted the Iranian airplanes carrying a delegation of more than 70 Iranians from the border of Iran to Islamabad and back again when the session was over.

But on the way back to Tehran, an Israeli security threat emerged.

Iran's security forces notified the plane carrying Ghalibaf back to Tehran that they had picked up intelligence that Israel planned to attack the plane and that two Israeli fighter jets had entered Iran's airspace from its western border near Iraq, the two officials said.

Mahdi Mohammadi, a senior adviser for Ghalibaf, who accompanied him to Islamabad, confirmed this account on his social media page. The plane made an emergency landing in the city of Mashhad, Iran's closest airport to the Pakistani border, and the Iranian delegation travelled some eight hours by land back to Tehran, Mohammadi and the two officials said.

The war began February 28 with an Israeli strike that killed the supreme leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, and other top officials, based in part on US intelligence. While US strikes focused on Iran's navy and missile forces, Israel prioritized targeting the leadership in the early phase of the war, intent on killing as many high-ranking officials as it could.

That included killing potentially more pragmatic leaders that the Trump administration had hoped to negotiate with, such as Ali Larijani, Iran's top national security official, and Kamal Kharazi, a former Iranian foreign minister. Both men were involved in the negotiations with the US when they were killed in Israeli airstrikes.

The Trump administration's suspicions about the possible Israeli plot to kill the two top negotiators show how the US and Israeli war aims, which were close at the very beginning of the war, quickly diverged radically. And while the US wanted a peace agreement, Israel has been skeptical from the initial cessation of hostilities in April.

Araghchi and Ghalibaf have been the key officials negotiating with various countries in the region to reach a ceasefire and then a more lasting peace with the US. In June, the US and Iran reached a framework agreement that sought to open the Strait of Hormuz and set the outline for follow-on talks on

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

PAGE 1 anchor

Iran Parliament Speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf (centre) with Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi in Islamabad in April. X/@IRANAMBPAK

Paying tribute

Minister of State for External Affairs Pabitra Margherita and Bihar Governor Lt General (retd) Syed Ata Hasnain pay tribute to late Iran leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei in Tehran, Friday. PTI

Matcha tea, now from India: Assam estate sells first batch

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, July 3

FEATURING IN lattes and desserts across trendy cafes, matcha tea has found growing demand in India. And on Friday, the first batch of Indian-manufactured matcha tea, produced at a tea estate in Assam, was sold at the Guwahati Tea Auction Centre (GTAC).

The five-kg batch of matcha produced at the Chota Tingrai Tea Estate in Assam's Tinsukia district was sold for Rs 3,000 at the GTAC to a Guwahati-based buyer. Currently, the matcha sold in Indian markets is imported from Japan, China and Vietnam.

Mritunjay Jalan, director of Chota Tingrai Tea Estate, said that they had set up a Japanese tea manufacturing facility on their estate in 2016 and had been working with experts from the country since then to produce green tea, but decided to venture specifically into matcha this year after observing a jump in demand.

"We had begun 10 years ago when we realised that there was a big demand for green tea starting in India, but that the Indian market did not have authentic green tea... But the demand for matcha had not picked up at the time and it is a very specialised product. You cannot mass-produce it, and we didn't want to jump ahead because the market was not ready, and investments are high. But last year, we saw such a huge demand for matcha globally, which has also reached India, and we thought now is the right time to start," he said.

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma highlighted this move after Friday's sale.

"Furthering our glorious tea legacy, Assam becomes the first state in India to commercially produce matcha tea at the Chota Tingrai Tea Estate in Tinsukia. This diversification of the viral drink will help strengthen Brand Assam Tea in the global markets. This has been made possible due to the strong India-Japan ties and our collaboration in various fields, and has fetched a handsome price in the Guwahati Tea Auction Centre," he said.

The market for Assam tea has been grappling with several issues for a long time, not least of which, multiple stakeholders say, is that production outweighs the demand. Different stakeholders often hold up the global boom in demand for matcha as a contrast to what they say is a largely stagnant demand for Assam tea, with the challenges in the industry pushing several estates into diversifying into sectors such as tea tourism.

The investment in producing matcha is sizable, Jalan says, and production capacity is roughly 1/10 of that of a black tea factory. For now, he says, the target market for them is domestic.

"Tea estates in Assam will have to adapt and diversify because the black tea market has stagnated, with the result that when there is good production, prices fall... We have diversified into tea tourism, but are also diversifying within tea, trying to provide the new age products that are in demand," he said.

Rajasthan's former Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot meets former Vice President Jagdeep Dhankhar at a hospital in Jaipur on Friday. ANI

Former V-P Jagdeep Dhankhar undergoes angioplasty in Jaipur

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, July 3

FORMER VICE President of India, Jagdeep Dhankhar, underwent a successful angioplasty at Eternal Hospital, Jaipur, on Friday.

Officials at the hospital said that the procedure was performed by a team led by Dr Samin K Sharma, Chairman and Chief – Interventional Cardiology, during which two stents were successfully implanted to treat significant blockages in the former VP's coronary arteries.

Hospital sources said that Dhankhar had "complaints of heaviness in chest while walking, shortness of breath, and intermittent chest pain over the past few days" and visited Eternal Hospital for a comprehensive cardiac evaluation, including a cardiac stress test, following which specialists performed a coronary angiography.

They said that the investigation revealed a "significant blockage" in one coronary artery and based on the findings, the medical team immediately proceeded with angioplasty. "Using advanced interventional techniques, Dr Samin K Sharma successfully restored blood flow by implanting two stents in the affected artery," a hospital official said.

"The procedure was completed successfully and Shri Dhankhar is stable. He remains under the observation of the medical team and is recovering well," the official said.

Earlier in the day, former Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot visited Dhankhar at the hospital "to inquire about his well-being. His treatment is ongoing here under the supervision of Dr Samin Sharma, who has come from America. Shri Dhankhar will undergo angioplasty today. I pray to God for Shri Dhankhar's swift recovery," he said on X.

Last year, Dhankhar resigned as the VP citing his health. In his letter dated July 21, 2025, to the President, Dhankhar had said that he is resigning, "To prioritise health care and abide by medical advice."

However, this February, he had said that his resignation as VP wasn't on account of ill health. Addressing a small gathering in Churu, Dhankhar said, "*Kehte hain pehla sukh nirogi kaaya. Maine swasthya ke prati kabhi laparwahi nahi barti* (It is said that the first happiness is a healthy body. I have never neglected my health). When I said I was resigning, I never said I was sick. I said I was prioritising my health, and it should be."

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

RSS breaks silence

Trust and the state government-appointed Special Investigation Team (SIT).

The statement marks the first formal intervention by the RSS in the controversy that has engulfed the temple administration over allegations that donations from the temple were siphoned off.

Following the registration of an FIR in the matter, Trust general secretary Champat Rai stepped down from his post amid mounting pressure. His former driver is among eight arrested by police as part of the probe into the alleged theft.

Describing the Ram temple as a symbol of reverence and devotion through the sacrifices of generations of Ram devotees, Hosabale said the theft from the donation boxes had caused deep pain and anger across Hindu society.

Referring to the investigation, he said the Uttar Pradesh government had constituted an SIT at the request of the Trust and initiated legal proceedings on the basis of its recommendations. Anyone found guilty, he said, should face severe punishment.

The Sangh leader also expressed confidence that the Trust would restore public confidence through "proper financial management, flawless and transparent operational systems, and an atmosphere imbued with purity, sanctity and true dharmikta (religiosity)".

Calling for restraint, the RSS urged the Hindu society not to allow "anti-Hindu and anti-national forces" to exploit the controversy to defame Hindu society and the faith.

Hosabale's statement assumes significance given the long and central association of the RSS with the Ram Janmabhoomi movement. The Sangh and its affiliates played a pivotal role in mobilising a nationwide campaign that culminated in the construction of the temple.

Even after the temple's inauguration, the Trust has widely been perceived as functioning under the broad ideological guidance of leaders associated with the Sangh Parivar. Because of this close historical association, the RSS statement is an attempt by the organisation to distance itself from alleged administrative lapses while simultaneously demanding accountability and systemic reforms.

Pilferage

added to the cash-counting process on the recommendation of members of the Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust to assist the State Bank of India.

An official at the temple, speaking on condition of anonymity, said, "After the initial influx of pilgrims following the consecration ceremony (in 2024), it was during Maha Kumbh that footfall increased drastically and so did donations. Counting needed more assistance, and recommendations were made to provide local employment. But hiring was done by the firm for SBI. Everything was built on trust and faith and no one expected things to become so organised," said an official.

The Sainik Security Services was hired by SBI for security and manpower to manage the counting of donated money and its dispatch to the bank branch. On Thursday, Gaurav Singh, director of Sainik Security Services, said his agency provides housekeeping staff to banks and other firms.

"We don't provide banking-related manpower, but housekeeping staff. What a bank or firm uses the staff for is up to them," Singh said. He said that in the hiring for the Ram temple, the agency did not have the freedom to choose manpower.

"In this case, SBI gave us names of the people to be hired. We verified their credentials by examining their Aadhaar cards and processed the paperwork. These men have never worked with us earlier," Singh said, adding that documentary evidence to the effect had been provided to the Special Investigation Team probing the case.

According to sources, the matter became public following infighting between two members associated with the Trust over recruitment and alleged pilferage.

A police officer told *The Indian Express*, "It was not the first time that the pilferage had come to the knowledge of temple officials. It had long gone unchecked and ignored until recently, when a series of events led to revelations one after another."

Sources said there were initial attempts to contain the matter by asking those allegedly caught to deposit the money back into the accounts.

Sources said there were two CCTV control rooms, one monitored by the police and another at the cash counting centre, staffed by Trust officials and police.

Investigators are now looking into the role of police and SBI officials as well, maintaining that such organised pilferage could not have been possible at just one level.

Officials said in addition to heavy security deployment – 8 companies of PAC, 500 CRPF personnel, 750 Uttar Pradesh Police Special Security Force personnel and civil police – the Trust hired private security which was stationed outside the cash counting room.

"Considering the extent of cash handled at the counting room, security checks were certainly insufficient," an official said.

Police had earlier said around Rs 80 lakh was recovered from seven of the eight arrested accused. Foreign currency in different denominations have also been recovered.

Himanta

the law, I do not need to talk every day. I have to speak whenever it is required."

According to Sarma, the indigenous community, which includes "Assamese Muslims", was frustrated at feeling it was turning into a minority, and needed a polarising figure who would speak for it.

"Because we did not have a figure, (there was) reason for frustration. I saw the requirement. Now people feel confident. Nothing has changed numerically, but people feel that there is a government which will not take care of just one community but they will listen to us too. Earlier, they felt they were fragmented and would not have the power to install a government of their own," he said.

"People wanted a polarising figure... and I served that purpose," he said.

At the state polls this year, Sarma, who is known for his controversial remarks, led the BJP to a resounding victory, reducing the Congress to 19 seats in the 126-member Assembly.

Asked about the ongoing tensions in Manipur, Sarma maintained that the conflict was between communities and could only be resolved through discussions between them, not outside intervention.

"In Manipur, the conflict is between the communities — of Kukis and Meiteis, and now between Kukis and Nagas. It's very strong and can never be resolved by outside intervention. We can restore law and order. But we cannot sit two brothers and settle their dispute. We can encourage, but cannot force... You cannot settle those disputes, particularly among the tribal communities.. There is no memorandum or charter of demands for the Government of India. They say it's their fight and that they should find a solution," he said.

"You cannot put a rifle on them and say if you don't resolve the issues before 6 o'clock tomorrow we will do something. We can maintain law and order but a solution has to come from the community. We can just encourage them for discussions," he said.

Sarma, who has been a critic of Rahul Gandhi ever since he left the Congress in 2015, alleged that the opposition party has shifted its ideological position from centrist to Leftist.

"Congress never asked questions like 'what's your caste?' Rahul Gandhi asked this to a reporter. He typically borrowed this from the JNU and from the Left. When he wants to make a chief minister from his party he never asks his jaati (caste)... When he replaced OBC Siddaramaiah (in Karnataka) with a (D K) Shivkumar, a non-OBC, he did not ask his caste. This is typical Left style: what he says is not practiced in their families. Now the slogans of the Congress and AISA's slogans are similar," he said.

"I was in Congress for 22 years. It never had dafli-wala (the handheld drum widely used in street protests) culture. There was never a talk about casteism. Congress was always centrist. There was never such an ideological shift. They have lost their centrist position now. That's why followers of Nehru, Gandhi, Sardar Patel do not relate with the present Congress," Sarma said.

Ladakh

departure from the earlier draft minutes circulated by the MHA after the May 22 meeting, which Ladakh leaders had refused to sign, alleging they omitted crucial understandings reached during negotiations.

It had triggered a political standoff, culminating in a complete shutdown across Ladakh on June 23 called jointly by the ABL and KDA. The groups had accused the Centre of backtracking on commitments and described the draft minutes as not reflecting the actual discussions held with MHA officials.

According to the finalised minutes, representatives from Ladakh reiterated their demands for statehood, Sixth Schedule status, a separate Ladakh Administrative and Police Service, and withdrawal of cases related to the September 24, 2025 protests.

The minutes note that while statehood would remain Ladakh's "long-term aspiration", both sides agreed that, as a first step, a customised model of self-governance would be created through a Union Territory-level elected body with executive, financial and legislative powers.

Significantly, the document records that the issue of bureaucratic accountability was discussed in detail. "It was agreed that in terms of functions and civil servants for the subjects under the purview of the UT-level elected body, the control and supervision, including APAR, will be exercised by the elected executive body. Further details will be finalised in future meetings as per the Transaction of Business Rules," the minutes state.

The final document also records that a customised constitutional safeguards model under Article 371 would be developed for Ladakh. It says a "sui generis" model, drawing from the various provisions under Article 371, would be prepared, with a draft proposal on the powers and functions of the elected body to be fine-tuned in future meetings.

The minutes were finalised at a meeting Friday in Leh in the presence of Additional Secretary (MHA) Prashant S Lokhande, Chief Secretary Ashish Kundra, Ladakh MP Mohmad Haneefa, former MP Thupstan Chhewang, ABL co-chairman Chering Dorjay Lakrook, KDA co-chairman Asgar Ali Karbalai, Kargil Hill Council Chairman Mohd Jaffar Akhoon and other representatives.

The endorsement of the revised minutes is expected to revive the dialogue process between the Centre and Ladakh's civil society groups after weeks of uncertainty over the future of the negotiations.

Activist Sonam Wangchuk, who spearheaded the protests for Ladakh's statehood and constitutional safeguards under the Sixth Schedule and was present in the May 22 meeting, told *The Indian Express*, "There's still time to reach an accord, but the issue is more or less resolved."

"The democratic setup will be tailor-made for Ladakh, in which elected representatives will have supremacy over bureaucrats in everything, basically, including their APRs (performance reports), which is true democracy," he said, at Jantar Mantar, where he has been on an indefinite fast over the alleged examination irregularities.

When asked about Ladakh's inclusion in the Sixth Schedule, he said, "Since Sixth Schedule status and full statehood were considered difficult currently, the Centre proposed a win-win solution. However, there were some blocks, they were resolved today, and now those measures will take effect, hopefully sincerely, without any ifs, buts..."

Ghalibaf

Tehran's nuclear program.

Officials and commentators in Israel viewed the initial agreement as a disaster, because it did not accomplish their country's war aims of forcing regime change, destroying Iran's proxy forces and seriously damaging its missile program. Israeli officials also worried the agreement would put billions of dollars into Iran, allowing it to quickly rebuild after the war and without meaningfully restricting its nuclear ambitions.

A spokesperson for the Israeli Embassy in Washington declined to comment.

Asked about Israeli plans and the warning to Iran, a US official noted that talks between American and Iranian delegations continue and that Steve Witkoff, a special envoy, and Jared Kushner, the US President's son-in-law, had productive meetings in Qatar. President Donald Trump, the official said, wants the peace process "to play out." NYT

Adani infra

studying the policy in other states, had decided "to increase the compensation to ensure lakhs of farmers in the state get fair and market-based compensation for their land".

The farmers had demanded compensation at the rate of 400% of the market price of their land. Vaghani said they would be paid double the market price.

Also, the compensation will now be calculated on the basis of an area larger than the actual base area of the electricity tower.

"From now on, for the benefit of the farmers, more compensation will be paid by calculating one additional square metre on each side of the base area of the tower. For example, in the 765 kV transmission line, compensation was earlier given for 625 square metres, which has been revised to 729 square metres," Vaghani said.

The government has also agreed to the farmers' demand to form a MRC (Market Rate Committee) to determine the actual market price of the land in a neutral and transparent manner.

"The committee (MRC) will be headed by the District Collector, and will have representatives of affected landowners, an authorised market valuer nominated by farmers, and representatives of the transmission service provider along with an authorised valuer nominated by the company. The inclusion of farmer representatives is intended to ensure transparency and protect farmers' interests during the valuation process," Ashwini Kumar, principal secretary, Energy and Petrochemicals, said.

Also, the compensation will be paid out in advance and in one installment, as the protesting farmers had demanded. The current system is one of staggered payment in three installments.

Claiming that the transmission towers and high-tension power cables on their land would lead to a massive reduction of its value, the farmers had put forth a set of six demands, including the creation of a Market Rate Committee (MRC) to determine the market price of the land; compensation amounting to 400% of the market price as determined by the MRC for the tower area; separate compensation slabs for the secure 'Right of Way' (RoW) area around the power lines in rural, municipality, and municipal corporation areas; and full advance payment of compensation.

"Demands from various farmer organisations, kisan sangh, and individual farmers were received by the Chief Minister," Vaghani said. "After consultations...chaired by the CM and Deputy Chief Minister who asked us to take decisions with an open mind in the farmers' interest..., the Gujarat government has taken this historic decision. A major amendment has been made by the government...," he said.

Vaghani added that the "benefits of the revised policy will also be available to farmers whose compensation had been determined under the earlier rates, but on whose lands the transmission line projects are still under execution".

The power transmission infrastructure is coming up on land in around 400 villages in Kutch and Morbi.

4 firms

of a violent clash between Indian and Chinese troops along the Line of Actual Control. The provisions required Chinese bidders to obtain mandatory political and security clearances from the Ministry of External Affairs and Ministry of Home Affairs.

The clearances to the power firms comes nearly three months after the government announced calibrated changes in the Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) policy for investments from Land Bordering Countries (LBCs), or those that share a land border with India. The changes were made six years after the government made prior approval mandatory for Indian entities receiving investments from LBCs in April 2020. The changes, introduced through a document known as Press Note 3 or PN3, were to curb potential takeovers of local companies during the slump in equity valuations around Covid-19.

All four firms, which have been granted exemption, manufacture key power sector equipment such as transformers, wires, high-voltage switch gear, and gas-insulated switchgear which are used in transmission lines. In its website, New North-east Electric India shows at least 11 transmission line projects across India.

Since early 2000, Chinese companies have made inroads into India's growing power sector market, especially in supplying generation equipment for thermal power plants. During this period, China's three major power generation equipment manufacturers, China Dongfang Electric Group, Shanghai Electric Group and Harbin Electric Group, had become bulk exporters to the Indian market.

Availability of Chinese tech and expertise has been crucial for Indian industry, especially in generation and transmission projects. Last year, the industry had sought an easing of the visa norms for Chinese technicians as several projects were stuck due to lack of expert manpower. Industry representatives had said the delay in visa approval is hurting the manufacturing industry including the leather sector which is increasingly shifting to sports footwear. Having imported and installed Chinese machinery, the domestic industry said it was unable to operationalise plants due to visa hurdles.

The Indian industry needs Chinese professionals since it is heavily dependent on China for crucial parts in most electrical and electronic segments. Official data shows that out of the nearly $112 billion worth imports from China, nearly 60 per cent comprised engineering and electronic items, and these also play a key role in fulfilling India's export orders.

E-rickshaw shutdown

plays a key role in extending the service life of the battery and ensuring the safe use of the battery.

Top vendors of BMS systems include Texas Instruments, NXP Semiconductors, Analog Devices, Infineon Technologies, LG Chem, Panasonic and Renesas Electronics. Chinese battery makers such as CATL and BYD are also big players in this space, alongside a host of smaller companies that cater to the unorganised segment. Automotive is the largest segment for BMS systems with a 50% market share that is primarily driven by EV battery management and hybrid vehicle energy optimisation.

Energy accounts for 20%, with grid-scale battery storage and renewable energy integration, where companies such as Navitas Systems and Nuvation Energy are among the big players.

The BAT-BMS app was originally developed by China's Shenzhen Grenergy Technology as a legitimate battery management tool for Bluetooth-enabled lithium-ion batteries.

The idea of having a Bluetooth connection point is to enable vehicles with these batteries to connect to the device remotely through an app and monitor the parameters of the battery on a real time basis. The app allows users to monitor a battery's state of charge, voltage, current, temperature, charging cycles and overall health. The application also enables compatible users to control charging and discharging functions, making it useful for battery diagnostics and maintenance.

According to its Play Store listing, the app can connect wirelessly to batteries over Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) within an operating range of around 15 metres. Such apps are typically designed to be used at service centres for battery-related diagnostics.

The primary concern, however, lies with the security configuration of some BMS used in low-cost electric vehicles. The apps in question could connect to the BMS within a limited range, and be used to cut battery power, bringing the vehicle to a sudden halt.

This was primarily a problem in electric e-rickshaws, which use low-cost Chinese-made BMS without adequate password protection or default credentials. As a result, anyone standing within Bluetooth range may be able to pair with the battery using compatible applications such as BAT-BMS and disable the battery's discharge function. Since the discharge circuit supplies power to the motor, switching it off can immediately immobilise the vehicle.

Sources said this is not a sophisticated hacking attack but rather the exploitation of weak security settings on connected battery systems. The app itself does not automatically gain control over every electric vehicle. It only works with batteries that support compatible Bluetooth-enabled BMS hardware. Many e-rickshaws continue to use lead-acid batteries, while several lithium-powered vehicles rely on proprietary battery management systems that cannot be accessed through applications like BAT-BMS.

The problem with some of the low-cost Chinese lithium battery packs used in most e-rickshaws is that they come with Bluetooth-enabled BMS units that have little or no password protection. If such a battery is not adequately secured, anyone standing within Bluetooth range can potentially connect to it and manipulate the settings, including turning off the battery's discharge function. Since the discharge function supplies power to the motor, disabling it can immediately stop the vehicle.

Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

1991 Act

purposes, such as building roads, highways or public infrastructure."

The bench termed the relief sought a "misconstruction of the scope of the Statute". It was hearing a batch of pleas by shopkeepers and tenants in the Dalmandi Market area, which is about 800 metres to the east of the Kashi Vishwanath temple.

Among other protections from demolition of their shops and residences, the petitioners argued that the takeover and change of the character of the six ancient mosques would be barred under the 1991 Act. The law retrospectively froze the religious character of all places of worship except the (then) disputed structure in Ayodhya as they stood at the dawn of Independence.

The government told the bench: "The purport of the Act of 1991 is not to place beyond the pale of authority of the State's right as the owner paramount of all lands in the territory of India and to acquire and use it for any public purpose, subject, of course, to the owner's right to receive just and fair compensation. That is what the doctrine of eminent domain, after all, means. The Act of 1991 is not meant to derogate from that right of the State."

According to the petitioners, the six mosques – Anjuman Intezamia Masjid, Masjid Rangile Shah, Masjid Ali Raza Khan, Masjid Karimullah Baig, Masjid Nisaran and Masjid Sangamarmar – predate the cut-off in the 1991 law.

The ruling noted that the government, in an order dated March 31, 2025 and July 30, 2025, were issued by the state government, allocating a budget of Rs 21,588.24 lakh for the purpose of "widening and beautification of the Dalmandi Street."

The bench also dismissed the petitioner's pleas on the grounds that they had no right to challenge the acquisition as tenants of the land. It said it had decided the pleas "without prejudice to the rights of the State, the Waqf Board and the Mutawalli of mosques concerned to suit their rights in appropriate proceedings, if and when the occasion arises."

FIRST USE OF PROVISION REVISED IN 2023

Centre reappoints Yogesh Singh as DU VC for second term

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 3

ALMOST THREE years after the Union government amended the University of Delhi's statutes to make its Vice-Chancellor eligible for reappointment, the Centre has exercised the provision for the first time, reappointing VC Yogesh Singh for a second consecutive five-year term.

In an order dated July 2, the Ministry of Education said the President, in her capacity as the Visitor of the University of Delhi, has approved Singh's reappointment. "I am directed to convey that the Hon'ble President of India in her capacity as the Visitor of University of Delhi has been pleased to re-appoint Prof Yogesh Singh as the Vice Chancellor of University of Delhi for a second term of five years w.e.f. 08.10.2026," the notification issued by the Department of Higher Education stated.

Before the rules were changed, DU was among the few central universities in the country where the VC was not eligible for re-appointment. The development follows a statutory amendment first reported by *The Indian Express* in October 2023, when the Union government approved changes to the Delhi University Statutes enabling the VC to serve a second consecutive term through reappointment. Before the amendment, an incumbent VC of DU seeking another term had to apply afresh alongside other candidates. The VC could continue until their successor assumed office, but a seamless transition to a second term was not possible. The amendment altered Statute 11-F(4) to state that the VC "shall hold office for a term of five years and shall be eligible for re-appointment for another term".

Vice Chancellor Yogesh Singh begins fresh term on October 8

At the time, university officials had told *The Indian Express* that the amendment was not a fresh proposal but the revival of a resolution that was originally passed by Delhi University's Executive Council in March 2014 during the tenure of then Vice Chancellor Dinesh Singh.

The proposal had subsequently been approved by the University Court and forwarded to the Ministry of Education, where it remained pending for almost a decade before receiving the Visitor's approval in 2023.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* then, Prof Yogesh Singh had earlier said, "This is not a new proposal. This was approved by the EC under the leadership of Dinesh Singh ji and has now been approved by the Visitor too."

During Dinesh Singh's term (2010-15) as VC, aside from approving a resolution on giving the VC another term, the EC, DU's highest decision-making authority, had also passed resolutions increasing the retirement age of several office bearers such as the Dean of Colleges and the Pro-Vice Chancellor from 65 years to 70 years. This change too was approved by the Centre.

Yogesh Singh, who assumed office as Delhi University's VC in 2021, will begin his second five-year term on October 8, 2026, according to the Ministry's order.

As the 23rd VC of DU, Singh's current term has seen the rollout of the National Education Policy (NEP) at the university, implementation of the Four-Year Undergraduate Programme (FYUP), expansion of admissions through the Common University Entrance Test (CUET), and significant restructuring across colleges and departments.

Days after govt order, SC stays audit of discoms

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 3

THE SUPREME Court on Friday stayed the audit of three major private discoms in the Capital — BSES Rajdhani Power Limited (BRPL), BSES Yamuna Power Limited (BYPL) and Tata Power Delhi Distribution Limited (TPDDL). This comes two days after the Delhi government ordered an audit of the discoms amid concerns over accumulation of regulatory assets (RAs) to the tune of Rs 38,500 crore over the years — a cost that is ultimately to be recovered from consumers. This was the first time that such an order was issued since the privatisation of electricity distribution in 2002 in the Capital.

On who would audit the discoms, a bench of Justices K V Viswanathan and Shree Chandrasekhar on Friday ordered a status quo till the apex court examines the scope of its August 2025 judgment that ordered a strict audit into the circumstances in which the discoms continued without recovery of the regulatory assets.

"Till further orders, there shall be a stay of the Appellate Tribunal for Electricity (APTEL) direction on appointing any chartered accountant for audit. The Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) shall also not proceed with the audit in the meantime," the bench directed.

The interim order came on an appeal by the Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission (DERC), challenging an order of the APTEL, an autonomous body, which said that entrusting the audit to CAG would be against the statutory framework and instead directed the regulator to appoint an independent chartered accountant. The SC has issued notice on the plea.

Appearing for DERC, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said the audit — as directed by the August 2025 judgment —is necessary before the recovery of regulatory assets is made from the consumers.

He informed the court that LG Taranjit Singh Sandhu had given nod to the CAG audit. He submitted that the direction in the August 2025 judgement was to liquidate existing regulatory assets. "Liquidation has been prohibited by the LG yesterday. They want recovery without the audit. Consumers should not be saddled with the cost they will have to pay if they go ahead with the liquidation," Mehta said.

The bench wondered how the question of liquidation arose in the 2025 proceedings, which were about legality of appointing CAG to audit.

Appearing for the discoms, senior advocate A M Singhvi said the audit question and recovery of regulatory assets were distinct issues. The instant appeal, he said, only dealt with the question as to whether the DERC can entrust the audit to CAG. He added that the roadmap for liquidation of the regulatory assets had already been settled until 2031. The bench noted that the matter would require interpretation of the August 2025 decision and directed that the appeal be placed before the Chief Justice of India for referring to an appropriate bench. In its August 2025 judgment, the SC had not specified who should conduct the audit.

Reacting to the order, Power Minister Ashish Sood said, "It is a procedural order intended to preserve the status quo until the legal issues are examined in detail."

'No job security': Doctors, health workers protest for benefits of Seventh Pay Commission

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, July 3

AROUND 500-550 DOCTORS and healthcare workers employed under the Delhi State Health Mission (DSHM) sat on a one-day strike on Friday, demanding implementation of the recommendations of the 7th Pay Commission and other salary-related benefits.

They camped outside Vikas Bhawan near Sushruta Trauma Centre after a delegation failed to meet either the Delhi Chief Minister or the Health Minister. Braving the sweltering heat, many protesters covered their heads with scarves, towels and caps, while others carried umbrellas.

Members of the Health Mission Doctors' Welfare Association said a delegation had sought meetings with the Chief Minister and the Health Minister but both leaders were unavailable and the strike continued.

Their other demands include revision of salary ceilings to restore pending annual increments, job security for contractual employees, Delhi Government Employees Health Scheme (DGEHS) health cards, and retirement and death benefits for employees working under the National Health Mission (NHM).

Protesters outside Vikas Bhawan on Friday. EXPRESS

In a letter dated June 24, addressed to the State Programme Officer, DSHM, the association announced that NHM employees would go on a one-day token strike on July 3 if their long-pending demands remained unresolved.

It warned that if its demands continue to be ignored, it may intensify its agitation in the coming days.

Association members said NHM doctors and healthcare workers form the backbone of Delhi's public healthcare system.

Despite delivering frontline healthcare services for years, they alleged that thousands of contractual employees continue to work without job security or adequate benefits.

In the June 24 letter, the association claimed a proposal to extend benefits of the 7th Pay Commission to DSHM employees has remained pending for years despite completing departmental processing.

It claimed the file had been forwarded for Cabinet approval but has since remained stalled.

It also alleged that several employees have not received annual salary increments for the last three years because the maximum salary ceiling has not been revised in line with their years of service, resulting in significant financial losses.

There was no immediate response from the Delhi government or DSHM to the association's claims.

Over 90% desilting work complete: Minister as city braces for monsoon

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 3

A DAY after the onset of monsoon in Delhi, the Public Works Department (PWD) on Friday said it has completed around 93% of desilting work across its three main zones. According to official figures, till July 2, the PWD cleared around 92% of its 2,123 km storm water drainage network — desilting about 1,955 km across its East (539.34 km), South (603 km), and North (812 km) zones. PWD manages 1,440 kms of roads and 2,123 km of drainage network across the city, making up for around 50 per cent of the total drainage network of the city.

"Our priority is to clean the drainage network and make it functional to ensure that even during heavy rainfall, water does not accumulate and disrupt movement. For this, we have strengthened the manpower and desilting work is ongoing at desired pace with overall more than 90% of the work completed," PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said.

Meanwhile, the Irrigation and Flood Control (I&FC) department which looks after key drains in the city including the Najafgarh, Barapullah Bhasin also said that it has completed 93% of desilting work across 77 drains, with more than 31 lakh metric tonnes (MT) of silt already removed. Currently, I&FC manages 382 kilometres of drain length, including the Najafgarh drain, Barapullah drain and Delhi Gate drain. "Officials have also been directed to ensure proper disposal of silt and prevent it from flowing back into the drains," Singh added.

Further, Delhi government has identified around 169 locations that are prone to waterlogging. Of the total 445 waterlogging hotspots have been identified, of which 335 are under PWD and are being closely monitored with special deployment like pumps and sucking machines to clear the water as soon as it accumulates, officials said.

Of these, approximately 31 spots are located along the Ring Road only, according to the government's flood control order published recently. To manage issues that might arise in these spots, PWD and I&FC have made arrangements , said officials.

Ghaziabad: Teen held for sexually assaulting 5-yr-old

Drishti Jain
Ghaziabad, July 3

A 14-YEAR-OLD boy was detained on Friday in Ghaziabad for allegedly sexually assaulting a five-year-old girl, said police.

In a complaint, the child's family told the police that the incident happened on Wednesday when they were visiting a relative and the five-year-old went out to play along with other children.

"The girl's brother took away a toy and she ran behind him. On the way, she collided with the accused who took her to an abandoned place where he sexually assaulted her," an officer said.

When the five-year-old returned home, she was crying and told her parents about the incident, said police.

Officers said a case has been registered under sections of POCSO Act and Section (137(2) of the BNS.

ONE MONTH OF MALVIYA NAGAR B&B FIRE THAT CLAIMED 23 LIVES

Probe reveals regulatory blind spots before blaze

Alok Singh & Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, July 3

ON MAY 3, 2024, the Delhi Tourism department issued a licence to Flourish Stay in Malviya Nagar to operate as a six-room Bed & Breakfast (B&B). The licence was valid for three years and as per the Bed & Breakfast Act, the department was not required to carry out periodic inspections during this period.

This loophole in the law, sources said, led to the hotel flouting norms by expanding the B&B into a 26-room hotel, where a fire on June 3 led to the deaths of 23 people, including 14 foreigners. According to sources, the same has been flagged to senior government authorities who are probing the matter.

According to officials, while the department was not needed to carry out periodic inspections, it had to intervene if any other government agency reported violations or raised a red flag about the B&B's functioning.

Sources citing official records said that none of the agencies that dealt with the B&B since May 2024 alerted the Tourism department about the unauthorised expansion.

These included the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), which is scheduled to conduct inspections when health and trade licences are renewed every year. Power and Water departments, too, could have noticed consumption inconsistent with a six-room B&B and more in line with a larger hotel operation.

Further, the local police are supposed to periodically verify guest records before major events and festivals, including Independence Day and Republic Day.

Outside the B&B in Hauz Rani on Friday. ABHINAV SAHA

Sources also said that for security reasons, B&B operators are required to inform the Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO) about the stay of foreign nationals, periodically.

None of these agencies raised a red flag.

Sources in the government said the Tourism department's internal report has said that the fire was related to "issues concerning operational safety, fire prevention measures, building usage, occupancy management and compliance with statutory obligations that are primarily the responsibility of the owner and the authorities empowered under the relevant municipal, fire safety, police and other regulatory laws."

According to official records, while obtaining the licence, owner Lavkesh Bajaj told the Tourism department that he had leased the property to his accountant, Jay Mishra, for six years.

Under the B&B rules, if a property is leased for more than three years, the licence-issuing authority may treat the lessee as the owner for licensing purposes. The licence application stated that Mishra would reside on the property.

Bajaj had also submitted documents, including police verification documents issued by the local Malviya Nagar police station, Aadhaar card, ownership papers and the building layout plan.

Sources said three Tourism department officials, including an assistant director, inspected the property before issuing the licence for three years, valid until May 2, 2027. They found Mishra living there and approved a six-room B&B – three each on the first floor and second floor. At the time, the three-storey building had 10 rooms.

The registration certificate was issued under the Silver Category of the National Capital Territory of Delhi (Incredible India) Bed & Breakfast Establishments (Registration and Regulation) Act, 2007.

According to the probe, after getting the licence, three additional floors and 20 more rooms were illegally added on the upper floors and in the basement. A full kitchen was also started on the ground floor despite Bajaj having permission only to serve tea and snacks under a licence issued by the MCD.

The department sent copies of the registration certificate to several agencies, including the Delhi Police, MCD, Delhi Jal Board, BSES Yamuna Power Limited, Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation (DTTDC) and India Tourism.

However, none informed the department that the property was allegedly operating as a hotel.

The police probe has, meanwhile, found that the blaze originated in the B&B's kitchen after chef Keshav Negi switched on a stove to heat oil for frying.

"As the oil became excessively hot, fumes came into contact with plastic panelling installed behind the cooking area, igniting the fire and allowing it to spread rapidly through the building," said an officer.

As per police, Negi initially tried to control the situation by shutting off the source of the fumes, but the flames intensified within moments and he fled. At the time, the receptionist, a sanitation worker and two housekeeping employees were present at the B&B. It was the receptionist who informed the Bajaj of the fire.

Police are now awaiting the final forensic reports before filing a chargesheet, which is expected to be submitted in the coming days, said officers.

Most hotels and B&Bs shut, Hauz Rani Market awaits customers

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, July 3

GROUND report

ANYONE VISITING Hauz Rani Market in South Delhi's Malviya Nagar cannot miss the yellow sealing tapes outside most of the hotels and B&Bs in the area.

A month after the fire at Flourish Stay B&B killed 23 people, including 14 foreign nationals, the crackdown by the MCD on hotels flouting norms continues. Around almost every corner, hotels and B&Bs are shut, with safety violation notices pasted across their entrances. The gutted building where the fire broke out on June 3 stands hidden behind a pink sheet and police barricades.

Barricades in place at the Hauz Rani market on Friday. ABHINAV SAHA

The shops, however, are open again. Pharmacies, grocery stores, restaurants, crockery and pottery shops have resumed business after a brief closure.

But beneath the appearance of normalcy, traders say business has all but disappeared. With the crackdown in effect, the streets are empty and so are the shops. For years, many establishments in the area relied on medical tourists who came for treatment at the Max Hospital in Saket, located across the road, and stayed in nearby hotels, guest houses and B&Bs. A foreign national, who has been running a store of imported food items for two years in the market, said his business depended almost entirely on overseas visitors.

"Footfall has dropped by at least 70%. My store survives on foreign customers. I have three employees who depend on me. I feel like a leaf floating on water. At any moment, the current can carry everything away," he said.

Many shopkeepers are migrants who operate from rented shops. Thahlath Azeez from Bodh Gaya in Bihar, who has been running a tea shop in the market for more than a decade, said, "I wish the building owners understand our situation. They only care about getting the rent on time. We are really worried about how we will cover our expenses."

Kesar (57), who has run a pottery shop next to the gutted building for more than three decades, still remembers the morning of the fire. "We were having breakfast when we heard the screams. My husband and son ran towards the building and returned hours later covered in soot. I can still hear the screams," she said.

Her shop hardly sees any customers these days. "I have only made Rs 30 selling a clay pot since we opened the shop in the morning...," she said.

A few metres from the burnt building, Mansuri Cotton Shop has reopened days after the fire. Riyazuddin Mansoori (62), the proprietor, became a local hero after he attempted to save victims of the fire by laying down blankets from his shop to cushion the blow as many jumped from the upper floors of the B&B to save their lives.

"Seeing the market like this, and shopkeepers panicking, makes me worried for our neighbourhood. The tourists were our bread and butter. Now, they are gone. Where do we go from here?" he said.

Backed by World Bank, Delhi draws up 7-year plan to tackle air pollution

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 3

THE DELHI government has drawn up a seven-year air pollution mitigation plan with an estimated outlay of Rs 8,300 crore as it aims to strengthen air quality management in the Capital and reduce emissions from major pollution sources such as vehicles, road dust, construction and demolition waste.

"The goal is to accelerate the implementation of Delhi's air pollution mitigation plan, advance the objectives of the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP) and contribute to the vision of 'Viksit Bharat 2047'," said Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday. NCAP was launched by the Centre in 2019 with to curb pollution in major cities. Titled 'Swachh Hawa, Swasth Delhi', the Delhi government project is proposed to be implemented between September this year and August 2033 with support from the World Bank.

"The World Bank will provide 65% financial assistance, while the remaining 35% will be borne by the Delhi government," Gupta said.

She added, "A special workshop will be held on July 10 to define the role of various departments and agencies and lay the roadmap for the effective and timely implementation of the project."

Under the strengthening Institutional Capacity for Air Quality Management (AQM), the government aims to establish a dedicated Project Management Unit (PMU) to ensure mission-mode implementation, developing advanced air quality monitoring, data analytics, and Integrated Command and Control Centre (ICCC)-based monitoring systems, strengthening inter-departmental coordination and collaboration with Indo-Gangetic Plain (IGP) states for airshed-based pollution management, according to officials.

Another key aspect of the plan is to promote cleaner transportation by accelerating the phase-out of polluting vehicles, expanding EV adoption, improving public transport integration, and establishing advanced Pollution Under Control (PUC) systems, implement dust control measures through road redevelopment, end-to-end paving, mechanised cleaning, and innovative dust suppression technologies and strengthen construction and demolition (C&D) waste management and promote the use of Recycled Aggregate Manufacturing Systems (RAMS).

Besides, this project also aims to improve municipal solid waste collection, processing, and disposal to prevent open waste burning and landfill fires, support cleaner industrial operations through adoption of cleaner technologies and strengthened compliance mechanisms and enhance green cover through plantation activities and improve management of water pollution and untreated effluent discharge.

Also in discussion is piloting innovative interventions such as low-emission zones, integrated urban planning solutions, and green public spaces.

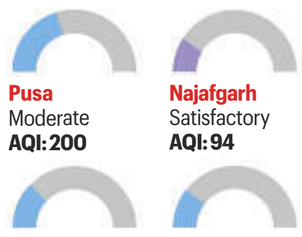
• Skywatch

Forecast: July 4, 2026
Generally cloudy sky; spell of very light to light rainfall

MAX: 34-36
1.4°C below normal

MIN: 26-28
1.9°C below normal

• AQI Tracker



- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)

E-RICKSHAWS SHUTTING DOWN IN MIDDLE OF ROADS

From Rs 1,000 to Rs 600: Earnings of Delhi's e-rickshaw drivers hit by Bluetooth hack

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, July 3

ON WEDNESDAY, 20-year old Anu Kumar's e-rickshaw stopped in the middle of the road in front of Bangla Sahib Gurdwara. He tried switching it on multiple times, but to no avail. A long line of angry drivers kept honking behind him.

By the time a couple of kind strangers helped him push the e-rickshaw to the roadside, his passengers had left, and that too without paying. "No one will pay if you drop them before their destination," he said.

Kumar took the e-rickshaw to a mechanic, afraid how much he will have to shell out to get it fixed.

But the mechanic just opened an app and tapped on the screen, and to his relief, the vehicle whirred back to life.

But the relief was short-lived. His rickshaw stopped the same way three more times the same day. On Thursday, too, it shut down thrice. "I went home. What can you do when your vehicle stops three times in a day?"

Kumar is not alone.

For the last three days, e-rickshaw drivers in the Capital have found themselves at the mercy of strangers using Bluetooth-enabled mobile applications to connect to their vehicles' battery management systems (BMS) and remotely switch them off, stopping their vehicle dead in the middle of the road.

On Friday, the Union government directed Apple and Google to remove at least three battery-management apps – BAT-BMS, Lossigy and Epoch Li-ion – from their app stores following reports that they were being misused.

E-rickshaws outside the Dilli Haat INA Metro station in New Delhi on Friday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Drivers, meanwhile, are a harried lot. "I usually earn Rs 1,000 a day. After paying for charging and maintenance, I am left with about Rs 800. But for the last two days, I have earned only Rs 600-700 because my vehicle was stopped four times each day," said Mukhiya Yadav (24), who operates between Chuna Mandi and Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital.

"While some people demanded Rs 200 to restart the vehicle, yesterday, one person even asked me for a beer," he added.

By Friday, Yadav had downloaded the BAT-BMS app himself and was helping stranded drivers restart their e-rickshaws.

The BAT-BMS app was originally developed by China's Shenzhen Grenergy Technology as a legitimate battery management tool for Bluetooth-enabled lithium-ion batteries. It allows users to monitor a battery's state of charge, voltage, current, temperature, charging cycles and overall health. The app can connect wirelessly to batteries over Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) within an operating range of around 15 m.

The primary concern, however, lies with the security configuration of some BMS used in low-cost electric vehicles. A BMS is the electronic controller that monitors and protects lithium-ion battery packs by regulating charging, discharging, temperature and cell balance. The apps in question could connect to the BMS within a limited range, and be used to cut battery power, bringing the vehicle to a sudden halt.

"This is a matter of security, and to ensure that people do not face inconvenience or distress, the government will certainly take appropriate action... The Transport department is also investigating and checking the matter," Delhi Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said, adding that Delhi Police was conducting an inquiry into it.

Kishori Kumar Jha (55), who drives it in West Delhi's Ramesh Nagar, said, "People in cars and young boys have been troubling us continuously for the last two days. After my e-rickshaw stopped yesterday, someone came up to me and demanded Rs 500 to restart it. This is extortion."

Rajiv Tuli, General Secretary of Electric Vehicle Manufacturing Society (EVMS), said complaints started pouring in from Wednesday.

"We started receiving complaints from drivers across Delhi the day before yesterday. Manufacturing companies have set up helplines where stranded drivers can call and get assistance on how to restart their vehicle. Manufacturing companies have also made their own apps now which drivers can use," he said.

• HOW TO APPLY FOR EV SUBSIDY ON DEDICATED PORTAL

- Sign up at https://evsubsidy.delhi.gov.in
- Portal has 3 sections — 'How to apply', 'Apply online' & 'Application status'

FOR PERSONAL VEHICLES

- Enter Aadhaar number, date of birth, and gender.
- Upload PDF copies of registration certificate (RC), Aadhaar card, voter ID, bank account's passbook or cancelled cheque.
- OTP will be sent through SMS to a number linked with RC
- Subsidy will be transferred to Aadhaar-linked bank account.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launches the portal where people can apply for EV subsidy, in New Delhi on Friday. ANI

For getting scrapping incentive: Upload certificate of deposit.

For businesses applying for commercial vehicle subsidy

Upload PDF copies of RC, PAN Card, and GST document.

Submit bank details, including account number, IFSC code.

After applying for subsidy, buyers can check the "Application status" section where they can enter registration number, and last five digits of Chassis Number, a unique number assigned to vehicles.

A notification is received if authorities require additional documents. After checking the status, vehicle owners need to upload the correct documents to resume the approval process.

Portal has posted a list of 123 approved EV models, including two wheelers, three wheelers and trucks.

Court directs FIR against two DU asst professors over publication fraud

Accused got research work of Assistant Professor published in fake journals

Sakshi Chand & Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, July 3

FOR 29-YEAR-OLD Ankita Kilsan, landing a job as an Assistant Professor at Delhi University's (DU) Bharati College in November 2023 felt like the ultimate validation of her hard work. A Jawaharlal Nehru University alumni, she believed her academic career was finally taking off. But just months later that dream disintegrated.

Kilsan, a resident of Shalimar Bagh, was allegedly the victim of a scam run by people she considered peers. She allegedly paid Rs 1 lakh to get three of her articles published in journals, which later turned out to be fake, leading to the termination of her service.

On Wednesday, a Delhi court directed the registration of an FIR against two DU assistant professors for allegedly duping Kilsan, formerly employed in Bharati College's Political Science department.

The court directed the SHO of Shalimar Bagh police station to register an FIR based on a complaint filed on November 5, 2024, and submit a compliance report within 30 days.

"I trusted them. Thought they were a fraternity. I found out in July 2024 that my articles are fake. I kept questioning them and they kept fooling me," Kilsan told *The Indian Express*.

"Since 2024 I have been suffering. I completed my PhD in such a stressful situation. The work I could have done in six months took over one year. I am not an isolated example. Lots of people face such a situation," she added. "My mental health deteriorated so much."

The accused against whom the FIR is to be registered are Sanjeev Kumar, who allegedly misrepresented himself as a senior medical officer at AIIMS, Delhi, Pramod Kumar and Luke Khanna, assistant professors at Dayal Singh and Bharati College, respectively.

According to Kilsan, she was introduced to Kumar in May 2021. In December 2021, Sanjeev introduced her to the two DU professors.

In her complaint, Kilsan has alleged that in May 2022, Pramod and Luke convinced her that she desperately needed research publications in reputed journals to land a teaching job. They took her original research work for publication along with Rs 1 lakh in cash as publication fees and travel expenses.

By late 2022, they allegedly handed her copies of three of her "published" articles and certificates from "recognised" journals Shodhprabha, Shodhasamhita and Madhya Bharati. Relying on these documents, Kilsan secured an assistant professor's job at Bharati College. However, in August 2024, the college Principal informed her that an RTI inquiry has revealed that the publications were fake.

On October 3, 2024, Luke allegedly demanded a bribe of Rs 25 lakh from Kilsan to "settle" the matter and preserve her job.

"...The dishonest intention on the part of the accused persons appear to be evident from the outset, prima facie satisfying the essential ingredients of cheating," Judicial Magistrate First Class Gaurav Katariya of Rohini court noted in an order.

"...the purportedly forged Certificates of Publication and journals require forensic/ scientific examination by the FSL to ascertain their origin, genuineness, and whether they are alleged to be fabricated/cloned documents...," it added.

"...the present case discloses prima facie cognizable offences warranting police investigation...," it further said, adding that misrepresentation appears to have been deliberate, designed to gain Kilsan's trust.

"What makes an act criminally liable is the presence of a fraudulent intention behind it. In this case, such an intention appears evident from the very outset...," JMFC Katariya said.

Kilsan was represented by advocates Pardeep Khatri and Pranjal Bhaskar.

'Democracy is in jeopardy': INDIA bloc parties write to CJI

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 3

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge is among the signatories

THE INDIA bloc on Friday released the full text of its letter to Chief Justice of India Surya Kant over alleged electoral malpractices, saying that people still repose their trust in the judiciary and its failure to respond "indicates a complete breakdown of the Republic".

The six-page letter, signed by top leaders of 24 parties and one Independent MP, states that under normal circumstances, the Opposition would not have written to the CJI. "Given the fact that our democracy is in jeopardy, we have chosen this unusual path," reads the letter.

The letter underlines that the elections are constitutionally required to be free and fair. "When that process is, in one way or the other, tainted, the outcome is suspect. The will of the people becomes the victim of this perfidy," it says.

"We all, representing like-minded political parties, firmly opposed to the BJP, believe that the electoral process is being manipulated and outcomes in multiple instances do not reflect the will of the people. There are several reasons for this," says the letter.

The letter, also signed by AAP and DMK, which have of late stayed away from the INDIA bloc, says the Opposition's "grave concern is the brazen biased conduct of the Election Commission of India (ECI), in particular the Chief Election Commissioner". "There has been open, unabashed support of the BJP during the course of and in the outcome of electoral processes. The Commission has not been evenhanded by choosing not to take action when the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) is breached by the political party in power — all this while targeting those in the opposition," it says.

"The Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process of sanitising the electoral rolls, according to the Chief Election Commissioner, was required to be done to ensure their integrity. But the result is quite the opposite," the letter says.

Calling the SIR "ill-timed and a monumental disaster", the letter says: "The documentation process, adopted for the first time, was inherently exclusionary and politically motivated. Verification of voters based on filling forms and production of documents, questioning citizenship, left voters disenfranchised."

The signatories included LOPs in both Houses of Parliament – Mallikarjun Kharge and Rahul Gandhi – Samajwadi Party's Akhilesh Yadav, TMC's Mamata Banerjee, DMK's Tiruchi Siva, RJD's Tejashwi Yadav, AAP's Sanjay Singh and other senior leaders in the bloc.

PM on six-day tour of Indonesia, Australia, New Zealand from July 6

Divya A
New Delhi, July 3

Secretary-East, MEA, Rudrendra Tandon, Additional Secretary (South) Prashant Agrawal, Joint Secretary (Oceania) Vishwesh Negi and MEA Spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal during a media briefing on PM Modi's three-nation visit, in New Delhi on Friday. ANI

AS DELHI seeks to bolster ties in the Asia-Pacific region, Prime Minister Narendra Modi is set to visit Indonesia, Australia and New Zealand next week, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) announced on Friday. Modi will reach Indonesia on July 6 and travel to Australia before concluding his trip with a visit to New Zealand on July 11.

Briefing reporters about the six-day visit on Friday, MEA Secretary (East) Rudrendra Tandon said the focus has shifted to the eastern maritime zones of the Indian Ocean and our Act East engagement after Modi's recent visits to Mauritius and Seychelles and Japan's PM Sanae Takaichi's New Delhi visit this week.

While the Prime Minister will hold bilateral talks with his counterparts in all three countries – Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto, Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese and New Zealand Prime Minister Christopher Luxon – diaspora engagements have also been planned in each place, owing to a significant diaspora presence.

While an estimated 1.4 lakh people of Indian origin and non-resident Indians are in Indonesia, the number for Australia goes up to 9.7 lakh, and about 3 lakh in New Zealand.

In Melbourne, where PM Modi lands on July 8, besides participating in the third India-Australia Annual Summit, the Prime Minister is also expected to meet leaders from top Australian companies, as well as visit the Melbourne Cricket Ground.

Modi and his Australian counterpart, Anthony Albanese held the 2nd India-Australia Annual Summit on the sidelines of the G20 Summit in Rio de Janeiro in November 2024. The first edition was held in March 2023 in New Delhi during the State Visit of PM Albanese.

India is one of Australia's largest trading partners, with defence cooperation among the key pillars of the ties. The discussions between the two sides will cover emerging areas of the bilateral relations, including critical minerals, cybersecurity, supply chain resilience and emerging technologies, as per officials. Along with Japan and the United States, Australia is also a member of the Quad grouping, advocating for a peaceful, stable and prosperous Indo-Pacific Region, based on respect for international law.

During the Indonesia leg, while his main engagements will be in Jakarta, the Prime Minister will also visit the historical Prambanan Temple complex in Yogyakarta city, MEA officials said. India and Indonesia will be collaborating on the conservation of the temple, a UNESCO World Heritage site. The visit to Indonesia will be a continuation of the discussions on various bilateral tracks of cooperation that began when President Prabowo visited India as the Guest of Honour for the 2025 Republic Day celebrations, the MEA said.

The visit to New Zealand will be the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister in 40 years. It also comes in the wake of a free-trade agreement signed between the two sides in April. "Prime Minister Modi's visit is historic, with this being the first to New Zealand by an Indian Prime Minister in 40 years," New Zealand's Prime Minister Christopher Luxon said in a statement on Friday.

The visit reflects the growing momentum in the New Zealand-India relationship. Discussions between the leaders will include trade and investment, maritime security, education, technology, tourism, sport, and global issues, as per officials.

"This visit is about celebrating a winning partnership between New Zealand and India — one that delivers for our people and supports greater prosperity and security for both our countries. I look forward to welcoming Prime Minister Modi to New Zealand," PM Luxon said.

Free Whatsapp Channel https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F
Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

The BJP president will hold separate meetings with Deputy CMs Pathak and Maurya

Eye on UP Assembly polls, Nabin to visit Lucknow today

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, July 3

BJP NATIONAL president Nitin Nabin, who will be on a two-day organisational visit to Lucknow beginning Saturday to draw strategy for upcoming UP Assembly elections, will hold separate meetings with Deputy Chief Ministers Keshav Prasad Maurya and Brajesh Pathak at their respective residences.

"This visit by the party's national president is extremely important for sharpening BJP's strategy, guiding the newly formed team of the state BJP and reviewing the preparations of the party and the Yogi Adityanath government for the Assembly polls (due early next year). His visit will warm up the cadres for polls and send a message to senior leaders," said a state BJP leader.

According to sources, Nabin will hold an organisational meeting with newly appointed state BJP office-bearers, regional presidents, state morcha chiefs and district presidents, review the ongoing organisational programmes and guide them on future campaign programmes.

He will then meet Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, the two Deputy Chief Ministers, party MPs, MLAs and Legislative Council members at a five-star hotel and discuss the ongoing welfare schemes of the state government and coordination between the government and the party organisation. Immediately afterward, he will hold a meeting with the UP BJP core committee and later in the evening meet prominent personalities, said sources.

Randhawa meets Shah; denies buzz of rift in Congress

Express News Service
Chandigarh, July 3

CONGRESS MP Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa Friday denied speculation that his meeting with Union Home Minister Amit Shah carried any political undertone amid talk of a rift in his party. He insisted that his meeting with Shah was solely regarding Punjab's security and law-and-order challenges.

When asked by reporters to comment on the meeting held at the residence of former CM Charanjit Singh Channi Friday, he said, "It is worth reflecting on the fact that things should not have reached this stage. After holding so many meetings and still not getting satisfied is very unfortunate..."

In his meeting with Shah, Randhawa raised the issue of "deteriorating" law and order in the border state.

Randhawa later told reporters that he had written to PM Narendra Modi almost a month ago and raised the issue of "gangsters ruling the state, extortion, and Pak-sponsored narco-terrorism, especially in the border districts of Punjab".

Speaking to the media after the meeting, Randhawa said, "My meeting with Shah was completely non-political."

Reiterating his commitment to the Congress, he said, "I am performing my duties with complete honesty."

Punjab Congress row: 20 MLAs, former legislators turn up at Channi's residence

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, July 3

At least six party MLAs gathered at Channi's residence in Rupnagar, in a show of strength for the Jalandhar MP.

FACTIONS EMERGED in Punjab Congress Friday with more than 20 sitting and former MLAs throwing their weight behind former CM Charanjit Singh Channi for state unit chief after the party decided to retain Amrinder Singh Raja Warring for the post.

At least six party MLAs, several former legislators and many senior leaders of Punjab Congress gathered at Channi's residence in Morinda, Rupnagar, in a show of strength for the Jalandhar MP.

The development comes after the party's central leadership decided to retain Warring as the state unit chief. The announcement came on Wednesday, alongside the unveiling of the party's various committees for the 2027 Assembly polls.

Prominent attendees included former Deputy CM OP Soni, sitting and former MLAs such as Bharat Bhushan Ashu, Sukhbinder Singh Sukh Sarkaria, Rana Gurjeet Singh, Hardev Singh Laddi Sherowalia, Gurpreet Singh Kangar, Darshan Singh Brar, Harminder Singh Gill, Tarsem Singh DC, Lakhvir Singh Lakha, Inderbir Singh Bolaria, Dalvir Singh Khangura, and several others.

Several Congress leaders who spoke to the media openly rejected the high command's decision to retain Amrinder Singh Raja Warring as PPCC president and not appoint Channi. Senior Congress leaders, including MLA Tript Rajinder Singh Bajwa and former MP Mohammad Sadiq, said that any decision regarding the next course of action, including approaching the high command with a list of demands has been left with Channi. "Everyone has said that whatever Channi decides will be acceptable to all. He has been given all the authority. This is not a meeting of rebels. This is a meeting of Congress," said Mohd Sadiq.

Tripat Bajwa said the list of party appointments recently issued has come not as per the wishes of the people. "There is a feeling of disappointment and despondency. We are not against the high command... We have asked Channi to approach the high command again for reconsideration and put up the points so that a decision which is acceptable to all Congressmen is made," he said.

In an embarrassing development, even the newly appointed working president of the state unit, Sangat Singh Gilzian, who was not part of the meeting Friday, spoke out against the high command's list.

HC orders security for judge facing threats over lynching verdict

Ashish Shaji
New Delhi, July 3

OBSERVING THAT such activities "directly hamper the judicial independence" and "fearless working of judicial officers", the Madhya Pradesh High Court has taken cognizance of news reports on threats faced by a district court judge after she had convicted seven men in a 2022 lynching case.

The court directed the DGP and the Additional Chief Secretary/Principal Secretary (Home) to file a response on the steps being taken to book the miscreants. Justices Vivek Agarwal and Avanindra Kumar Singh also ordered police protection to Additional District and Sessions Judge Tabassum Khan.

"Our judicial officer cannot be threatened merely because he or she chooses to pass a particular order and that is not to the liking of a certain section of society," the order read.

Though the court was informed that protection has been extended, it directed the SP, Narmadapuram, to inform as to what steps have been taken to book the persons who have "created an atmosphere of threats to the judicial officer."

Judge Khan, posted in Narmadapuram district, had on June 12 sentenced seven men to life imprisonment for the lynching of truck driver Sheikh Lala Nazir Ahmed in August 2022 on suspicion of cow smuggling. In its judgment, the court held that the prosecution had proved beyond a reasonable doubt that the accused participated in the attack and observed that they had assaulted the victim with "extreme brutality". After the verdict, dramatic scenes unfolded outside the court as kin of the convicted men attempted to stop the police vehicle from taking the convicts to jail.

ASSAULTED IN 2023

Manipur MLA to be laid to rest four months after his death

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, July 3

OVER FOUR months after the death of Manipur MLA Vungzagin Valte, who was severely injured in a mob attack in Imphal in 2023, his final rites are set to be held in his family's home in Churachandpur on Saturday.

Valte (63) was a BJP leader, former minister and three-time MLA representing the Thanlon constituency. He was one of the 10 Kuki-Zomi MLAs in the state when the ethnic conflict erupted. The attack, on May 4, 2023, had left him with multiple fractures and requiring ventilator support. He died in a hospital in Gurgaon in February this year.

Once his body was brought back to Churachandpur, his family and the Zomi Council, representing eight tribes under the Zomi umbrella, decided to put the final rites on hold and move his remains to the morgue in Churachandpur Medical College. Among their demands was that a central agency take the investigation into his 2023 assault further.

A Zomi Council leader told *The Indian Express* that the decision to lay Valte to rest on Saturday was taken in line with the wishes of the family.

CENTRAL UNIVERSITY OF RAJASTHAN

nirf | Category-I University | QS ASIA 2026 | NAAC A++

CURAJ/R/F.176/Rectt./2026/5996 Date : 22.06.2026

Walk-in-Interview (Faculty Position)

Eligible candidates are invited for **contractual appointment** on the post of **Assistant Professor** in various Academic Departments.

The appointment will be made purely on contractual basis for a period upto last working day of the Academic Session 2026-27 or till further orders, whichever is earlier.

For more details, visit: www.curaj.ac.in

Registrar

No. Admin-12011(16)/2/2024-eoffice

Government of India
Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
Directorate General of Health Service
Central Drugs Standard Control Organization
(Drugs Section)

Ministry of Health and Family Welfare invites application from eligible candidates for filling up the post as mentioned below at Regional Drugs Testing Laboratory, Guwahati by Deputation (including short term contract). Interested candidates are requested to submit the application with full Bio-data to **Shri Pawan Kumar, Deputy Director (Admn.), Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO), FDA Bhawan, Kotla Road, New Delhi-110002** within 60 days from the date of publication of this advertisement in the Employment News.

2. For further details please visit CDSCO's website https://cdsco.gov.in.

Sl. No.	Name of the Post	Pay as per 7th CPC	No. of Post	Office for which the posts is filled up
1,	Scientific Officer	Pay level 10 of 7th CPC (Rs.56100-177500)	01	Regronal Drugs Testing Laboratory Guwahati

Sd/- Director (Admn)
C.D.S.C.O, Headquarter,
Directorate General of Health Services
Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, New Delhi 110002

CBC-17194/11/0011/2627

रजिस्ट्री सं.डीएल.-33004/99 REGE.NO. D.L.-33004/99

भारत का राजपत्र
The Gazette of India

सी.जी.-डी.एल.-अ.-27062026-273889
CG-DL-E-27062026-273889
असाधारण
EXTRAORDINARY
भाग II-खण्ड 3-उप-खण्ड (ii)
PART II-Section 3-Sub-section (ii)
प्राधिकार से प्रकाशित
PUBLISHED BY AUTHORITY

सं. 3258] नई दिल्ली, बृहस्पतिवार, जून 25, 2026/आषाढ़ 4, 1948
No.3258] NEW DELHI, THURSDAY, JUNE 25, 2026/ASHADHA 4, 1948

सड़क परिवहन और राजमार्ग मंत्रालय
अधिसूचना
नई दिल्ली, 24 जून, 2026

का.आ. 3392(अ).— केन्द्रीय सरकार राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग अधिनियम, 1956 (1956 का 48) (जिसे इसमें इसके पश्चात् उक्त अधिनियम कहा गया है) की धारा 3क की उपधारा (1) के अधीन जारी की गई भारत सरकार के सड़क परिवहन और राजमार्ग मंत्रालय की अधिसूचना संख्या का.आ. **994(अ)** तारीख **24 फरवरी 2026,** जो भारत के राजपत्र, असाधारण भाग II, खण्ड 3, उपखण्ड (ii) में प्रकाशित की गई थी, द्वारा उत्तर प्रदेश राज्य के **आगरा** जिले में **NH-321G** के **कि.मी. 0+000 से कि.मी. 51+600** में तक (**आगरा-जलेसर-एटा मार्ग**)(**सेक्शन-1**) के लिए भू-खण्ड के निर्माण, (चौड़ीकरण/दो/चार लेन बनाने आदि) अनुरक्षण, प्रबंधन और प्रचालन के लिए उस अधिसूचना से उपाबद्ध अनुसूची में विनिर्दिष्ट भूमि का अर्जन करने के अपने आशय की घोषणा की थी; और उक्त अधिसूचना का सार उक्त अधिनियम की धारा 3क की उपधारा (3) के अधीन तारीख **22 मार्च 2026** को ''**दैनिक जागरण (हिन्दी)**'' और ''**संडे एक्सप्रेस (अंग्रेजी)**'' दोनों में प्रकाशित किया गया था; और सक्षम प्राधिकारी को किसी व्यक्ति से कोई आक्षेप प्राप्त नहीं हुए हैं; और सक्षम प्राधिकारी ने उक्त अधिनियम की धारा 3घ की उपधारा (1) के अनुसरण में, केन्द्रीय सरकार को अपनी रिपोर्ट दे दी है;

अतः अब, केन्द्रीय सरकार, सक्षम प्राधिकारी की उक्त रिपोर्ट प्राप्त हो जाने पर और उक्त अधिनियम की धारा 3घ की उपधारा (1) द्वारा प्रदत्त शक्तियों का प्रयोग करते हुए, यह घोषणा करती है कि उक्त अनुसूची में विनिर्दिष्ट भूमि का पूर्वोक्त प्रयोजन के लिए अर्जन किया जाना चाहिए; और अब, केन्द्रीय सरकार, उक्त अधिनियम की धारा 3घ की उपधारा (2) के अनुसरण में यह घोषणा करती है कि इस अधिसूचना के राजपत्र में प्रकाशन पर, उक्त अनुसूची में विनिर्दिष्ट भूमि सभी विल्लंगमों से मुक्त होकर आत्यन्तिक रूप से केन्द्रीय सरकार में निहत हो जाएगी।

अनुसूची
उत्तर प्रदेश राज्य के आगरा जिले में NH-321G के कि.मी. 0+000 से कि.मी. 51+600 में तक (आगरा-जलेसर-एटा मार्ग) (सेक्शन-1) के लिए अर्जन की जाने वाली संरचना सहित अथवा संरचना रहित विवरण।

[फा.सं. CE-RO/LKO/NH-321G/LA/2021-22/3D2]
शेख अमीनखान, निदेशक

MINISTRY OF ROAD TRANSPORT AND HIGHWAYS
NOTIFICATION
New Delhi, the 24th June, 2026

S.O. 3392(E).—Whereas by the notification of the Government of India in the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways,number S.O. **994(E)** Dated **24 Februray 2026** published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part II, Section 3, Sub-section (ii) issued under sub-section (1) of section 3A of the National Highway Act, 1956 (48 of 1956) (hereinafter referred to as the said Act), the Central Government declared its intention to acquire the land specified in the Schedule annexed to the said notification for construction (widening/two /four lane etc.,) Maintenance, management and operation of **NH-321G** in the stretch of land from **Km. 0+000 to Km.51+600 in (Aagra-Jalesar- Etha Road) (Section-1)** in the District **Aagra** state of **Uttar Pradesh**

And whereas the substance of the said notification has been published in "**Dainik Jagaran (Hindi)**" And "**Sunday Express (English)**" both dated "**22 March 2026**", under sub-section (3) of section 3A of the said Act; And whereas no objection has been received from any person by the competent authority;

And whereas the Competent Authority has, in pursuance of sub-section (1) of section 3D of the said Act, submitted its report to the Central Government: So now The Central Government, on receipt of the said report of the competent authority, in exercise of the powers conferred by sub-section (1) of section 3D of the said Act, hereby declares that the land specified in the said Schedule should be acquired for the aforesaid purpose And now the Central Government, in pursuance of sub-section (2) of section 3D of the said Act, hereby declares that on the publication of this notification in the Official Gazette, the lands specified in the said Schedule shall, free from all encumbrances, vest absolutely in the Central Government .

SCHEDULE

Brief description of the land to be acquired, with or without structure, falling within the NH-321G in the stretch of land from Km. 0+000 to Km. 51+600 in (Aagra-Jalesar-Etha Road) (Section-1) in the District Aagra state of Uttar Pradesh.

[F. No. CE-RO/LKO/NH-321G/LA/2021-22/3D2]
SHAIKH AMINKHAN, Director

COLLEGE OF TECHNOLOGY AND ENGINEERING
MPUAT, UDAIPUR – 313001 (Rajasthan)

No.: CTAE/Estt./PG Admission/2026/2688 Date: 30-06-2026

PG ADMISSION 2026-27 NOTIFICATION

Applications are invited from eligible candidates for admission in full time M.Tech. / PhD programs in various branches of Engineering. Interested candidates should submit hard copy of their application forms along with all requisite documents (self-attested) on or before **27 July 2026** in the office of Dean, College of Technology and Engineering, MPUAT, Udaipur-313001 (Rajasthan). The eligibility conditions, seat matrix and other details related to admission can be seen on university or college websites **http://www.mpuat.ac.in** or **http://www.ctae.ac.in** . Application forms received in the office after the due date because of any reasons will not be entertained under any conditions.

DEAN, CTAE

PUBLIC NOTICE

FOR INVITING OBJECTIONS REGARDING CONTINUATION OF REGISTRATION OF THE AFFORDABLE GROUP HOUSING PROJECT NAMELY "THE SKYLINE"

(HARERA RC NO. 34 OF 2021) LOCATED AT SECTOR 106, URUGRAM BEING DEVELOPED BY M/S MRG CASTLE REALITY LLP

1. The above-mentioned project was registered with the RERA, Gurugram vide registration no. 34 of 2021 dated 20.07.2021 and the registration was valid up to 30.06.2025 and extension of registration was granted by RERA, Gurugram vide no. 15 of 2026 dated 10.06.2026 which was valid upto 29.06.2026.
2. The promoter has made an application dated 23.06.2026 with the request to the authority that instead of revoking the registration on its expiry, the authority may permit it to remain in force subject to such further terms and conditions as it thinks fit to impose in the interest of the allottees, and any such terms and conditions so imposed shall be binding upon the promoter.
3. The Authority is considering an application of the promoter to permit the continuation of the registration certificate under section 7(3) of the Act for this project to remain in force and hereby invite objections from the allottees in particular and any other concerned persons in general in this regard.
4. Those objections shall be filed in the registry of the Authority before 17.07.2026 and appear in the Authority on 20.07.2026 at 11.00 AM for considering the objections received, failing with the Authority will consider present application for continuation of the registration under section 7(3) of the Act.

Given under the approval of the Authority and its seal.

Secretary,
Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram

Dated: 04.07.2026

पूर्वोत्तर आयुर्वेद एवं होम्योपैथी संस्थान
NORTH EASTERN INSTITUTE OF AYURVEDA & HOMOEOPATHY
(भारत सरकार, आयुष मंत्रालय के अधीन एक स्वायत्त संस्थान)
(An Autonomous Institute under the Ministry of Ayush, Govt. of India)
माउडियाँडियाँ, शिलांग, मेघालय- 793018
Mawdiangdiang, Shillong, Meghalaya – 793018

सं. Advt. No, EST-16/1/2025-Administration Division/H-673

रिक्ति सूचना/VACANCY NOTICE

पूर्वोत्तर आयुर्वेद एवं होम्योपैथी संस्थान (पू.आ.हो.सं), शिलांग में प्रतिनियुक्ति / सीधी भर्ती के आधार पर विभिन्न शिक्षण पदों को भरने हेतु आवेदन आमंत्रित करता है

North Eastern Institute of Ayurveda & Homoeopathy (NEIAH), Shillong is inviting applications for various teaching posts to be filled up by Deputation/Direct Recruitment.

Note:

योग्यता, अनुभव, आरक्षण, आवेदन का निर्धारित प्रारूप, अपेक्षित शुल्क तथा अन्य सामान्य शर्तों के संबंध में विस्तृत जानकारी हेतु इच्छुक एवं पात्र अभ्यर्थियों को संस्थान की वेबसाइट **www.neiah.nic.in** का अवलोकन करने की सलाह दी जाती है।

For details of qualifications, experience, reservation, prescribed format of application, requisite fee and other general conditions, interested and eligible candidates are advised to visit Institute website www.neiah.nic.in

2. आवेदन प्रस्तुत करने की अंतिम तिथि रोजगार समाचार (**Employment News**) में विज्ञापन के प्रकाशन की तिथि से 45 दिन होगी।

Closing date for submission of application will be 45 days from the date of publication of Advertisement in the Employment News.

Sd/-
उप निदेशक (प्रशा.) / Dy. Director (Admn)
पू.आ.हो.सं. शिलांग/ NEIAH, Shillong

CBC- 17217/11/0003/2627

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL

Steady Support

VICE-PRESIDENT C P Radhakrishnan struck a light-hearted note while recalling the early days of RSS publications at an event marking 80 years of the Organiser on Friday. He said that for the longest time, almost every RSS publication had just one advertiser — Mangalore Ganesh Beedi. Expressing gratitude to the beedi-manufacturing firm for backing the Sangh, Radhakrishnan quipped that the advertisement was aimed at people who were hardly its customers, as he had "rarely seen a swayamsevak smoking". The company's contribution was made "in the interest of the nation".

Big Feast

AS PART of the Central Public Works Department's 172nd annual day celebrations on July 12, the organisation is planning a "bara khana" or a lunch to felicitate workers and officials. It is learnt that the rank and file of CPWD, up to the head of the department, will dine together. The gatherings will be held at multiple venues across the country, including Sunder Nursery in Delhi. The menu includes *puri, chhole, aloo sabzi,* rice and *halwa*.

Reshuffle buzz

AMID SPECULATION of a possible reshuffle in the Union Council of Ministers, all activities at the BJP headquarters are being closely watched by partymen across the country. Recently, when two Union ministers visited the BJP office, their names were immediately added to the list of leaders likely to be dropped from the Cabinet. Party leaders, however, insisted that the ministers — one from Jharkhand and the other from Karnataka — visited the office for a routine meeting with BJP president Nitin Nabin.

MEA: India's position on IWT consistent

New Delhi: India's position on the Indus Waters Treaty is consistent and the Treaty stands in abeyance in response to Pakistan's continued support for cross-border terrorism, the MEA said Friday. "On the IWT, I would reiterate what we have said earlier as well. India's position on the Indus Waters Treaty is consistent," MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said while replying to a question on a seminar on the Treaty in Islamabad. **PTI**

WILL BOOST COMBAT READINESS OF FORCES

Defence acquisition proposals worth Rs 52,000 crore cleared

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, July 3

THE DEFENCE Acquisition Council (DAC) on Friday cleared a range of acquisition proposals worth about Rs 52,000 crore for the Armed Forces.

The proposals include Anti-Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (Anti-UAV) Electronic Warfare System named 'Akash Tarang', Medium Range Surface-to-Air Missile (MRSAM) Weapon System, Very Short Range Air Defence System (VSHORADS), Jet-Based Kamikaze Drone System for the Army, Naval Shipborne Unmanned Aerial System (NSUAS) for the Navy and Fixed-Wing Based High Altitude Pseudo Satellite (FW-HAPS) for the Indian Air Force, among others.

The DAC is the key defence body that grants Acceptance of Necessity (AoN) on all big-ticket capital procurements. The AoN is the first step in the defence procurement process. However, obtaining an AoN does not always lead to a final order.

The DAC meeting on Friday, under the chairmanship of Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, took place after three months. The last DAC meeting was held in March this year, when a proposal to procure five additional S-400 Long Range Surface-to-Air Missile Systems from Russia was cleared.

The Ministry of Defence said the proposals to procure Man Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile (MPATGM) Systems and Active Protection Systems for Tanks have also been cleared for the Army. The MPATGM will help counter the adversary's mechanised threats; the MRSAM system will provide medium-range air defence against a variety of stand-off aerial threats; and the V-SHORADS with multi-spectral sensing will enhance counter-measure resilience and effectiveness of the Army, the statement noted.

'Akash Tarang', it said, will provide effective anti-UAV protection to the Army Formations.

Additionally, the Active Protection System would improve the defence mechanism of tanks and enhance their survivability, and the Jet-Based Kamikaze Drones would provide better electronic warfare capability with greater lethality and survivability while also being cost-effective.

The DAC also granted AoN for the procurement of Multi-Influence Ground Mine (MIGM), Naval Shipborne Unmanned Aerial System (NSUAS) and the setting up of Land-Based Testing Facility (LBTF) for Electric Propulsion System.

The MIGM will deny freedom of manoeuvre to the adversary. The NSUAS, equipped with advanced sensors, will enhance situational awareness of the Indian Navy. The LBTF will meet the testing requirements for motors and associated propulsion systems of the Indian Naval assets.

For the Indian Air Force, the procurement of FW-HAPS was approved among other proposals. The FW-HAPS will carry out persistent intelligence, surveillance and reconnaissance, telecommunication and remote sensing for the IAF, the statement noted.

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh with the new Chief of Army Staff, General Dhiraj Seth, in New Delhi on Thursday. PTI

Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

E. EXPLAINED

Multi-domain operations

THE LATEST DAC nod to a series of acquisitions reflects the military's need to procure modern and new technology systems to boost its combat capabilities, in line with the way India plans its future multi-domain operations. However, the journey from the DAC nod to an actual induction is a long process.

Free Whatsapp Channel https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

Anticipatory bail plea rejected, DMK MLA arrested for remarks on Tamil Nadu CM

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, July 3

FORMER MINISTER and sitting DMK MLA Anitha R Radhakrishnan was arrested by the Thoothukudi police on Friday after the Madras High Court refused to grant him anticipatory bail in a case registered over his alleged derogatory remarks against Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay.

Radhakrishnan, who represents Tiruchendur constituency and serves as the DMK's South District Secretary in Thoothukudi, was arrested by Authoor police shortly after the court dismissed his plea. Police sources said he was inspecting records at the Authoor Town Panchayat when a team led by Authoor Police Inspector and team apprehended him. He was later taken to the office of the Thoothukudi Superintendent of Police, where Additional Superintendent of Police Arumugam questioned him.

The case was registered by Authoor police on June 23, based on a complaint lodged by TVK's Authoor Urban Secretary S Selvam. The complaint alleged that Radhakrishnan had made defamatory and provocative remarks against Chief Minister Vijay while addressing a DMK public meeting at Authoor on June 20. The police booked him under Sections 352, dealing with intentional insult with intent to provoke breach of peace, and 353(2), relating to statements made with intent to create enmity, hatred or ill will between different groups, of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

During the speech, Radhakrishnan allegedly mocked the chief minister's conduct in the Assembly and made a personal remark linking him to his past association with an actress, suggesting that he appeared uncomfortable in public office and happier in his earlier private life.

Anitha R Radhakrishnan represents Tiruchendur constituency

Earlier in the day, Justice G K Ilanthiraiyan of the Madras High Court dismissed Radhakrishnan's anticipatory bail petition after reading the transcript of his speech, produced by the prosecution. The judge expressed displeasure over the remarks and asked how a former Minister and sitting MLA could use such disparaging language against an elected Chief Minister.

"He is not a layman. Should he not give respect to the post of the Chief Minister?" the judge observed during the hearing.

Radhakrishnan's counsel argued that even if the speech was disparaging, it did not attract the offences invoked by the police. He contended that the remarks did not prima facie show any intent to create enmity between groups.

The government counsel opposed the plea, saying the remarks were highly objectionable and could have led to a clash between DMK and ruling TVK cadres had the police not acted promptly after the public meeting.

Following the arrest, DMK cadres led by Corporation Mayor Jegan Periyasamy staged a protest outside the SP office. Another group blocked a road at Authoor and argued with police personnel, condemning the police action against the sitting MLA.

The TMC office in Kolkata. EXPRESS

Rebel TMC faction takes over party office in Kolkata

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, July 3

A DAY after the rebel Trinamool Congress (TMC) faction met the Election Commission of India (ECI) in New Delhi, the bloc, led by Leader of the Opposition in West Bengal Assembly Ritabrata Banerjee, took possession of the state party office in Kolkata, claiming they are the "real Trinamool". They also hung a banner in front of the office mentioning Arup Roy as the party chairman instead of Mamata Banerjee.

The building has served as the party office since 2022, when the TMC shifted there after its original office adjacent to the EM Bypass was taken up for reconstruction.

By moving into the premises, the dissidents sought to reinforce their claim to organisational legitimacy amid an escalating battle with the Mamata Banerjee-led faction.

Accompanied by senior leaders, including Firhad Hakim, Javed Khan, Sandipan Saha and Akhruzzaman, Ritabrata visited the office and held a meeting there.

At the time, Mamata-led faction leader and former minister Chandrima Bhattacharya was there but after Ritabrata and others entered the premises, she left.

"We are the real Trinamool Congress and this office belongs to the Trinamool Congress. We already spoke to the house owner. This is our party office and it will remain our party office. The key of the main gate lock will be with us. I always used to come to this office. However, during the elections, I did not come here for many days. After a long time, I came here. This is nothing unusual," Akhrujjaman said.

Earlier, house owner of Trinamool Bhavan, Monotosh Saha had alleged that the rent agreement with the TMC had ended in 2025. Even after a year had passed, TMC did not vacate the house.

He also alleged that after the election results were announced, he had asked the party leaders to vacate the building. However, he alleged that there was no response from the party.

EXPRESS special

As Kishor eyes debut from Nitin Nabin seat, why it may make or break JSP

Santosh Singh
Patna, July 3

EIGHT MONTHS after the Jan Suraaj Party (JSP) failed to open its account in the Bihar Assembly elections, party founder Prashant Kishor is likely to make his electoral debut in the Bankipur Assembly bypoll to be held on July 30.

According to JSP insiders, Kishor, who did not contest a seat in his party's first Assembly poll battle in November 2025, is now set to contest the prestigious Bankipur constituency in Bihar, which was vacated by BJP national president Nitin Nabin.

The Bankipur seat falls within Patna, which has been won by the BJP in consecutive elections since 1995. The five-time Bankipur MLA Nabin resigned from the seat earlier this year in the wake of his elevation as the BJP president, succeeding J P Nadda, and his subsequent election to the Rajya Sabha.

Given the high-profile nature of the seat, the ruling BJP is expected to pull out all the stops to retain its bastion, setting up a highly charged bypoll battle in the state capital.

While the JSP's core committee will make a formal announcement about its Bankipur candidate on July 5, sources said the party top brass was pushing for Kishor's candidature.

JSP state president Manoj Bharati told reporters on Thursday: "The Jan Suraaj Party has decided to field a candidate in the Bankipur Assembly by-election. The formal announcement will be made on July 5 following a meeting of the party's core committee. Distressed by the BJP's misgovernance, the people of Bankipur are demanding that Prashant Kishor ji contest the election from here. Party leaders and workers share this sentiment for the architect of our campaign."

If Prashant Kishor contests from Bankipur, his personal political capital will be on the line

While the BJP has yet to name its candidate, insiders said Neel Ranjan Ghosh — a veteran party worker considered close to Nabin — is the front-runner among the party hopefuls.

The Opposition Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD)-led Mahagathbandhan alliance has also not announced its candidate for the seat so far.

For the BJP, Bankipur has been a party stronghold since 1995, held first by Navin Kishore Prasad Sinha and later by his son Nitin Nabin.

The bypoll would serve as the first major electoral test for Samrat Choudhary since he took over as the Bihar Chief Minister, replacing Nitish Kumar in April. A loss, or even a narrowed victory margin, would severely dent his political authority and give the Opposition fresh ammunition to challenge his leadership.

"Since Nitin Nabin is now the BJP national president, losing his home turf immediately after his elevation would be an embarrassing psychological blow to the party at the national level," said a senior BJP leader.

Patna's urban pockets — specifically Bankipur's dominant Kayastha voting bloc and trader groups — form the bedrock of the BJP's urban identity in Bihar. The party needs to prove that its core urban voters remain entirely loyal following the change of the guard in the state.

For Prashant Kishor and his JSP, the bypoll would be a critical shot at political comeback.

In the Bihar elections, the party had aggressively fielded candidates in 238 of the state's 243 seats but drew a blank, walking away with just 3.4% vote share.

Bankipur represents an immediate chance to change the narrative around the party from being "just hype" to a "possible alternative".

If Kishor contests the seat, his personal political capital will be on the line. He has called this bypoll a "referendum on the backdoor entry of Samrat Choudhary as CM". If Kishor runs and wins — or even finishes a strong second by fracturing the BJP's base — it could establish the JSP as a player in state politics. A poor showing, however, may relegate the party to the margins in Bihar's already crowded political landscape.

MP: BJP youth leader booked for 'sexually harassing' doctor

Express News Service
Bhopal, July 3

A BJP Yuva Morcha state executive member has been booked for allegedly sexually harassing a woman doctor inside a medical college in Madhya Pradesh's Sagar district and threatening to shoot her after she resisted his advances, triggering protests by doctors and a warning of a statewide strike if he is not arrested.

The Yuva Morcha man, Anil Srivastava, was among two booked by Sagar police under multiple provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS). Police said searches are underway to arrest both accused.

According to the complainant, she was attending to a poisoning case when one of the accused allegedly touched her inappropriately. "I was treating a poisoning patient when he touched me inappropriately. When other hospital staff and I objected, they threatened us, saying, '*goli maar denge* (we will shoot)'," she alleged. She said when she warned them of a police complaint, the accused told the staff to "do whatever you want" before fleeing.

ASP Narendra Solanki said an FIR had been registered based on the doctor's complaint. "Considering the seriousness of the allegations, efforts are being made to arrest both accused at the earliest."

The incident sparked protests by doctors and nursing staff, who suspended work and blocked the main gate to the medical college, disrupting healthcare services for hours. They alleged that despite informing police and the hospital administration immediately after the incident, the accused managed to leave the premises before they could be detained.

The Chandigarh paradox: Why three states fight for a city that remains above the fray

NORTHERN LIGHTS

BY MANRAJ GREWAL SHARMA

A WEEKLY DISPATCH ON THE POLITICS AND IDEAS SHAPING NORTH INDIA

LAST WEEK, Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu was in Chandigarh on a mission: he met Punjab Governor and Chandigarh Administrator Gulab Chand Kataria to seek a 7.19% share in the UT, arguing that Himachal, carved out of the erstwhile Punjab in 1966, was entitled to it as a successor state.

Earlier this year, Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann made Chandigarh the centerpiece of his Republic Day address, reiterating that Punjab would ensure complete control over the city.

This is a well-trodden arena. Four years ago, after Union Home Minister Amit Shah announced that the Central civil service rules will be implemented for all employees under Chandigarh Administration, replacing Punjab's, the AAP government convened a special Assembly session to pass a resolution seeking the city's immediate transfer. Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini maintains that Chandigarh remains their joint capital, while pushing for land to build his state's separate Assembly building in the city.

Arc of a contested city

Six decades after it became the joint capital of Punjab and Haryana, Chandigarh continues to be hotly contested. Yet, while governments continue to debate its ownership, the city itself has quietly evolved into something larger than a territorial prize.

Conceived after Partition as Punjab's replacement for Lahore, Chandigarh became Independent India's first planned city, designed from scratch by Swiss-French architect Le Corbusier. Its Capitol Complex, comprising the Assembly, Secretariat and High Court, now enjoys the UNESCO World Heritage status and has been among India's most significant architectural achievements.

Chandigarh's political future, however, was never settled. When Punjab was reorganised on the linguistic lines in 1966 into Punjab, Haryana and the hill areas that later became Himachal Pradesh, Chandigarh was designated a UT and made the joint capital of Punjab and Haryana as an interim arrangement.

In 1970, then Prime Minister Indira Gandhi announced that Chandigarh would be transferred to Punjab while Haryana would receive the Fazilka tehsil, or equivalent territory, along with financial assistance to build a new capital. The proposal never took off.

Fifteen years later, the Rajiv-Longowal Accord revived the promise, fixing January 26, 1986, as the date for Chandigarh's transfer to Punjab after the exchange of certain Hindi-speaking areas. Militancy intervened, Sant Harchand Singh Longowal was assassinated, and the accord remained unimplemented.

That has not stopped successive governments from reviving the issue whenever political circumstances demand it. The city, meanwhile, has moved on.

Today it forms the nucleus of the Tricity, a term coined by former Punjab Governor V P Singh Badnore, nestled between Mohali in Punjab and Panchkula in Haryana. People live in one city, work in another and socialise across all three.

Politically too, the region reflects India's diversity: the AAP governs nearby Mohali, Chandigarh has a Congress MP but a BJP-dominated Municipal Corporation, while Panchkula is represented by the BJP. Civic elections here are often viewed as an early indicator of political trends in Punjab.

Chandigarh has also developed a social character unlike that of most state capitals. Built over 22 villages of Punjab and sprawling mango orchards, it drew refugees, government officials, lawyers, professionals and entrepreneurs from across India.

Justice M S Liberhan, who headed the Commission probing the demolition of the Babri Masjid, is among Chandigarh's few prominent residents whose family belongs to one of its original villages. Industrialist Rajendra K Saboo, later the first Indian president of Rotary International, recalls arriving from Kolkata as a 25-year-old to meet then Punjab CM Partap Singh Kairon, who immediately resized an industrial plot to meet the requirements of his German collaborators.

Soul of Chandigarh

The city's distinctive personality owes much to its first Chief Commissioner, M S Randhawa, who earned the sobriquet "Punjab's sixth river".

Apart from establishing the Rose Garden and starting the Government Museum and Art Gallery with nearly 2,000 Pahari miniature paintings acquired from erstwhile Himachal royals, he personally supervised the planting and watering of amaltas, gulmohar, jacaranda and other trees that make the city so beautiful. Even today, many longtime residents can identify a sector simply by the trees lining its avenues.

At 94, Shivdatt Sharma, one of the few surviving members of Le Corbusier's team, continues to defend the city's original vision. A Partition refugee from Lahore who later trained as an architect, Sharma insists that Chandigarh's founding creed will endure even though the city planned for five lakh people, now houses over 12 lakh residents.

Ironically, the biggest battle over Chandigarh today is not about which state should own it but whether it can preserve the core principles of sun, space and greenery that make it exceptional. Proposals for high-rise development in Manimajra and sectors south of Sector 30 have revived concerns about altering Le Corbusier's low-rise vision. The Punjab and Haryana High Court recently stalled the proposed flyover at Tribune Chowk, while lawyers successfully opposed the shifting of the High Court from the Capitol Complex to Sarangpur.

As Punjab heads to another Assembly election in about eight months, leaders cutting across party lines would once again use Chandigarh as an emotional bargaining chip to sway voters. The tragedy is that those shouting the loudest to stake claim to the city are the least equipped to preserve it. Sometimes, true wisdom lies not in possession, but in cherishing the city's soul.

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सत्यमेव जयते

Ministry of Civil Aviation
Government of India

A New Decade of Regional Air Connectivity Begins

Shri Narendra Modi
Hon'ble Prime Minister

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By

Shri Narendra Modi
Hon'ble Prime Minister

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● WEB EXCLUSIVE
America at 250: What exactly are we celebrating?
— By Jonah Blank
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Those who would give up essential liberty to purchase a little temporary safety, deserve neither liberty nor safety.
— Benjamin Franklin

The Indian EXPRESS
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RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Thank you, Justice Jamdar

WHY CAN'T citizens protest government decisions and raise slogans? The police are servants of the people, not of top government functionaries. That question and that statement by a single-judge bench of Bombay High Court need to be celebrated. In a way, in setting aside the externment order issued by Mumbai Police against a political activist, by pointing out that in the absence of evidence that the protester posed a danger to public safety or property, the order affected his constitutionally guaranteed fundamental rights, Justice Madhav J Jamdar was only abiding by the Constitution, in letter and spirit, in their fullest form. After all, the judiciary is the custodian of citizen freedoms and a bulwark against their encroachment if and when the state becomes overreaching. And yet, Justice Jamdar's order on Thursday is also extraordinary. These are times when amid rising polarisation and receding common ground, powerful governments seek to subdue institutions and dominate spaces. They label and criminalise dissent and crack down on political opponents. In the name of the people, they create an architecture of distrust of the citizen. They use democratic instruments to shrink democratic spaces. In times like these, the Bombay High Court has asked a powerful question and spoken a truth to democracy.

The petitioner in the case, Saeed Ahmad Abdul Wahid Chaudhary, general secretary of the Social Democratic Party of India, had organised or participated in protests, allegedly without police permission, against the BJP-led government's decisions on the CAA/NRC, Babri Masjid and sealing at the Gyanvapi mosque. These tangled issues have touched off concerns, especially vis-à-vis the rights of minorities. They call for conversations that make space for citizens to ask difficult questions and express grievances — not for the state to wield extraordinary legal tools against them to send out a chilling message and strip them of their freedom and dignity. When Justice Jamdar asks the police if citizens are being made "slaves of government" by slapping cases for opposing government decisions, he points to the danger that comes from institutions bending to power, smudging lines that separate them and imperilling spaces for checks and balances to kick in.

Justice Jamdar's order will, hopefully, strike echoes in the system. The state must not challenge it. This is an opportunity to correct course. The relief given to an activist by a judge in Mumbai could become a moment for reflection, an act of redeeming. But even if cynicism triumphs and this is a mere flash in the judicial pan, it did shine very bright. Thank you, Justice Jamdar.

Happy birthday, America, no more an only child

BIRTHDAYS, FOR people and nations, are an occasion for celebration, for pageantry that would appear gauche on most other days. Add to that a chief executive who has doubled down on jingoistic nationalism and the triumphalism surrounding the United States of America's 250th Independence Day is understandable. Even so, the Ultimate Fighting Championship event on the White House lawns last month that carried the unsubtle symbolism of a Roman emperor presiding over a gladiatorial contest was a bit much. A major anniversary, however, is also an occasion for major reflection. While much about America remains exceptional, in a changing world the self-conception of its exceptionalism might require revision.

The philosophical and political underpinnings of US success, and the American model, can be found in the Declaration of Independence and the country's constitution. "Life, liberty and the pursuit of happiness" foregrounds the individual, and the optimism of what was seen by colonial settlers as a "new world". It encompasses both the American dream and its hypocrisies and exploitations — vis-à-vis indigenous populations, Black people, and migrants. The idea of natural rights, of inalienable freedoms, found its greatest expression in the US. The historic move away from constraining feudalism and an embrace of earned wealth and success laid the foundations for its knowledge economy, innovation, military power and even Hollywood. The latter, through cinema, TV and now OTT, continues to determine the cultural vocabulary of a significant chunk of the world population. US oligarchs control the latest industries and innovation. And yet, all is not well with the world's oldest democracy.

Donald Trump is seen by his many critics as undermining the foundations on which the American story was built — from its universities and free trade, to its openness and institutions. The question is whether he is the architect of this erosion or its symptom. Since the fall of communism in Europe and the end of the Cold War, the US has seen itself as the lone superpower — not just in terms of its economy or military, but also in terms of values. The "end of history", though, turned out to be short-lived. China, authoritarianism intact, has emerged as the world's factory and a competitor, in no small part thanks to US businesses and policies. Middle powers like India, Brazil, Australia are making their mark, on their own terms. At 250, America is no longer an only child. That can't be wished away by nostalgia or celebration.

When peak romance meets the law's long arm

WHAT KAREN Carpenter sang about in 1972, Angela Nikolau and Ivan Beerkus embodied this week: Being so in love that they were "on top of the world, looking down on creation". The Russian daredevil duo has gone viral for scaling the Empire State Building in New York City, where he went down on one knee and put a ring on her perfectly manicured fingers. The proposal was photographed and shared with their 2 million followers.

The stunt was the culmination of a decade-long romance that has played out across countries and skyscrapers, from the 1,957-ft Goldin Finance 117 in China to the 2,227-ft Merdeka 118 in Malaysia. It was also, perhaps inadvertently, the encapsulation of what it could feel like to be in love: Euphoric and vertiginous, complete with the conviction that there is no force on Earth that can bring one down. Yet, the high is inevitably followed by the crashing low.

The climb to the top of the Empire State Building, done with neither safety gear nor permission, was illegal. Among the many charges that the NYPD has slapped on the couple are reckless endangerment, criminal mischief, criminal trespass and disorderly conduct. So far, Nikolau and Beerkus have refused to let the prosecutorial instincts of the state dampen their romance, kissing for the cameras after leaving the courthouse where they were arraigned. Like other lovers before them, they may discover that even the most soaring romance can only defy gravity for so long.

At 250, the US can still reinvent itself — and the world

C RAJA MOHAN

AS AMERICA turns 250, much in Washington's current politics distracts Indian attention — Donald Trump's antics in capturing the historic moment for personal glory, his diplomatic style that breaks from protocol, disputes on tariffs and technology, America's new dalliance with the Pakistan army, and the anxiety in Delhi at the prospect of a US-China condominium in Asia. But major anniversaries demand a longer view. For Indians trying to understand the future of the US, the more important story lies beneath the unending political noise from Washington: The repeated reinvention of American capitalism. That process has shaped not only America's domestic evolution but also the international order it has led for much of the past century.

In reflecting on the American revolution, we must also consider the other, intellectual revolution that occurred in 1776. While Britain's 13 North American colonies proclaimed their independence, Adam Smith published *The Wealth of Nations*, which laid the intellectual foundations of modern capitalism. Over the next 250 years, the two evolved together. America's greatest contribution to the modern world has not only been its leadership of capitalist development, but also its extraordinary capacity to reinvent it. Every reinvention transformed the nature of production at home, reconfigured US politics, and restructured the international system.

In the 19th century, factories, railroads and mechanised production transformed an agrarian republic into the world's leading industrial economy. Capital, machines and labour were brought together on an unprecedented scale. Productivity soared, cities expanded, and American industry became the foundation of national power.

The second reinvention arrived in the early 20th century with Frederick Winslow Taylor's scientific management and Henry Ford's moving assembly line reorganising work itself. Charlie Chaplin captured both the brilliance and the absurdity of this new industrial order in *Modern Times*. His unforgettable image of a worker swallowed by the assembly line remains one of the sharpest commentaries on modern capitalism. Fordism produced mass prosperity, but it also demanded that human beings adapt themselves to the rhythm of machines.

The third reinvention took American capitalism beyond US shores. Advances in container shipping, telecommunications and information technology allowed production to be fragmented across national borders and distant continents. American firms increasingly specialised in technological innovation, finance, branding and design while manufacturing shifted to lower-cost locations across Asia. The resulting global value chains defined a new era of capitalism. They also transformed China into the world's manufacturing powerhouse, even as American companies retained control over many of the technologies, finance and intellectual property that governed the system.

Today, America is embarking on a fourth reinvention — techno-capitalism. AI, advanced semiconductors, cloud computing, biotechnology and humanoid robotics are converging to create a new production system. The ambition is no longer to make workers more productive. It is increasingly to reduce dependence on human labour itself. Anthropic's Claude AI and Tesla's Optimus humanoid robot have become the most visible symbol of this transformation, but they represent a much broader technological ecosystem. Combined with recursive self-improvement, the emerging AI systems promise to reshape manufacturing, logistics, healthcare, and many other sectors. With proclamations that Artificial General Intelligence (AGI) and Artificial Super Intelligence (ASI) are not far away, the future could be here much faster than many imagine.

The new technologies change the very character of capitalism. Industrial capitalism depended on labour. Globalised capitalism depended on moving production to where labour was cheapest. Techno-capitalism depends increasingly on algorithms, computing power, data and intelligent machines. It also involves building massive new infrastructure within the US. Wealth now flows less from employing large and cheap workforces than from owning the technologies that can substitute for them.

Left-wing historians in the US have argued that technological revolutions do not merely transform capitalism; they are shaped by capitalism itself. That insight is especially relevant today. The age of AI will not simply produce new technologies. It is intensifying already heavy concentrations of economic power. Political institutions are nowhere near limiting their reach and power.

But efforts are on, if at a nascent stage. Every reinvention of capitalism has eventually produced a recasting of politics. The rise of giant industrial trusts produced the "progressive era" and antitrust legislation at the turn of the 20th century. The Great Depression produced the New Deal and a new social compact between capital and labour. The digital revolution has revived concerns over monopoly and market concentration. If Lina Maliha Khan led the legal battle against tech platforms as the chair of the Federal Trade Commission under the Biden Administration, sections of the MAGA movement are now revolting against the excessive adoption of AI.

AI and robotics are reopening familiar questions in unfamiliar forms: Who owns the machines, who captures the enormous productivity they generate, how should that new wealth be distributed, and what obligations does capital owe to society? The answers will shape the future of the American republic and rebalance the relationship between innovation, capital and society. The consequences of techno-capitalism will not stop at America's shores. Every previous iteration of American capitalism has reshaped the international system. Industrial capitalism in a massive continental state made the US a superpower. Fordism underpinned its global leadership after World War II. Globalisation spread American capital, technology and finance across the world. Techno-capitalism promises another global reordering — by redistributing economic and military power and transforming global institutions.

The US at 250 is deeply divided at home and at odds with itself. The rise of Trump is indeed the visible manifestation of it. But American history cautions us against writing off a republic that has repeatedly reinvented both its capitalism and the politics needed to govern it at home and lead it abroad. The age of AI is unlikely to be different.

> The consequences of techno-capitalism will not stop at America's shores. Every previous iteration of American capitalism has reshaped the international system

The writer is contributing editor on international affairs for The Indian Express. *He is distinguished professor at the Motwani-Jadeja Institute of American Studies, Jindal Global University and Korea Foundation Chair on Asian Geopolitics at the Council on Strategic and Defence Research*

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Claims of Track 2 diplomacy with Pakistan are fake

RAM RAJYA
BY RAM MADHAV

MILITARY AND intelligence agencies often deploy a tactic called PSYOP — structured disinformation campaigns aimed at creating suspicion and confusion in enemy ranks. Recent propaganda about a fictitious Track 2 dialogue between India and Pakistan at Colombo appears to be a classic example of one such PSYOP unleashed by interested parties. It was lapped up by sections of the media in India, without checking the story's veracity.

A prestigious London-based think tank has been hosting an annual South Asia conference for more than a decade, in which scholars, former diplomats, military and intelligence agency veterans, and occasionally politicians and serving officials from countries in South Asia and beyond participate. Those conferences are like any other academic events hosted by think tanks.

As Indian foreign secretary Vikram Misri has clarified, they are not part of Track 2 diplomacy. The latter is a bilateral dialogue track that has the tacit approval of the governments and doesn't involve half-a-dozen countries. The conference in Colombo in the news was a structured event with the participation of representatives from the US, the UK, Sri Lanka, Pakistan, Afghanistan and India. I addressed one session and left.

While the Pakistani side seemed eager for a formal engagement with India, that sentiment wasn't reciprocated. The reasons were unambiguous. Prime Minister Narendra Modi broke a six-year-long diplomatic freeze by inviting his Pakistan counterpart, Nawaz Sharif, to his oath-taking ceremony in 2014. On an impromptu visit to Lahore a year later, he extended an olive branch to Pakistan. But our neighbour responded with the Uri and Pulwama terror attacks. Pakistan ended up paying a heavy price when the Modi government declared curtains down on most forms of direct engagement with Islamabad.

India's refusal to engage frustrates Pakistan. Islamabad feels belittled when India engages with several other countries but discards its overtures. Under Modi's leadership, India has joined the big leagues and is no longer interested in being re-hyphenated with its failed western neighbour. The Pahalgam terror attack, in contrast, demonstrated that there is no change in Pakistan's policy of using terrorism as a state instrument against India. After the Pahalgam terror attack, India launched Operation Sindoor and successfully took out terrorist camps deep inside Pakistani territory. Modi declared that such a response would be the "new normal" for India in dealing with Pakistan — this holds even now.

In October last year, Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif claimed at the UNGA that he wanted to "win peace" with India. But on-ground experience proves otherwise. There have been no major terror attacks in the country after Pahalgam. But the credit for that goes to the counter-terror operations by India's security and intelligence establishment.

Pakistan continues to be a hotbed of global terror infrastructure. Saifullah Kasuri, commander of Lashkar-e-Taiba and the mastermind of the Pahalgam attack, continues to roam freely and issues repeated threats that his outfit "would never back down from the Kashmir mission".

There were at least five attempts last year to infiltrate terrorists from across the border — they were foiled by our security forces, who killed eight terrorists. In other operations, 13 more terrorists were neutralised. Two apprehended terrorists revealed that their handlers in Pakistan had directed them to stay on for a prolonged period, radicalise the youth and induct them into the terror ranks. Magazines like TRR (*The Revolutionary Resurgence*) and ZUV (*The Soul of Resistance*), run by terror outfits whose IP addresses have been tracked to Pakistan by Indian agencies, spread anti-India propaganda and promote separatist narratives in Kashmir.

After brokering an unstable truce between America and Iran, Pakistan is seeking to project itself as a champion of peace. India has seen its true colours. Its message at all forums — including Colombo — has been that "talks and terrorism cannot go together".

> India's refusal to engage frustrates Pakistan. Islamabad feels belittled when India engages with several other countries but discards its overtures

The writer, president, India Foundation, is with the BJP

Europe must rethink how it will live with heat

POOJA RAMAMURTHI

IN 2003, when a record-breaking heatwave hit Europe, several countries rushed to create national and city-level action plans. These were meant to be emergency responses to "once-in-a-generation" extreme weather events. Two decades later, high summer temperatures are no longer an anomaly in Europe. Over the past five years, all summers but one have seen severe heatwaves. The science is clear: Increasing carbon emissions are causing weather patterns to change, with Europe being the fastest-warming region. Heat stress has had repercussions for health, infrastructure and labour productivity. Estimates predict an excess of 2,000 deaths in Europe this summer. Railways have been disrupted and roads have melted. Germany and the UK have issued advisories to avoid non-essential travel. European heat action plans remain largely geared towards protecting people rather than ensuring that society continues functioning. Will Europe move towards seeing heatwaves as a broader infrastructure, productivity and agricultural issue?

Espoused by far-right politicians like Marine Le Pen, there are calls for Europe to become an "air-conditioned" society. AC penetration remains low, with only one in five households owning one. There has been opposition from environmentalists, saying ACs will lead to higher carbon emissions that cause more global heating. Yet portraying ACs as environmentally irresponsible ignores the reality that Europe has long accepted the carbon costs of winter heating. Space heating contributes to 10 per cent of global carbon emissions versus 3 per cent from space cooling. When there is a need, Europeans, too, consider comfort over emissions.

ACs also come with problems of equity, as seen in many Global South countries. The rich can adopt them while the poor cannot. Europe has some of the highest electricity costs, with 10 per cent of the population facing "energy poverty". While vulnerable populations should be protected through ACs, this is not a universal solution. Issues of grid capacity to meet peak demand from space cooling must also be considered. As long as cheaper, sustainable alternatives exist, air conditioning need not be the only answer.

In the Global South, disruptions and failings in infrastructure are often criticised as resulting from a lack of adequate planning. In Europe, when similar systems fail, governments tend to argue that they have not been built for high temperatures. In the Global South, initiatives like the Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure are working towards climate preparedness. Similar efforts will have to be made in Europe. This will not require a reinvention of the wheel. The technologies and materials needed exist in the Global South. A less-discussed aspect is agriculture. Unpredictable weather patterns make it difficult to plan crops, with France stating that it has lost up to one-third of its corn production. Farm animals are unable to adapt to heat stress. There are restrictions on farming activities during peak hours, and storing and transporting goods is a challenge. Farmers will need to start diversifying crop patterns. Given the strength of farmer lobbies in the EU, implementation of such plans may see pushback. For millions in the Global South, adapting to heat stress has become a way of life. As extreme heat becomes Europe's new normal, it must also learn to build resilient societies.

> Portraying air conditioning as irresponsible ignores the reality that Europe has long accepted the carbon costs of winter heating

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The writer is fellow, Centre for Social and Economic Progress

40 YEARS AGO
July 4, 1986

INDIAN EXPRESS
Public unit offices in Delhi to go
Belgaum language stir called off
PM leaves for Mauritius today
Migrant slain, 2 families looted

NCR public unit offices to go

THE NATIONAL Capital Region Planning Board has identified eight towns spread over the states of Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, and Rajasthan where a large number of public sector undertakings now located in the capital will be shifted. The towns are Meerut, Hapur, and Bulandshahr-Khurja Complex in UP; Palwal, Rewan, Rohtak and Panipat in Haryana; and Alwar in Rajasthan.

Belgaum stir called off

THE SAMYUKTA Maharashtra Seema Samiti (SMSS) withdrew its month-old agitation against the imposition of Kannada in Marathi-medium schools in the border areas of Karnataka. Maharashtra Chief Minister S B Chavan in the Council Hall in Bombay assured an SMSS deputation that the circular making Marathi "compulsory" from fifth to eighth standards would be withdrawn immediately.

PM leaves for Mauritius

THE PRIME Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, leaves New Delhi on a two-day state visit to Mauritius, an event which is being looked at with keen interest by both countries. The deteriorating security environment in the Indian Ocean Region will feature prominently in the discussions between Rajiv Gandhi and the Mauritius Prime Minister, Aneerudh Jugnauth.

Jeweller slain, 2 families robbed

A YOUNG migrant jeweller from Punjab was murdered by armed robbers in his house in West Delhi. His family was among two that were beaten up and robbed in their house in Paschim Vihar. The robbers, armed with iron rods and a revolver, bashed the faces of members of both families almost out of recognition after drugging them unconscious.

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

1,000 days since October 7, those responsible are still in power.

— Haaretz, Israel

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American Declaration will remain universal, revolutionary. America may not

PRATAP BHANU MEHTA

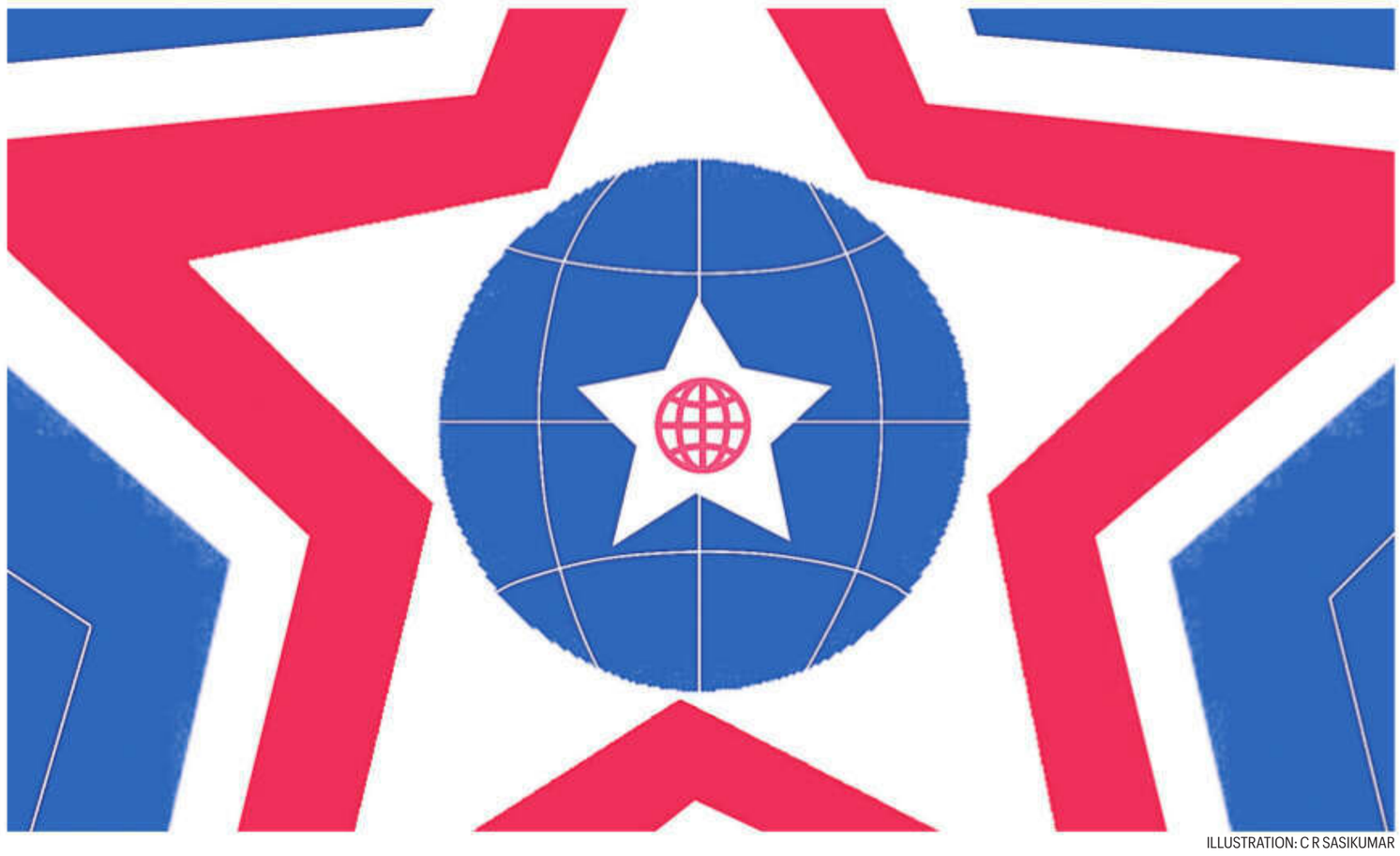

ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

IN 1776, the Declaration of Independence, formally "The Unanimous Declaration of the Thirteen States of the United States", was adopted by the Second Continental Congress. The Declaration did not merely bring into being a new state. It did not merely announce an abstract but revolutionary self-evident truth that "all Men are Created Equal, that they are endowed by their Creator with certain Unalienable Rights that amongst these are Life, Liberty and the Pursuit of Happiness". From that improbable Republic would emerge a force that would transform civilisation itself.

Observers struggled to name the core characteristic of America. The enigmatic word they kept circling back to was "energy". Edmund Burke described religion itself as a "principle of energy" in the colonies. But it was not a conventional religion. It was what he called the "dissidence of dissent, and the Protestantism of the Protestant Religion", almost as if it was a surplus of saying "no" to authority or command that defined America.

This excess of resistance had no inherent moral direction. It could be appropriated by the slave owner as much as the partisan for freedom; it could sustain a violent society that defended the right to bear arms in the name of liberty. Alexis de Tocqueville, on one count, uses the term "energy" more than 50 times in *Democracy in America*. Alexander Hamilton counted "energy" in the executive as a leading marker of good government. Henry Adams, in a way that foreshadowed the American Century, converted physical energy into a religion. The dynamo was a true symbol of "godly infinity". The worship of material expansion was not so much about the objects it created, but the underlying energy it reflected. It is often said that the final draft of the Declaration of Independence removed explicit references to slavery and brought in references to providence. Yet this idiom of providence was never related to piety. Its measure was always going to be energy: Unleashing the capacities of a people to transform the nature of power in the modern world and becoming an object of universal desire.

In the American imagination, freedom became inseparable from power, from the energies it could release and the capacities it could enlarge. It was not simply a doctrine of individual dignity, but a deep faith in the limitless expansion of human possibility. But this energy had a double character. On the one hand, it would unleash an incredibly creative individualism, new forms of associational life, technological innovation, constant experimentation, unmatched material prosperity, mastery over nature, openness to novelty, and a capacity to most fully absorb, even distort, ideas from anywhere in the world. On the other hand, this civilisation and its furious energies were also imperial, violent, constantly expansionary, and destructive. No moral frame could easily contain that impulse. After all, even the Declaration of Independence was not merely about containing American power. One of its grievances against the Crown was that the Crown was, as it were, restraining the colonists from denying sovereignty to Native Americans.

But America in 1776 was already, almost providentially, born powerful. Which nation gets to buy the conditions that allow it to geopolitically pacify its own neighbourhood? In a very typical act of American nation-building, in the Louisiana Purchase, America buys sovereignty over a million square miles, gives a fillip to continental expansion, intensifies the dispossession of indigenous peoples, and creates conditions for the expansion of slavery. Republican freedom as non-domination and a bulwark against arbitrary power was a cornerstone of the political theory of the founding. Never has a conception of freedom been so eloquently and forthrightly articulated. But it was matched by an imperial, energetic freedom, reflected in the mastery of space and the subordination of others. It is the freedom to command and organise the world. These are not two contradictory impulses as much as different ways of discharging an energy that constantly chafes against any limits. In America, freedom and empire are not antithetical; they are both expressions of the same underlying energy.

America is not a nation that has, to date, known a lack of power in ways that are threatening, relative to its adversaries. It is an astounding fact that America has never known powerlessness. This is what underwrites its exceptionalism from all "opinions of mankind" in international law. America's power has allowed it so far to absorb the cost of failure without denting its dominance. An astonished Burke had already noticed in 1776 that "the appearance of a new state, of a new species in a new part of the globe... has made as great a change in all the relations, and balances, and gravitation of power, as the appearance of a new planet would in the system of the solar world". Two hundred and fifty years later, this firmament around which geopolitics revolved is being tested. One enduring paradox of American power is that one of the least threatened nations in history is often in search of enemies it can present as an existential threat — from communism to jihadism — as a pretext for mobilising its power. The second is that it has never really had a challenger. Soviet power was an ideological and military rival. But it never came close to displacing the United States as the central gravitational power of the world system. China has a very different political system and may yet falter on its own contradictions. But for the first time, America confronts a rival animated by a similar relentless logic of global power and material transformation: The ambition not merely to defend sovereignty, but to organise global geopolitics around itself.

> America is not a nation that has, to date, known a lack of power in ways that are threatening, relative to its adversaries. It is an astounding fact that America has never known powerlessness. This is what underwrites its exceptionalism from all opinions of mankind' in international law. America's power has allowed it so far to absorb the cost of failure without denting its dominance

But as always, the main challenge to power that the Declaration unleashed will be internal. Abraham Lincoln knew that even in America, there was nothing self-evident about the self-evident truths of the Declaration. They were, as he put it in a letter to Henry Pierce in 1859, dismissed as "glittering generalities"; or "self-evident lies"; and "still others insidiously argue that they apply only to 'superior races'". Race and inequality remain America's original burden, the unresolved contradiction between its universal promises and the appalling hierarchies through which its power was built. Pessimists have always seen these as braided with American freedom. Even if one argues that race and inequality are not the essence of American freedom, they are not incidental to its history. They have been an important axis on which freedom's promises were allocated unequally and its energies politically organised.

The central challenge of American constitutionalism has always been how to channel immense energy into stable institutional forms; how to discipline power without inhibiting the dynamism that generates it. At the heart of divisions in contemporary America, there remains a contest over two competing visions of freedom that come from the Declaration. The 1789 United States Constitution does not resolve this tension so much as contain it. Its proceduralism seeks to discipline the fires of American energy, converting its glittering truths into staid laws. Yet two rival visions of American constitutionalism persist. One channels that fire into the common promise of self-government with a concern for the internal link between freedom and equality. Another version celebrates the discharge of that energy as rugged individualism, with freedom including the freedom to dominate, unleashing an almost Darwinian power struggle within the frame of democracy. At the heart of American constitutionalism is not a contest between two principles but between two ways of organising power. Each vision accuses the other of betraying the promise of 1776. It is this mutual claim to authentic inheritance that helps drive American polarisation. Is each of these ways of organising power capable of maintaining the dream of limitless material expansion that has defined modern civilisation through America? Are they capable of solving concrete problems, of mass incarceration, alienation, inequality, and services? The question is whether the civilisation that was once defined by inexhaustible energy gets exhausted by its own polarisation.

In a letter written to Roger C Weightman in 1826, at the 50th anniversary of the American founding, Thomas Jefferson asserted the universality and revolutionary character of the American founding: "May it be to the world, what I believe it will be, (*to some parts sooner, to others later, but finally to all,*) the signal of arousing men to burst the chains under which monkish ignorance and superstition had persuaded them to bind themselves, and to assume the blessings and security of self-government."

In 1945, Ho Chi Minh's Declaration of Independence of the Democratic Republic of Vietnam in Hanoi opened with the 1776 American Declaration of Independence. This invocation, doubtless, served rhetorical purposes. But it has been invoked by dozens of states, sometimes as an assertion of sovereignty and independence rather than individual freedom. It may not seem that way in an age of rising authoritarianism, but the conflict between arbitrary power and individual dignity, between imperialism and self-government, between the quest for self-definition and defined hierarchies has indeed become universal. The irony is that, at this moment, these conflicts have escaped their modern origin story in America, as it itself becomes an exemplar of what it sought to deny: Imperialism and authoritarianism. The Declaration will always remain universal and revolutionary. America may not.

The writer is contributing editor, The Indian Express

For immigrants, to love America is to question it

SAYU BHOJWANI

MILLIONS OF Americans breathed a sigh of relief this week when the Supreme Court upheld birthright citizenship in the United States. A 6-3 ruling in the *Trump v. Barbara* case affirmed a core tenet of America's constitution. Its reliance on the 1898 ruling in *United States v. Wong Kim Ark* reminds us that citizenship has always been a contested status for those of us who are not White and male.

For immigrants like me, the ideal of America has always been far from its reality. The win was not guaranteed, and is especially noteworthy coming days before the country marks 250 years of its declaration of independence.

I moved to the United States as an international student, understanding it to be a place of freedom, a place where people could speak their minds and pursue their passions. For decades, this is the story America has told about itself, through its heavy-handed diplomacy and its Hollywood imagery. In fact, as any immigrant can attest, the road to American citizenship — on paper and in practice — is paved with roadblocks: Years-long waiting times and paperwork lost by immigration authorities, or dead ends like denials of legitimate asylum claims.

The most public of these challenges occur in the courts or in the ICE raids that have plagued immigrant communities since January 2025. But in classrooms, at workplaces and on street corners, America reminds us clearly who is American and who is not. There are the seemingly innocent questions of "How do you speak such good English?" or "Where are you from?". Or, the more devastating time — economically and psychologically — when I couldn't get a job for months because I had only a work visa and was neither a permanent resident nor a citizen.

From symbolism to substance, belonging is baked into everyday life in the United States: Which holidays are celebrated, which heroes are lauded, which histories are taught. Indian Americans, indigenous people, Black Americans and immigrants are central to the American story but peripheral in most retellings. The rapid pace at which the Donald Trump administration has been able to tear down civil rights is a testament to the tenuous place immigrants and people of colour occupy in America.

How can I celebrate the Declaration of Independence when my independence is decidedly conditional — upon my skin colour, gender, immigration status, and willingness to conform? To do so would be to celebrate invisibility and erasure. In fact, some of the Declaration's statements against the King of Great Britain could be statements against President Trump. Take for example: "He has endeavoured to prevent the population of these States; for that purpose obstructing the Laws for Naturalisation of Foreigners; refusing to pass others to encourage their migrations hither..." How perfectly that describes the Trump administration's approach to immigration. Or this: "He has kept among us, in times of peace, Standing Armies without the Consent of our legislatures." Look to Los Angeles where troops were deployed to quell immigration protests, or to Washington, DC, where they were used in response to claims of high crime. The Declaration continues with making "Judges dependent on his Will alone, for the tenure of their offices" and "cutting off our Trade with all parts of the world" and other examples that are parallel with this moment.

Despite these, today is a more hopeful moment. In recognition of America's milestone, many are organising and documenting new visions for the next 250. Among them is the Declaration of Interdependence, collaboratively created for a country "where everyone can participate, prosper, and reach their full potential." Or the Declaration of Belonging, in which Errin Haines, award-winning editor at *The 19th*, a non-profit newsroom, asserts "that our humanity is not conditional — not on wealth, whiteness, gender or citizenship" and that "democracy is only real when it is shaped by and applied to all of us". Or, as I always say, nothing is guaranteed to us. We must dream it, build it, nurture it.

This week's ruling on birthright citizenship against the backdrop of the country's 250th anniversary perfectly symbolises what it means to live in America as an immigrant and woman of colour. With every jubilation comes a warning. When we celebrate navigating immigration bureaucracy to secure citizenship for one of us, we must remember that millions live in fear of deportation. When we are successful in electing new and radical voices, we must remember that they will need to work alongside hundreds of legislators who are beholden to special interests. It is in observing this contradiction that I exercise my authority as an American: By working toward a better version of this country I have adopted, I show my love.

The writer is an adjunct professor at Columbia University and served as New York City's first Commissioner of Immigrant Affairs

AI's upgraded the fraudster. Let's upgrade our defence

MIHIR MEHTA

THE MULE account has quietly become the load-bearing wall of digital fraud in India. As laundering channels multiply at machine speed, banks do not need louder alarms — they need a transaction-monitoring intelligence layer that cuts the noise and catches what matters. To understand why it has grown so dangerous, it helps to remember how much the ground beneath us has moved.

Ten years ago, banking largely meant a branch, a queue, and a passbook. Today it lives entirely on the phone, with the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) alone processing nearly Rs 30 trillion in a single month across more than 800 million digital users.

Here lies the uncomfortable corollary: Every new rail we build for legitimate money is also a new lane for illicit money.

Artificial intelligence (AI) has mechanised the entire craft. No longer is a forged signature the extent of fraud. A few seconds of audio is now enough to manufacture voice instructions from a "CFO". Stolen data is being used to walk synthetic identities through onboarding checks. Deepfake scams are being run at a scale that has touched nearly half of all Indian adults.

The damage shows up on three fronts. Identity fraud, where the customer never truly existed. Monetary fraud, where the victim is socially engineered into pressing "send" themselves, defeating every authentication factor we built. And beneath both — the core — the mule account.

The mule is the getaway vehicle of digital crime. In a single year, agencies froze close to 4,50,000 mule accounts through which more than Rs 17,000 crore had already been routed.

The regulator has clearly heard it. The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) Mule-Hunter.ai, the digital payments intelligence platform being built with the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), and the recent discussion paper proposing deliberate "frictions" on suspicious transfers all point the same way. But here is the sobering part: A rule we write on Monday is played upon by Friday.

Almost every bank and NBFC already runs a transaction monitoring system. The problem is not that these systems flag too little. It is that they flag far, far too much. Such a system does not strengthen a bank's defences but slowly erodes its own analysts' trust in the alert itself, until the one signal that genuinely matters is lost in the static.

This is not hypothetical. One global lender recently absorbed a penalty in the region of $3 billion, in part because alert fatigue meant genuine signals sat unread in a queue nobody could clear. The cost of noise is not merely wasted hours. It is missed crime and consequent monetary and reputational losses.

The answer is not a louder alarm, or a larger team. It is an intelligence layer that sits on top of the monitoring system — one that stops handing the money laundering reporting officer a flat list of 48,000 alerts and starts answering the questions that matter. Which five rules are generating 80 per cent of your noise and never converting into a Suspicious Transaction Report? Which clusters look like a mule ring assembling in real time, while funds can still be frozen?

This is the shift the next few years demand.

For those running banks and non-banking financial companies (NBFCs), the instruction is not the tired "adopt AI". It is sharper.

Deploy intelligence at the two points where it changes the odds. First, cut the noise so your best analysts spend their scarce hours on the 5 per cent that is real rather than the 95 that is not. Second, surface the mule networks early, while money is still recoverable.

AI is now on both sides of the table. The fraudster has also picked it up. The only open question is whether our defences have. In banking, trust has always been the real moat. Protecting it is how we build a digitally inclusive and secure Bharat.

The writer is co-founder and CEO of Optimoney Technologies, a RegTech firm working on AML and compliance intelligence for banks and financial institutions. Views are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Indo-Pacific partners

THE EDITORIAL'S optimism regarding India-Japan relations is understandable, but a reality check is equally necessary ('Delhi-Tokyo ties face the future', *IE*, July 3). While strategic convergence between Delhi and Tokyo has undoubtedly deepened, economic outcomes continue to lag behind diplomatic aspirations. The gap between rhetoric and reality remains substantial. Viewed through the prism of the Japan-America-China triangle, the limitations become even more apparent. Despite growing concerns over China's strategic assertiveness, Japan's economic dependence on China remains profound. China's manufacturing sophistication, infrastructure ecosystem and integration into global value chains were built over decades. India has immense potential, but potential and performance are not synonymous. Regulatory uncertainties, logistical bottlenecks, land-acquisition challenges and skill gaps continue to temper investor enthusiasm. History rewards nations not for their potential but for their capacity to convert opportunity into achievement.

Vijay Singh Adhikari, Nainital

Collective effort

THE FIGHT FOR clean air must begin before the smog arrives and continue long after it clears. ('On winter air, Delhi does the right thing', *IE*, July 3). The government is preparing the state for the winter but the real question is whether the people, offices and neighbouring states will cooperate when it comes to long-term practices. Collective effort will be required to combat the situation as together we will have to act responsibly as success will come only through year-round, coordinated action.

Anvi Jain, Delhi

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7 held from Gujarat, one from MP for Jaish links

Express News Service
Rajkot, July 3

THE GUJARAT Anti-Terrorist Squad (ATS) on Friday said it has arrested eight persons, including seven from Gujarat and one from adjoining Madhya Pradesh, for their alleged association with proscribed terror organisation Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM).

The arrested accused were identified by the ATS as Ahmed Abdullah Gajiwala, 19, Ibrahim Mohammad Husen Ghagha , 30, Mudassir Abdullah Ghaziwala, 22, all from Palanpur, Banaskantha; Zakariya Durani Mohammad Ammar Ghagha, 21, Mufti Faujan Ismail Dauwa, 40, and Mohammad Amin Shera, 21, all from Siddhpur, Patan; Mohammad Abdul Rahman Savdi, 22, of Chikhli, Navsari; and Bilal Durani Mohammad Ammar Ghagha, 18, of Dewas, Madhya Pradesh.

The ATS said the arrested persons "established an active network of JeM in Gujarat" and "were in contact with Pakistani handlers".

"The arrested accused had formed an organisation (Tanzeem) named 'Darul Islam Gujarat Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM)'. They were working to extend Dawat (invitations) to other individuals in their areas to join the organisation.

These accused were in contact with Pakistani handlers 'Abdullah and Mohammad Umar'," the ATS said in a statement.

"They translated JeM literature into Gujarati to propagate its ideology and were actively participating in the conspiracy to execute terrorist acts on behalf of JeM in Gujarat. To execute this conspiracy, they had received funding of approximately Rs 3 lakh using which an old car was purchased, which has not been transferred to their name to date," the agency said.

> ***The ATS said the arrested persons "established an active network of JeM in Gujarat" and "were in contact with Pakistani handlers"***

The ATS said terrorist literature including "Jihadi books, speeches, audio, videos, photographs, and the flag of JeM" were recovered from them.

"Eight letters typed in Urdu addressed to Masood Azhar (JeM founder) to join the terrorist organisation were seized.

A Gujarati translation of 'Dars-e-Jihad', the book authored by Azhar, was also seized from them," the ATS statement said.

A case has been registered against the eight persons under Sections 13 (punishment for unlawful activities), 17 (punishment for raising funds for terrorist act), 18 (punishment for conspiracy), 38 (offence relating to membership of a terrorist organisation), and 39 (offence relating to support given to a terrorist organisation) of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA), 1967, and Sections 61 (criminal conspiracy) and 148 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

The arrests were made on Thursday following joint raids conducted in Banaskantha, Mehsana, Navsari, and Patan districts of Gujarat, and Dewas district of MP, the ATS added.

EXPRESS special

New Indore hospital exists only on paper, but appointments continue

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, July 3

SIX YEARS after the Madhya Pradesh government sanctioned a 100-bed civil hospital in Indore's Khajrana area, authorities have not yet taken possession of the land allotted for it, and no building has been constructed. However, the state has been appointing doctors, nurses, pharmacists and other staff to posts created for the hospital, with the latest appointment coming just last month.

The proposed hospital was approved on June 23, 2020, and was meant to serve Khajrana and the rapidly growing localities in its neighbourhood — an area with a population of more than 3 lakh people that currently does not have a secondary care facility and relies on the already stretched government hospitals in other parts of the district. The project is currently stalled at the pre-construction stage.

What has not stalled are appointments. Over the years, staff have been appointed to 87 sanctioned posts — specialist doctors, medical officers, staff nurses, laboratory technicians and pharmacists among them. The most recent appointment to the hospital was that of a laboratory technician this June.

The result is a hospital that exists administratively — in transfer orders, sanctioned posts and staffing rosters — but not physically. Indore Chief Medical and Health Officer Dr Madhav Hasani confirmed that land had been allotted to the Health Department but not handed over. "A 100-bed civil hospital has been sanctioned for Khajrana, along with the necessary manpower. Land has been allocated to us, but we have not yet received physical possession of it," he said, adding that the District Collector had directed the Joint Collector overseeing land matters to resolve the issue.

Indore's Chief Medical and Health Officer said the district was "working to resolve the land dispute so that construction can begin".

Deputy Chief Minister Rajendra Shukla, responding to questions on the delay, said the project remained on the government's books despite a lack of progress on the ground. "Work could not start due to the land not being available," he said.

Those appointed to posts sanctioned for the hospital have, for now, been attached to several new Sanjeevani Clinics that the government has set up. Mukhyamantri Sanjeevani Clinics are part of an urban primary healthcare initiative of the Madhya Pradesh government. They were launched to provide free basic healthcare close to people's homes, particularly in densely populated urban areas and economically weaker settlements where access to government health facilities is limited. The state has so far sanctioned 783 Sanjeevani Clinics, which provide free consultation, tests and some medicines.

Chief Medical and Health Officer Hasani said around 85 Sanjeevani Clinics have been launched in Indore over the past two-and-a-half years, and that those appointed to the Khajrana hospital are working in these clinics for the time being.

The Khajrana hospital was originally conceived to ease pressure on Indore's major public facilities — M Y Hospital, MTH Hospital, P C Sethi Hospital and the District Hospital — which together serve patients drawn from across the wider Malwa region, and to bring secondary care closer to residents of Khajrana, Musakhedi, Tejaji Nagar, Bicholi Hapsi and other colonies that have expanded rapidly over the past decade.

Indore district's annual health report lays bare the pressure already being faced by the existing healthcare infrastructure. According to the report, Indore's sanctioned bed strength outside its medical colleges stands at 1,240, including 300 at the District Hospital, 520 spread across eight civil hospitals, 240 across eight Community Health Centres, and 180 across 30 Primary Health Centres.

Set against a district population estimated at close to 35 lakhs, that works out to under 0.4 government hospital beds per 1,000 people — well below the two-beds-per-1,000 standard that the National Health Policy calls for.

Under Indian Public Health Standards, each of Indore's eight Community Health Centres is meant to serve a population of no more than 1.2 lakh. However, the district's population is more than three times the combined capacity those norms assume.

On the Khajrana hospital, the Chief Medical and Health Officer said the district was "working to resolve the land dispute so that construction can begin".

Allahabad HC junks pleas to quash FIR of rape under guise of nikah halala

Bhupendra Pandey
Lucknow, July 3

THE ALLAHABAD High Court has dismissed three petitions filed by a man, as well as other accused, seeking to quash an FIR lodged on a complaint by his wife that she was allegedly subjected to gangrape twice under the pretext of 'nikah halala', including when she was a minor, to remarry the same man.

A division bench of Justices JJ Munir and Tarun Saxena observed, "When it comes to criminal law, unless the law itself makes an exception, which it rarely does, there is absolutely no place for pleading personal laws governing marriage if, interlaced with a matrimonial relationship, a crime were committed."

The bench added that the constitutionality of halala is not under challenge before the court. "... But, if under the garb of... halala, a minor girl is subjected to carnal relations... it would certainly attract provisions of the POCSO Act," it said.

The court further observed, "We are minded to say that this case presents the picture of a part of our society that is far removed from constitutional values and... aspirations of equality, privacy, personal dignity and whatever Articles 21 and 14 of the Constitution stand for..."

"... We do not by any means intend to say that in this petition, that is not framed that way, that we propose or suggest anything about the constitutionality of a given practice... But the circumstances of this case, and whatever has happened... prima facie... militates against the constitutional aspirations and guarantees... In fact, the entire facts that have so far come on record, are shocking to the conscience," it observed.

The court was hearing three writ petitions jointly seeking to quash the FIR lodged on December 9, 2025, under various BNS sections including 85 (penalising a husband or relatives for physical/mental cruelty), 64 (rape), 70(2) (gangrape), section 3/4 of the Muslim Women (Protection of Rights on Marriage) Act, 2019, (for giving triple talaq) and Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act in Amroha district.

The co-accused named in the FIR are a cleric as well as the husband's brother and nephew who allegedly raped the woman on the pretext of halala. The victim was 16 years old when the first incident took place, as per the FIR and the victim's statement detailed in the court order.

The bench observed that the first halala prima facie constitutes statutory rape and offences under the POCSO Act, and the second instance prima facie constitutes a case of gangrape. Ihe court stated that the matter requires thorough investigation.

Thane man dies 2 days after tree fell on bike

Purnima Sah
Mira-Bhayandar, July 3

IN ANOTHER tragic death due to a tree fall, Rahul Ashok Patil , 35, died on Friday morning, two days after he suffered severe head injuries when a tree fell on him while he was on his two-wheeler in Thane's Mira Road.

Rahul was the son of Ashok Patil, former deputy mayor of the Mira-Bhayandar Municipal Council. His uncle said that Rahul had gone to refuel his two-wheeler on Wednesday and was on his way back home when the tree fell. "He suffered a severe head injury and one of his eyes was badly damaged. We rushed him to Tunga Hospital," Ramesh Patil said. Rahul underwent emergency surgery but remained in a coma; he was put on life support. According to the family, doctors were monitoring his condition before deciding on a second surgery. "Doctors were waiting for his body to respond. The second surgery... could not take place as his condition worsened," his uncle said. Rahul died around 9 am on Friday.

Holding civic authorities responsible, he alleged that the coconut tree had shown signs of instability before the monsoon. "The tree was partially uprooted and the road next to it was also in a bad condition. The (municipal) corporation should have removed the dangerous tree before the monsoon...Residents had flagged it but no one cared," he said, demanding accountability for the incident.

'Will never win genuine recognition': China on India-Japan's open Indo-Pacific stand

Divya A
New Delhi, July 3

AS JAPANESE Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi wound up her three-day India visit where New Delhi and Tokyo discussed and advocated a free and open Indo-Pacific, Beijing has said that the concept goes against the shared aspirations of regional countries.

On Friday, China's spokesperson in India, Yu Jing, highlighted the statement made by the spokesperson of China's Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Guo Jiakun, a day earlier, when talks between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and PM Takaichi were held.

"The so-called concept of 'Free and Open Indo-Pacific' goes against the regional countries shared aspirations for peace, development and cooperation, and will never win genuine recognition," Guo said in response to a question on Takaichi statement.

"Safeguarding post-war international order and purposes and principles of the UN Charter is the foundation of the prosperity and stability in the Asia Pacific, as well as the shared responsibility of regional countries," he said.

Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi waves before departing for Japan after concluding her India visit, at the airport in New Delhi on Friday. PTI

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Guo added, "It is more imperative than ever for regional countries to uphold the right course of Asia-Pacific cooperation, work together to build an Asia Pacific that is prosperous, stable, open, interconnected, universally beneficial, inclusive, united and mutually supportive."

Meanwhile, in response to Prime Minister Modi's remarks that India and Japan will strengthen cooperation in the area of critical minerals, Guo said on Friday that such cooperation should not target any third party or undermine its interests.

"Still less should such cooperation be used to create exclusive 'small blocs' or stoke confrontation under the pretext of cooperation," Guo said, as per the Chinese State Council Information office. He said cooperation between countries should help enhance understanding and trust among regional nations and safeguard regional peace and stability.

Maintaining the stability and security of global industrial and supply chains is a shared responsibility of all countries, he noted, adding that all parties should embrace an open and cooperative mindset and play a constructive role to this end.

In the joint statement released by India and Japan on Thursday, the two sides had also expressed concern over the situation in the South China Sea and East China Sea.

Without making any direct mention of China, they reiterated "strong opposition to any unilateral actions that endanger the safety as well as freedom of navigation and to change the status quo by force or coercion".

They shared their serious concerns over the growing militarisation of disputed features, in an oblique reference to China growing military dominance in the region.

In another initiative that is aimed at countering China's growing footprint in Africa, India and Japan discussed the formulation of the Strategic Outlook for Expanding Japan-India Cooperation in Africa.

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Diljit-starrer *Satluj* gets digital release after remaining stuck with CBFC for over 3 years

People can now watch the film exactly how it was made, says writer-director Trehan

Alaka Sahani
Mumbai, July 3

AFTER WAITING for over three years to get the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC) certificate and nod for its theatrical release, the makers of *Satluj* — previously titled *'Punjab 95'* — have finally released it on Hindi Zee 5.

The film, written and directed by Honey Trehan, is inspired by the life of human rights activist Jaswant Singh Khalra, essayed by singer-actor Diljit Dosanjh, and his relentless fight for truth.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Trehan said even though he was "a little disappointed" that the film could not be released in theatres, he is relieved that "people can now watch the film exactly how it was made".

"That's deeply satisfying for me. Apart from the title change, there have been no cuts or compromises," he said. The film's release hung in balance for a long time after the CBFC demanded about 127 cuts, but the makers, especially Dosanjh and Trehan, refused to comply.

Actor Diljit Dosanjh in a still from *Satluj*. The film was released on OTT platform Zee5 on Friday.

Set in Punjab of the 80s and 90s, the film delves into a landscape scarred by militancy, political violence and fear. As thousands of people vanished without explanation and justice remained elusive, Jaswant Singh, a bank employee in Amritsar, chose to fight against the system and look for the missing persons. The film's cast includes Arjun Rampal, Kanwaljit Singh, Suvinder Vicky, and Geetika Vidya Ohlyan. It is produced by Ronnie Screwvala, Abhishek Chaubey, and Trehan.

Trehan said, "There had been complete radio silence (from CBFC) for the last three-and-a-half years over its certification. For a film like this to finally be released says a lot about the team's spirit. I'm very grateful to Zee5, especially to my producer, Ronnie Screwvala, for the way they stood by the film. Diljit Dosanjh too has gone all out to support it." Hindi Zee5 announced the film's release on Friday evening.

Though the film was released without a single cut, Trehan says they "could not retain its original title for various reasons". However, he maintains that they were okay with 'Satluj' as the film's title since it was one of their original options. "Even when we chose Punjab 95, Satluj was on our list," he says.

Dosanjh in a press statement said: "Bhai Jaswant Singh Khalra ji's martyrdom and his contribution to humanity were the primary reasons I chose to be a part of this film. When I first heard the script, it moved me deeply, as it is rooted in the lived experiences, struggles, and sacrifices of real people. As an artist, opportunities to be part of such meaningful stories are rare."

He further added, "From the moment I heard the script, I felt a strong sense of responsibility towards the film and was committed to portraying such an inspiring character with truth, honesty, and utmost respect." Though Trehan is "happy and excited" over the film's release, he is nervous, too. "I don't know how people are going to react. I just hope the film resonates with people and that they accept it for what I wanted to communicate," he says.

Government of Tamil Nadu
ELECTRONICS CORPORATION TAMIL NADU LIMITED - ANGADI
9th Floor, Sigapi Aachi Building, 18/3, Rukmani Lakshmipathi Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008. https://elcot.tn.gov.in
+91 44 2855 6120 | tenders@elcotangadi.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Tender No. E-ANGADI-ST-HO12-2026-0001-2

ELCOT Angadi Division invites **"Tender for Supply, Installation and Commissioning of IT Hardware for Inter-Operable Criminal Justice System (ICJS) 2.0 Project for Police, Prison, Prosecution and Forensics Departments across Tamil Nadu (2nd call)".** For complete details, please visit www.tntenders.gov.in. Pre-bid meeting: 14.07.2026, 12:30 PM. Last date for submission of e-bids: 30.07.2026, 3 PM. For queries: tenders@elcotangadi.in.
DIPR/2205/Tender/2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

The Odisha State Co-operative Milk Producers' Federation Limited
omfed
www.omfed.com
6001/64/2627
D-2, Sahid Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751007
PH NO. : 0674-2546030,2540273,2540417,2540974
E-mail ID: omfed@yahoo.com

E-TENDER

OMFED invites item rate bids in Double cover in on-line mode system from experienced "C & above" class contractors towards "Architectural, Interior Design, Repair and Renovation work of existing MM, PROJECT. CSS and FINANCE Division with Officer Chamber at Omfed Corporate Office, Sahidnagar, BBSR, Khurda.". Interested bidders may download the Tender Document from The OMFED web site www.omfed.com only for reference. Bid document will be available in the **https://tendersodisha.gov.in** from 10.00 AM of 04/07/2026 to 11:00 AM of 27/07/2026 for bidding. The technical Bid shall be opened at 03.00 PM on 27/07/2026 at the OMFED Corporate Office in the presence of the interested bidders. The corrigendum/amendment to this notice if required shall be published only in the OMFED web site www.omfed.com. The Management reserves the right to accept or reject any or all the bid document or part thereof without assigning any reason.

Sd/-
OIPR- 6001/6063/1/26-27/0034 **Managing Director**

Government of Rajasthan
Local Self Government Department
(Directorate of Local Bodies, Jaipur, Rajasthan)
G-3, Rajmahal Residency, Near Civil Lines, Railway Crossing, Jaipur
Tel No.: +91 141 2222469 **Fax No.:** +91 141 2222403 **web site:** www.lsg.urban.rajasthan.gov.in

No: F 55 () PA/CE(SBM)/SBM (U)2.0/Legacy waste/cluster 2/2026/12068 **Date 22/06/2026**
UBN NO:-DLB2627 WLOB08434 **Tender ID: 2026_DLB_570195_1**

Short Term Notice Inviting Bids (NIB)

Online Technical and Financial Bids in Single Stage two envelops are invited on behalf of Governor of Rajasthan by Directorate of Local Bodies, State Mission Director, SBM (U) for Bio-Remediation of Legacy Waste (1.96 Lakh Cum) at old Dumpsites in 14 ULBs under Swachh Bharat Mission (Urban) 2.0 of Cluster 2 upto 06.07.2026. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the Procurement Portal (**http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in**, **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**.) of the State; and LSG Department website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 9.17 Crore.
DIPR/C/11363/2026 **State Mission Director, SBM (U)**

JHARKHAND URBAN INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT COMPANY LIMITED
(Govt. of Jharkhand Undertaking)
JUIDCO Bhawan, Kutchary Road, Ranchi-834001, Jharkhand., Ph No.: +91-651-2225878,
CIN: U45200JH2013SGC001752, e-mail ld-juidcolimited@gmail.com

NIT No.: JUIDCO/NIT/MB/Gumla/713 **Date – 02.07.2026**

e-Procurement (Tender Notice)

1	Name of Work	Construction of Municipal Building at Gumla under Gumla Nagar Parishad
2	Mode of Bid Submission	e-tendering (http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
3	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Rs. 13,51,84,452/- (Rupees Thirteen Crore Fifty-One Lakh Eighty-Four Thousand Four Hundred Fifty-Two) only.
4	Time of Completion	18 Months (Including Monsoon & Mobilization Period)
5	Tender Fee and Bid Security to be submitted online	Tender document fee: Rs 25,000/- (Rupees Twenty-Five Thousand) only non-refundable. Bid Security: Rs 13,52,000/- (Rupees Thirteen Lakh Fifty-Two Thousand) only
6	Date/Time of Publication of Tender on Website	06.07.2026 17:00 Hrs
7	Last Date/Time of Bid Submission	28.07.2026 17:00 Hrs
8	Date/Time of opening of Bid	29.07.2026 17:00 Hrs
9	Bid Submission Address	Jharkhand Urban Infrastructure Development Company Ltd., JUIDCO Bhawan, Kutchery Chowk, Ranchi, Jharkhand- 834001
10	Helpline Number of e-procurement Cell	0651-2225878

Further details can be seen on website http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in

Sd/-
PR 383903 Urban Development and Housing(26-27)#D **Project Director (Technical) JUIDCO Ltd, Ranchi**

JHARKHAND BIJLI VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED
(CIN: U40108JH2013SGC001702)
Regd. Office:- Engineering Building, HEC, Dhurwa, Ranchi–834004
fax # 0651-2400483 e-mail :cesd.jseb@gmail.com

Notice Inviting Tender

Tender is invited for Construction & Commissioning of new 33 KV line under Electric Supply Circle, Ranchi, Jharkhand on Turnkey basis.

NIT No.	Description	Estimated value incl. GST (In Crs.)	EMD value incl. GST (In lacs).	Tender Cost incl. GST (In Rs.)	Downloading/ Sale of Tender Document	Pre-Bid Meeting	Last date of sale of Tender Document	Last Date of submission of Tender Document	Date of Opening of Tender
175/PR/JBVNL/2026-27	Construction & Commissioning of New 33 KV feeder originated from 132/33 KV GSS IRBA, Sikidiri to Chaibagan PSS under ESSD, Ormanjhi, Electric Supply Circle, Ranchi on Turnkey Basis in ADP Head.	10.72	21.44	11,800	07.07.26	17.07.26 at 4.00 PM	27.07.26 up to 05:00 PM	27.07.26 up to 06:00 PM	29.07.26 at 05:00 PM

Details against the above Tender can be obtained from website http:jharkhandtenders.gov.in and may be contacted on Mobile No. 7004815844 & NIC helpline No. 0651-2400178. Submission of bid document fee and EMD will be accepted through online mode only and receipt of the same should be submitted to the office of undersigned on or before 27.07.2026.

स्वहित एवं राष्ट्र हित में ऊर्जा बचायें। कृपया अपनी शिकयतों को टॉलफ्री नं० 1800 345 6570 पर दर्ज करायें।

PR 384005 Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd (26-27)_D

Sd/-
GM (STN)
JBVNL

AYODHYA RAM MANDIR 'THEFT' PROBE

Accused's car seized, cops suspect it was bought with proceeds of crime

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, July 3

AYODHYA POLICE Friday seized Ram Temple 'theft' accused Avinash Shukla's car, which they suspect was purchased with proceeds from the alleged crime, said a senior police officer.

Police were granted one-day custody of Shukla by a court on Thursday. Sources said police had sought his custody as part of efforts to recover more of the allegedly stolen money and trace a vehicle suspected to be linked to the case.

Sources had earlier said that fresh searches at his home had led to the recovery of Rs 20.39 lakh in denominations of Rs 500, 200, 100, 50, 20, and 10; and USD 1,121 in the denominations of 100, 50, 20, 10, 5, and 1. The maximum cash was in Rs 500 denomination – over 3,000 currency notes.

His family has refused to comment on the allegations.

At his village, Babpur Nariyawa in Pratapgarh, pradhan Raju Yadav said, "The Shukla family has long depended on agriculture and runs a small paan shop in the village. After moving to Ayodhya about two years ago, Avinash would return home only occasionally, often in a second-hand car he had bought recently. The family home had also been undergoing renovation in recent months."

"It is a large family, and we assumed that several members were earning and their financial situation had improved," Yadav said.

Residents said Avinash, one of four brothers, had worked at a local shop in Pratapgarh before moving to Ayodhya reportedly with the help of an acquaintance there.

Police teams have made several visits to the family's home -- the latest on Thursday -- and questioned his parents and sought information about the family's property holdings.

Police believe Avinash could provide further leads in the case, as a substantial part of the recoveries made so far was allegedly based on information provided by him.

Police said they have not ruled out the possibility that some of the allegedly stolen money may have been used to purchase or commission jewellery.

Besides Avinash, the other arrested accused are Lavkush Mishra, Anukalp Mishra, Manish Kumar Yadav, Karunesh Pandey, Ramashankar Mishra, Ram Shankar Yadav alias Tinnu Yadav, and Subhash Srivastav.

Police have so far recovered Rs 79.80 lakh from seven of the eight arrested men.

Badrinath shrine: Panel orders probe into 'donation theft'

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, July 3

THE SHRI Badarinath Kedarnath Temple Committee (BKTC) on Friday ordered an inquiry into allegations circulating on social media about the "misappropriation" of offerings and donations at Shri Badrinath Dham.

A BKTC official said Dehradun-based outfit Bhairav Sena had alleged that an employee at Shri Badrinath Dham was embezzling donation money and offerings.

"While no evidence was provided by the outfit, BKTC has ordered an inquiry into the matter," said the official. The BKTC has also sought responses from the employees looking after the donation counting, he said.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, BKTC Chairman Hemant Dwivedi said, "BKTC has taken the allegations very seriously. Since it is a very sensitive matter associated with the sentiments and faith of crores of people, an order has been issued to constitute a committee to probe the allegations." The Chairman also said that the inquiry report will be made public and strict action will be taken against the wrongdoer, if any.

The temple is situated at an altitude of more than 10,000 feet.
(SOURCE: UTTARAKHANDTOURISM.GOV.IN)

A BKTC official said that allegations were made on social media that the "personal assistant" of the BKTC Chairman was involved in the alleged embezzlement. Dwivedi, however, said, "I have no personal secretary. That person is a regular employee of BKTC and has worked as personal secretary with three chairmen in the past. If allegations made against him on social media are found to be true in the inquiry, action will be taken against him."

BKTC Chief Executive Officer Sohan Singh Rangar, in a statement, said that the footage of the CCTV cameras installed on the Badrinath shrine premises was checked on Friday, but there was nothing conclusive in the videos.

"If any adverse fact or anomaly is found in the probe, legal and departmental action will be taken against the guilty as per the Shri Badrinath-Kedarnath Temple Committee Act-1939 and employee conduct rules," the CEO said in the statement.

Sources said that five CCTV cameras are installed inside the room where the donation money is counted by the BKTC employees.

• BRIEFLY

A landslide triggered by heavy rainfall blocked the Choling-Karcham stretch of National Highway-5 in Kinnaur district on Friday. PTI

HIMACHAL PRADESH

Three die, 49 roads closed as monsoon rain lashes Himachal

THREE PERSONS died in rain-related incidents in Himachal Pradesh in 24 hours till Friday evening, taking the death toll to 12 this monsoon. One person each was electrocuted in Kangra and Shimla districts, while another died after falling from a height in Mandi district, officials said. Meanwhile, a pickup truck and a Scorpio SUV on the Shimla-Kinnaur National Highway (NH-5) were buried under debris in a cloudburst-triggered massive landslide in the Choling area of Kinnaur district early Friday, but all occupants of both vehicles escaped unhurt, district authorities said. According to the Kinnaur district administration, the incident took place at around 4 am, dumped huge quantities of debris on the highway and disrupted traffic for nearly eight hours. The closure of the highway caused long queues of stranded vehicles. **ENS**

Govt to summon Meta on child sexual abuse ads

IT MINISTER Ashwini Vaishnaw has directed MeitY officials to summon Meta over Instagram ads allegedly promoting child sexual abuse material, marking the second instance of regulatory scrutiny initiated against the social media company this week. The ministry will demand an explanation and information on action taken in its notice to Meta over child sexual abuse material advertisement allegations, govt sources said. The latest action comes amid a *BBC* report that alleged Meta's recommendation algorithm had been promoting videos containing child sexual abuse material (CSAM), exposing gaps in the safeguards. **PTI**

2-yr-old drowns in trench, police book contractor

A TWO-YEAR-OLD boy died after falling into a nearly three-foot-deep trench filled with rainwater and sewage in Maharashtra's Pune district, following which police booked the contractor, officials said on Friday. The incident occurred on June 30 at Kadamwak Wasti in the Loni gram panchayat area, they said. According to police, the trench had been dug alongside a drain to facilitate the flow of rainwater. The toddler, who lived in a nearby settlement, accidentally fell into it while playing, said officials. The child's parents began searching for him after realising that he had been missing for a long time. **PTI**

EXPRESS special

Are UP prisoners eating 'unsafe' spices? Report shows batch failed quality tests

Report says Nov '25 supply contained 'extraneous matter' up to 50% of weight

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, July 3

Documents show spices worth crores supplied to UP prisons department for distribution across jails failed quality tests

IN MARCH 2024, a release by the Centre said that hundred-odd jails across the country had been certified as 'Eat Right Campus' by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI), as part of promoting safe and healthy eating habits. The highest number of these certified jails were in UP.

In the past few years, several jails in the state have also got "five-star" rating from FSSAI.

Now comes a pinch of salt — and spice. Documents seen by *The Indian Express* show spices worth crores supplied to the UP Prisons Administration and Reforms Department for distribution across jails in November last year failed quality tests.

As per the documents, at least six spices — haldi (turmeric), lal mirch (red chili), tez patta (bay leaf), kaali mirch (black pepper), dal chini (cinnamon) and badi elaichi (large cardamom) — failed quality tests at the Regional Food Research and Analysis Centre in Lucknow. The same batch was then sent to a private laboratory in Hapur district, and procured after the spices passed tests there.

The Lucknow laboratory found that the spices contained "extraneous matter" up to 50% of the weight, against the permissible 1%, while "insect damaged matter" amounted to more than 40% in one procured sample, the papers show.

Asked about the findings, Additional IG, Prisons Administration and Reform Services, Dharmendra Singh, cited the Hapur lab report clearing the spices. While some items "didn't match the parameters in testing... earlier", Singh told *The Indian Express*, "we cancelled that order and got a batch tested again. All the parameters were clear the second time". Sources said a different sample of the same batch was tested, and cleared.

About the samples being sent to a private laboratory, Singh said Vani Analytical Research Private Limited was NABL accredited. "We have both the options – to get samples tested at a government laboratory or an NABL-accredited laboratory".

The Indian Express visited Vani Analytical Research Private Limited, located in a three-storey building, in Shahpur Fagauta village of Hapur. The laboratory has 25 employees. Director Sudarshan Mittal, who owns the facility, told *The Indian Express*: "We get samples from across India. The set of samples you are talking about came through a courier from the UP Prisons Department and cleared all the parameters."

A food expert in Delhi said the findings by the Lucknow Centre show that the spices were substandard as per FSSAI parameters. "They are also unsafe to consume and can be injurious to health," said the expert, refusing to be identified.

The findings of the Lucknow centre:

- Turmeric: It held that while "extraneous matter" should not be more than 1% by weight of the total sample, it was 11.12% in one batch and 38.89% in another. The turmeric was also failed by the centre on parameters such as "insect-damaged matter", which was found to be 5.5% of the weight, instead of 1% limit.
- Black pepper: The "extraneous matter" allowed for black pepper as per FSSAI regulations is 2% of the weight, but in the pepper tested by the centre, it was found to be 14.26%.
- Large cardamon: The sample was found to have as much as 21.4% "extraneous matter". "Insect damaged matter" was 7.9%.
- Cinnamon: "Extraneous matter" was more than half (50.42%) in one sample and 38.2% in another. "Insect damaged matter" was 9.8% in one sample, and 7.79% in another.
- Bay leaf: The "extraneous matter" was 7.2% in one sample. Under the tests for "insect bored and diseased leaves", the permissible limit is 10%, while it was 43.24% in one sample.
- Red chilli: "Insect damaged matter" in the sample tested by the Lucknow laboratory was 8.8% in one sample.

Amarnath Yatra begins

Pilgrims leave for Amarnath Yatra in Jammu and Kashmir on Friday. The annual yatra to the south Kashmir Himalayas began with the first batch of pilgrims setting off for the holy cave shrine amidst chants of religious hymns. Vice President C P Radhakrishnan, Prime Minister Narendra Modi and other dignitaries greeted devotees on the commencement of the 57-day yatra. Stringent security arrangements have been put in place for the smooth conduct of the yatra. SHUAIB MASOODI

Assam teenager injured in stalker attack that killed her cousin dies

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, July 3

A TEENAGER, who had been critically injured in an attack in May that had caused outrage across Assam, died in a hospital on Friday.

The 17-year-old student was injured in the attack that occurred on May 31, in which her cousin Madhurjya Barman, who was a district-level office bearer for the All Assam Students' Union (AASU), was killed.

They were attacked when travelling together on a two-wheeler. While Barman died on the spot, the 17-year-old was rushed to the Gauhati Medical College and Hospital (GMCH) with injuries from a sharp weapon in multiple places, including her scalp, neck, back and arms. Within 24 hours of the attack, the accused was shot dead by police in an encounter amid growing outrage in the state. The victim's family had alleged that the accused had been pursuing her romantically despite rejection. GMCH superintendent Dr Devajit Choudhury said that she died on Friday morning after her health deteriorated over the past week.

"She was in our hospital's ICU. She had to have two surgeries because of wounds in her spinal cord. She had improved a lot... But her health started declining in the past week. In the last three days, she was getting weaker, and her blood pressure was dropping. She had to be put on a ventilator last night. This morning, she had a cardiac arrest and passed away," he said.

Meghalaya honeymoon murder: SC refuses to cancel Sonam's bail

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 3

THE SUPREME Court Friday refused to stay the bail granted to Sonam Raghuvanshi, arrested in connection with the murder of her husband, Indore-based businessman Raja Raghuvanshi, during their honeymoon in Meghalaya, even as it expressed reservations about the manner in which the Meghalaya High Court dealt with the matter.

A bench of Justices M M Sundresh and Sheel Nagu issued notice on the state's plea challenging the June 29 order of the high court, which upheld the trial court order granting Sonam bail in the case.

The bench said it did not want to cancel the bail since the order is already in effect and she had been released from custody.

However, initially, the bench said it will stay the high court order and observe how the trial proceeds.

But when it was pointed out that she had already been released following the high court order, Justice Sundresh said, "Then we cannot stay the order. But for the fact that she is released, prima facie we were inclined to stay".

A Shillong court granted her bail on April 27, saying the grounds of arrest had not been effectively communicated to her. The state's appeal challenging the order was dismissed by the Meghalaya HC on June 29.

Appearing for Meghalaya Friday, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said it was a "really shocking case".

"It's a predetermined murder. There are three accomplices travelling along with the wife. The wife takes the husband to some hilly areas and kills him. She participates in the assault, that's the chargesheet. And the body is thrown in the valley. It is found almost after 10 days," he submitted.

Responding to the bench's query as to who killed him, Mehta said, "The three assailants brought by the lady and she herself. She was also part of the physical assault... She had absconded after the crime and was arrested in Meghalaya."

Externed for protests, home after 7 months: Journey of SDPI leader behind HC ruling

Zeeshan Shaikh
Mumbai, July 3

WHEN MUMBAI Police externed Saeed Ahmed Abdul Wahid Choudhary from the city in December last year, the 51-year-old SDPI functionary packed his belongings, rented a room in Mumbra with four colleagues and stayed away from his home in Chembur for nearly seven months. On Thursday, hours after the Bombay High Court quashed the externment order, he drove straight back home.

For nearly a decade, Choudhary has been a regular at protest sites across Mumbai's eastern suburbs. From demonstrations against the Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA) and the National Register of Citizens (NRC) to annual protests marking the demolition of the Babri Masjid, agitations over the Gyanvapi mosque dispute, campaigns against restrictions on azaan loudspeakers and local protests against ready mix concrete plants in the Chembur-Govandi belt, he has built his political career around street mobilisation.

The Bombay High Court on Thursday held that the state could not extern him merely for organising protests against government decisions, observing that there was no material to show his activities caused alarm, danger or harm to the public.

A resident of Chembur's Mahul Road, Choudhary runs a transport and construction material supply business. A Class VIII dropout, he says he first became involved in local social work before joining the Social Democratic Party of India (SDPI) around 2015. He is now the party's Maharashtra general secretary and has also contested elections. In the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, he contested from Mumbai South Central but finished far behind the leading candidates.

According to the High Court order, the cases relied upon by Mumbai Police while seeking his externment stemmed largely from protests organised by Choudhary as an SDPI office-bearer. The FIRs, registered between 2019 and 2024, were mostly under Section 188 of the Indian Penal Code for allegedly violating prohibitory orders after permission for demonstrations had been denied.

Saeed Ahmed Abdul Wahid Choudhary. FILE

"There are around five cases against me and almost all of them relate to protests," Choudhary said. "We raised slogans against government policies. There were no allegations of violence."

His first prolonged detention came during the anti-CAA protests, when he was held under preventive provisions for around 10 days before being released.

His legal troubles deepened in 2025. During former BJP MP Kirit Somaiya's Loudspeaker Free Mumbai campaign in Chembur, Choudhary and other SDPI workers staged a protest. He was detained and later released after paying a fine. A few months later, he led another demonstration against alleged air pollution caused by the presence of cement godowns in residential parts of the Chembur-Govandi area, following which another case was registered.

In October 2025, Mumbai Police issued him a showcause notice under Section 56 of the Maharashtra Police Act proposing his externment. The notice alleged that his activities were causing, or were likely to cause, alarm, danger and harm to the public and property. On December 3, Choudhary and four other SDPI activists were externed from Mumbai for one year.

He challenged the order before the Divisional Commissioner, Konkan Division, but his appeal was dismissed in March this year.

He then approached the Bombay High Court.

His lawyers argued that none of the cases against him involved violence or offences that justified invoking the extraordinary powers of externment. Accepting the contention, Justice Madhav Jamdar held that the material on record only showed that Choudhary had organised protests and raised slogans against decisions of the Union government. Alleged offences under Section 188 IPC, the court said, could not justify depriving a citizen of the fundamental right to move freely.

The SDPI, which fought the case, also welcomed the verdict. "Citizens are not slaves of the government. The police must serve the Constitution, not political masters. The High Court's verdict is a powerful reminder against the misuse of state power," SDPI state president Azhar Tamoli said.

For Choudhary, the verdict meant an immediate return home after months away.

"We rented a room in Mumbra and stayed there together. It affected my family, my business and my political work. As soon as I came to know about the verdict I drove back home to Mumbai," he said.

Reflecting on the judgment, he added, "This is not only about me. The judgment reinforces that peaceful protest is a democratic right. In a democracy, citizens have the right to question the government. If people stop raising their voice, democracy loses its meaning."

SHUAIB MASOODI

FALLING IN LOVE

One May morning, in an Uri village, a message slid into Iram Majeed's phone. It was a friend request from Zeeshan, a 22-year-old from a village in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir. Over the next year, their conversations turned into a daily ritual, until, one day, Zeeshan crossed the Line of Control to meet Iram. BASHAARAT MASOOD tells their story of love, longing and now, waiting

IRAM MAJEED'S phone buzzes with a message: "*Main pahunch chuka hoon* (I have arrived)." Half-awake, she tosses the phone away. A few seconds later, the same buzz. This time, it is a photograph — a frame from Silikote village, with its cellphone tower and slanted-tin roof houses. She sits up, startled. Zeeshan has got to be joking. He couldn't have come to Silikote, could he have? She reaches for her *dupatta*, tosses it over her head and runs — as she has never before.

Silikote, the last village on the Indian side of the Line of Control (LoC), is 10 km uphill from Uri town. From Iram's home in Tilawari village, Silikote is just a few hundred metres away, the cellphone tower and the Army bunkers at the edge of the village a familiar sight from her bedroom window. Few maps have charted the distance from Zeeshan's home, Pankedi, in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir's Muzaffarabad, to Silikote. But that morning, on May 31, he had managed to bridge that gap.

As Iram runs up to Silikote, the distance seems longer. She sweeps down the mountain, crosses a footbridge, and walks up the 2-km road to Silikote, pausing midway to catch her breath, the cool mountain air soothing her burning lungs. Thirty minutes later, her run ends at Silikote's guarded gates, as the soldiers step out to stop her.

Later that day, on May 31, the Army issued an announcement: An "intruder from Pakistan-occupied Kashmir" had been apprehended while he was crossing the LoC in Kashmir's Uri sector. The soldiers had maintained "restraint while challenging the intruder" and, later in the evening, handed the youth over to the police for "legal proceedings". They were convinced that he had "no hostile intent".

He was just hopelessly in love.

A message on Snapchat

There is a lot that can come between two young people — caste, communities, parents, religion, money. Or, as in the case of 22-year-olds Iram and Zeeshan, a dotted line on the map.

Iram grew up in Tilawari, in the border district of Uri, as the eldest of four children of Abdul Majeed, a municipal employee posted in Uri town, and homemaker Afroza Begum. Most mornings in Tilawari are unhurried, unless there is a landslide and everyone gathers to talk about it, or the air sirens go off in the event of cross-border firing. On all other days, Iram would walk 1.5 km downhill to reach the local Darul Uloom, where she is enrolled in a four-year course, and come back home to watch reruns of *CID* on television with her three younger sisters. But even in that full house, Iram would, every now and then, find a way to check her old Vivo smartphone for updates from Zeeshan.

On May 31, Zeeshan landed up at an Army bunker in Silikote. Officers say he turned himself in. "He took out his phone and identity card and handed them over," says a security officer

Zeeshan dropped out of school after Class 5 — at least that's what he told Iram. "I don't know if he said it as a joke to tease me or if it is the truth," she says. The youngest of five brothers, Zeeshan grew up in a family of farmers in PoK's Pankedi village. Unlike his farmer brothers, he worked at a cardboard packaging factory in Lahore.

It was a year ago that Zeeshan entered Iram's life — through a friend request on Snapchat. The two had never met, but their families had once been in touch, with a common relative even suggesting a marriage alliance. It was the mid-2000s, when relations between India and Pakistan were markedly better, when a cross-LoC bus service between Srinagar and Muzaffarabad had been launched as a confidence-building measure. But the 2019 Pulwama attack changed that. The bus, and the border, shut down, and with that, the only way for people on both sides to connect with each other.

But then, over time, another window opened up. The growing popularity of social media, particularly among youngsters, allowed snippets of life from both sides of the LoC to slip across the barbed fence.

Just as Zeeshan's friend request slid into Iram's phone on May 14, 2025.

The two got talking — initially about their shared links to Iram's village, Tilawari. Zeeshan told her that his grandfather had migrated from Tilawari to Pankedi village in PoK's Forward Kahuta sometime before 1947.

Soon, their conversations turned into a daily ritual they both looked forward to. "We exchanged stories and shared photographs... I can't really say when it happened, but before we knew it, we had fallen in love," says Iram.

Yet, Iram kept the conversations — and her budding relationship with Zeeshan — a secret from her family. Not even her best friend, Shaheena, knew. She was unsure how her parents and sisters would react if she told them. "Since I am the eldest, I am supposed to set an example for my siblings. But what can you do about love," she says.

They talked about "life here and life there... our dreams, our future". Soon, Zeeshan was talking about how he was yearning to visit her. "But I never imagined — not even for a moment — that he would try to cross the border," says Iram.

(Top) Iram at her home in Tilawari, Uri; a video grab of the couple being interrogated by Army personnel.

Such a long journey

Silikote, less than a kilometre from the Line of Control (LoC), can seem forbidding to an outsider. Layers of security, in the form of Army bunkers, line the road that cuts through the village. Movement is highly restricted and to cross the military bunkers, residents must carry specialised smart identity cards, which are verified by Army personnel. Over time, most residents have moved out of Silikote, leaving behind barely five to six households.

It was at one of the Army bunkers that Zeeshan landed up that day. Officers say he turned himself in. "He took out his phone and identity card and handed them over," says a security officer. The identity card, issued by Pakistan in August 2022, identified him as Zeeshan Mir, son of Lal Mir and a resident of "AJK State (Azad Jammu and Kashmir)".

Minutes later, Iram landed up at the same checkpoint. Zeeshan, who caught a glimpse of her before he was taken away, told the soldiers that he had come for Iram. For the next 15 minutes, as she stood outside the guarded gate, pacing between its two ends, Iram's heart pounded. Was Zeeshan in trouble? Was he injured, shot by the Army personnel, hit by a stray bullet perhaps?

The trail from PoK's Pankedi to Silikote passes through steep cliffs and dense forests that's home to black bears, Himalayan gorals and wild boars, with snow leopards in the higher elevations. Besides, soldiers from both sides patrol the area, their guns at the ready, scanning for intruders.

Just as her mind raced, something around her stirred. She looked up to see Zeeshan standing before her, smiling. "He was safe, completely unharmed. He was alive. That was all that mattered," she says.

The soldiers interrogated the couple. A video of the interrogation, shared by official sources, shows Zeeshan and Iram, sitting side by side, sharing their personal details — name, address, father's name. Iram appears unafraid, her arm locked defiantly into Zeeshan's.

"Zeeshan wouldn't let go of my hand. He kept saying, 'Stay here with me'. I didn't want him to get harmed in any way or feel lonely," she says later. "The officers asked me if I knew him, reviewed our messages and the photographs we had exchanged. They treated us well."

And then, in an unexpected act of grace, the soldiers looked the other way and granted the couple a few moments together.

For the next 10 minutes, Zeeshan told Iram about his journey. "He told me he had started from his village the previous evening (May 30). He was scared, but was excited about crossing over and meeting me. While crossing the fence, he says he came across a leopard. Luckily, it had prey in its mouth and walked away without harming him," says Iram.

Iram stayed with Zeeshan till it was time for the Army to hand him over to the police. She says she pleaded with the soldiers to let her accompany him to the police station, but they refused, calling her father instead to escort her home.

At the Uri station, police filed a case against Zeeshan under provisions of the Egress and Internal Movement (Control) Ordinance (EIMCO), a law that regulates who can enter, exit and travel within the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir.

"One look at him and you could tell that he is not a militant. He had crossed such dangerous terrain wearing just a pair of Peshawari chappals, a kurta and tight pants," laughs a police officer at the Uri station.

Two days later, Iram, accompanied by her mother, met Zeeshan in police custody. They spoke briefly, asking if the other was doing alright. "We couldn't talk much. He looked tired, but happy and hopeful. He kept saying he was happy to finally be on this side of Kashmir. I don't think he fully knew what it meant to cross the border," says Iram.

By evening that day, Zeeshan was moved to Central Jail, Baramulla. A month later, police filed a chargesheet in an Uri court and shifted Zeeshan to Uri jail. The trial in the case is set to start soon, at the end of which the court will decide whether Zeeshan can stay on in Tilawari or will have to be sent back across the LoC.

Iram says Zeeshan is insistent on staying back. "He told me and the policemen that if he is sent back, he will apply for a visa and come back," she says. "He told them he can't live anywhere but in Kashmir."

Officials say that in most cases, intruders who are not deemed a security threat are sent back. "There is a possibility that the court may allow him to stay back on humanitarian grounds. But the chances of deportation are always higher," says a police officer.

'How can they send him back?'

Iram now counts the days, waiting for some news about Zeeshan. "I wonder what got into him. He never hinted that he would get up one day and cross over. At least when we were chatting, he seemed very practical — he would say that he would apply for a visa and come here," she says.

Iram now counts the days, waiting for some news about Zeeshan. "I wonder what got into him. He never hinted that he would get up one day and cross over to this side," she says

She wonders if family expectations played a part in his decision to take the risk. "He often spoke about the pressures he faced at home. He would say that one of his brothers wanted him to contribute more to the household than he earned. There was also a lot of pressure on him to get married. All that may have left him disturbed," she says.

Following the May 31 incident, two soldiers arrived at Iram's home to gather more information about their relationship.

Sitting in the verandah of their two-storeyed house, Iram's mother Afroza Begum says, "Initially, we were angry with Iram. But then, an Army man intervened, pointed out that this boy had taken all this trouble just to be with her. Then, I thought, we must stand by them. I have four daughters, and I have always wished for a son. God has sent us one. We only hope he is released and allowed to stay here."

"How can they send him back? And even if they do, Zeeshan will come back. I am certain," says Iram.

You Go, Girl! But As Told

Shubhra Gupta

THE MUCH-AWAITED female-led edition of the YRF spy universe is finally here, and all I can say is that it isn't worth the wait.

Not because Alia Bhatt doesn't strain every sinew to play Alpha, her slight frame belying her skills as a highly trained fighting machine, nurtured by the numero uno soldier Fateh Singh (Bobby Deol). Not also because as Alpha's second-in-command, Sharvari isn't too bad herself, getting a few solo scenes in which she shows her moves.

Both Deol's *fauji* and Anil Kapoor's RAW chief are clearly working hard at their job description: the former who is convinced that Alpha is the answer to all weakness amongst the armed forces; the latter who wants to save her from all her enemies, whom she is oblivious to.

Here's a film telling us to believe that a lone female ranger can blow up a superstructure housing a mad scientist and will then meekly do what she's told?

What prevents *Alpha* from being a slick, smart spy thriller, which is what the intention clearly is, is that old YRF weakness: the writing is borrowed and stale, reminding us of numerous films we have seen before. Amongst the few nice touches is a brief appearance by Dia Mirza, as the mother of the brave Alpha, and manages to leave a mark. And some well-executed action sequences, in which Alia and Sharvari go bang-bang.

When there is RAW, there will be the enemies from across the border. There is, horrors, a Pakistani mole in our midst. Now when have we seen that before? There are patriotic Indian soldiers arrayed to keep the nation safe. A forgettable song-and-dance set in a sunny European destination is stuffed in clearly only because well-toned mid-riffs need: if you insist, maybe it needs to be better choreographed?

Some chunks are set in wet Cherrapunji — now that's a new one — but for the rest, the film takes us into usual dank offices in New Delhi with officials exchanging dire notes, and to scenic but familiar stretches in Rajasthan and Ladakh and Kashmir, with 'copters carrying troops, jeeps hoisting bazookas and fellows in fatigues shooting and scooting. No one speaks in lines, they lurch from one dialogue to another, while daddy issues and parental props come flooding in.

In a picturesque monastery, old YRF spy universe hand Kabir (Hrithik Roshan) shows up, to help the girls out. He is addressed, believe it or faint, as Monk *ji*. An action sequence featuring said monk and the girls ensues, which feels as if it took inspiration from a John Wick film. He instructs them, 'Now leave.' Other men, including the RAW chief, give them orders.

And that to me, that's the worst cut: here's a film which is telling us to believe that a lone female ranger is capable of blowing up a massive superstructure, housing a gigantic lab running a scheme thought up by a mad scientist type, and this highly trained assassin will then meekly do what she's told?

It would fit in if the film was going for the fun comic-book feel of *Pathaan*, where eye-rolls are served along with eye-watering high octane scenes, but *Alpha* asks us to take it seriously.

It ends up dull and dreary.

ALPHA
★½
DIRECTOR: Shiv Rawail
CAST: Alia Bhatt, Sharvari, Bobby Deol, Hrithik Roshan, Anil Kapoor, Dibyendu Bhattacharya, Dia Mirza

Minions on Mute

I HAD so much fun at the previous edition (*The Rise Of Gru*, 2022) of the banana-loving yellow blobs that I was all set for another fun ride. But this time around, the fun quotient gets buried under familiar stretches in which the minions squeak and squawk in tongues — French and Spanish accents — commingling with the cartoony voices of a starry star cast. And the entertaining bits and bobs, such as there are, come in only after a long meander.

Before we go any further, we have to tell you that this is a prequel to outlast all prequels, in which the minions go back to the beginning of the movies, to a time when there was only sight, no sound, with the orchestra playing in the pit, with smartly wrought glimpses of the early era stars, a Chaplin here, a Monroe there.

Anyone familiar with the franchise will know that the thing with the minions is that they are always looking for the 'Most Evil Person In The Universe' to take orders from. And this film is at its most scattered when they set out doing just that, stopping only when they fetch up in Hollywood, where, duh, 'Movies Are Made'. A director named Max, busy making career-saving moves, hires the minions to amp up his latest flick, which leads to, of course, the movie bug biting said critters good and proper.

So, of course, it is the Minions who now want to make their own movie. To that end, we are transported to the gigantic black and white sets of old-timey Hollywood studios, getting to watch glimpses of classics under production. On that note, the writers have had themselves a grand old time, bunging in mentions of silent classics — ooh, look, Buster Keaton — and once sound comes in — oh there's Humphrey in *Casablanca*. Movie nerds can geek out counting the references: there's also a wicked robot who falls in love with a pretty woman demanding voting rights for women. And George Lucas shows up as himself, asking plaintively to 'go home'.

Things perk up when the monsters make their entry, except they are also blobs but bigger, and the biggest one is a yellow coloured one called Irene, which has a million eyes, and oozes about, gobbling everything in sight. That's when all the frantic rushing around finds a purpose, and the planet is saved, yet again, by the minions who best the monsters. The pace picks up, so does the fun. Finally.

SHUBHRA GUPTA

MINIONS & MONSTERS
★★½
DIRECTOR: Pierre Coffin
CAST: Pierre Coffin, Trey Parker, Allison Janney, Christoph Waltz, Jesse Eisenberg, Jeff Bridges, Zoey Deutch, Phil LaMarr

In a Loop of Lazy

Shubhra Gupta

PEDRO IS the kind of go-get-'em cop whose worst nightmare is to be banished to the cyber crime cell. Pritam is a whizz at cracking codes, when not taking care of his elderly *dadaji*. When the former's worst fears come true, the latter becomes his go-to support, and off this boomer uncle-Gen Z duo go solving crimes in sunny Goa.

The six-episode show, Rajkumar Hirani's first OTT outing, has old hand Arshad Warsi teaming up with newbie Vir Hirani, who has had experience in being in his dad's productions: the two posed with each other in *Munnabhai MBBS*. Here, they make up two unlikely halves in a buddy caper, one being at sea upon encountering a keyboard (why QWERTY not ABCDE), and the other selling vacuum cleaners when not busy sleuthing. Why vacuum cleaners? No one tells us. It's Goa, anything goes, better not to ask.

You have to employ this same sentiment through the show, which tries to be both funnier and darker than it turns out to be. After cracking the dead easy who-stole-the-ATM-machine — a bunch of layabouts being the inept criminals — Pedro and Pritam find themselves up against a much tougher case: the young son of a blustering minister (Satyadeep Misra) has been kidnapped, but complications arise even as a ransom is raised, and things get murkier. Who's behind it? Is there only one, or are there two kidnappers? Is the minister's wife (Shruti Marathe) protesting too much?

If you look at *Pritam and Pedro* as operating within the cosy crime thriller genre, then it fits right within the Raju Hirani universe in which the baddies come with sad backstories and mitigating circumstances.

The director who has given us good-at-heart mobsters, stone-hearted doctors and greedy bankers, doesn't believe in pure monsters, and that is the USP of his films.

Now Avinash Arun, on the other hand, is aces at creating atmosphere and unmitigated evil, along with human drama (remember *Pataal Lok*, *School of Lies*). Whatever else Arun can do, the one thing I have never witnessed in his work, which includes *Killa* and *Three Of Us*, is blandness. In this one, the emotion is undercut by lax bits, and a handful of underwritten characters.

Take, for example, the dodgy guy hiding out in a beach house: he looks very much as if belongs to the Goan landscape, swigging beer by the beach, and buying his booze at a local hooch-shop, but is wholly unsuccessfully at menace. That comes from a mysterious guy (Vikrant Massey) in a hoodie, who hangs out in a high-tech den surrounded by screens and scrolls.

We also get to spend a bit of tepid time with a few other characters. Pedro's senior (Rajesh Gupta) keeps trying to save him from a top-cop's wrath; Pritam's *dadaji* (Vinod Nagpal, last seen in *Main Vaapas Aaunga*) is devastated at the loss of a two-in-one, which housed the voice of his beloved deceased wife; and Pedro's own musical wife (Mona Singh, criminally wasted in a tiny part) struggling with a painful past.

Munnabhai, aka Sanjay Dutt, shows up for a supportive blink-and-miss, as does a famous cricketer. And some amount of fun is had by Warsi doing the kind of man who works best on his feet but hates being tied down to his desk: this is an actor whom I enjoy watching, even when he is made to be a tech-challenged ignoramus here than is believable. As for Vir as the computer geek hiding a dark secret: we don't miss him when he's off the screen.

'You know the password no one can crack,' says Pedro solemnly. 'What,' asks Pritam, equally seriously. '12345,' says the former. That's called not trying too hard at all. Which is what I can say for the entire show.

PRITAM AND PEDRO
★★
DIRECTOR: Avinash Arun
CAST: Arshad Warsi, Vir Hirani, Vikrant Massey, Satyadeep Misra, Naina Sareen, Shruti Marathe, Vinod Nagpal, Mona Singh, Rajesh Sharma, Ajay Madhok, Boman Irani
STREAMING ON: JioHotstar

When Revenge is Best Served Silent

Shubhra Gupta

BABY DO, sure. Baby Die, okay. But *Baby Do Die Do*? Can there be a clunkier title? Or is it plain kinky?

I went into the theatre wondering what I was in for, and I'm happy to report that fans of *desi*-style Korean actioners are in for a treat: Huma Qureshi playing a deaf-mute contract killer comes up with an implacable stare, and a weapon hiding in plain sight, as she goes about decimating her victims one after another, getting support from a solid ensemble.

The grey-blue screen, the acid rain, the frequent pull-backs to give us a panoramic view of Mumbai at night, people clawing their way up in *chawls* and high-rises, and the things they do in the dark when no one's looking: in this Sion-via-Seoul aesthetic, which the film commits to completely, no punches pulled, and the pace rarely flags.

There's a backstory to Baby (Huma Qureshi) and her doings. Of course, there is. Childhood trauma involving the murder of a twin sister, coupled with adept adult grooming, even as she is surrounded by people who are as stuck as she is, lead her into becoming a killer for hire.

Baby has a bed-ridden mother whose unhappiness is expressed in no uncertain terms, flinging glasses of water on the ground, saying that she has been left with the 'wrong one'. A *payal* that her dead sister wore is carried around like a *talisman*. A fatherly figure (Chunky Panday) gives her the affection she misses at home; a brother-from-another-mother, learning the ropes of the *dhandha*, is the *bhai* she never had.

This creation of a criminal family which isn't related by blood is an old trope, but refreshed well here: what they are up against is the underbelly of the city, comprising hard-nosed builders and their goons, businessman rivals and their wives, corrupt cops on their rounds. Again, figures we have seen in mob movies (Ram Gopal Varma comes to mind) but given distinct outlines here.

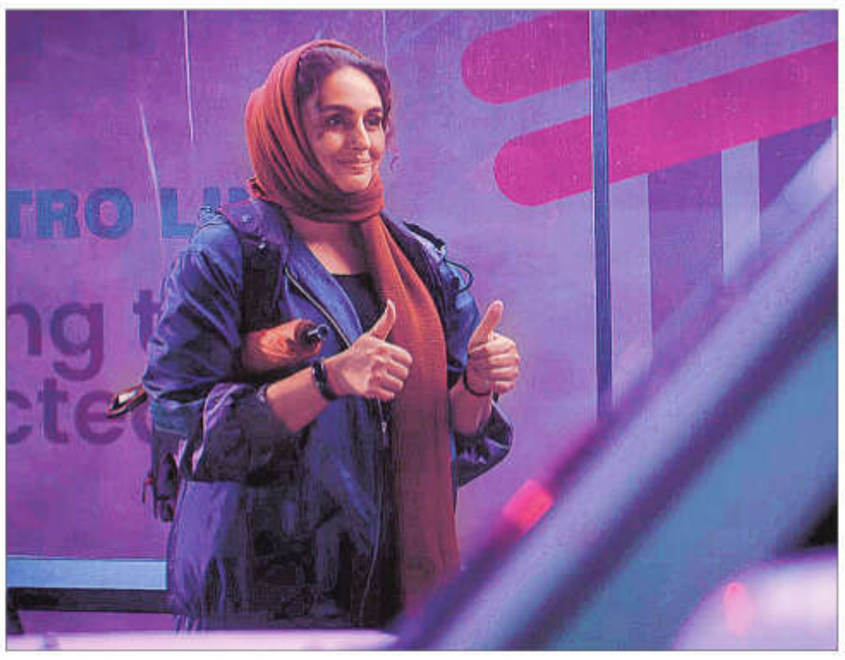
One of the best realised segments belongs to Baby and the man who is in love with her. Siddhu (Rachit Singh), who had come to Mumbai with bigger dreams, is now content with teaching the *chawl* youngsters their notes, even as he yearns for Baby. This is a felt romance, and gives this grimy, grim film a much-needed softness.

There are a couple of confused, contrived patches, and the big reveals towards the end aren't really as well hidden as the film thinks they are. But those aren't deal breakers: the writers — Jasmeet K Reen (*Darlings*), Parveez Shaikh and Nachiket Samant (*Single Salma*) have done a good job in not letting us fall out of the movie.

A sequence set in a gay nightclub, with a raunchy shake-shake led by Saqib Saleem Qureshi, is striking. Helping good actors break out of a mould is also something on display here: Seema Pahwa as a seasoned cop, making the rounds of her city, is a sight, as is Sikandar Kher as a guy who wants more, as well as Chunky Panday, who does benevolence laced with something extra, amongst others.

Qureshi, her eyelashes artfully and spikily done, her face unvarnished and set, leads from the front, as she hunts down her victims and long-ago killer. Anyone looking for a fast-paced revenge drama, in which the city is a character, as grasping as the humans, here's your film.

BABY DO DIE DO
★★★½
DIRECTOR: Nachiket Samant
CAST: Huma Qureshi, Chunky Panday, Sikandar Kher, Seema Pahwa, Vidya Malvade, Rachit Singh



Baby Do Die Do fully commits to a Sion-via-Seoul aesthetic, no punches pulled, and the pace rarely flags

• STREAMING WATCHLIST

Half Man
LIONSGATE PLAY

EMMY-WINNING creator Richard Gadd returns with *Half Man*, a series that delves into a layered story about two men tied together by brotherhood and a past that refuses to stay buried. When Niall's estranged 'brother' Ruben shows up at his wedding, it leads to violence that catapults us back through their lives. Spanning almost 40 years, *Half Man* covers the highs and lows of the brothers' lives.

Enola Holmes 3
NETFLIX

MILLIE BOBBY Brown is back as Sherlock Holmes's equally brilliant sister in *Enola Holmes 3*. It follows the young detective as she tackles another mystery, this time in Malta. As Enola heads to the altar to wed Lord Tewkesbury, she learns the distressing news that Sherlock has been kidnapped. The gumshoe is immediately on the case, all while grappling with her complicated feelings around marriage.

Elle
PRIME VIDEO

THIS SPIN-OFF of *Legally Blonde* takes audiences back to 1995, long before Elle Woods walked into Harvard. Between complicated friendships, first love, family expectations and questionable fashion choices, the series explores the experiences that shaped the confident, optimistic young woman audiences first met in *Legally Blonde*. The series stars Lexi Minetree, June Diane Raphael and Tom Everett Scott among others.

Super Subbu
NETFLIX

IN THIS comedy of errors, Subramanyam 'Subbu' Chillukuri Rao is posted to the one place no teacher wants to go: the village of Maakipur. Subbu arrives, only to be handed the village's most awkward assignment: teaching sex education. Armed with little to no experience but plenty of good intentions, Subbu has to navigate misunderstandings and unlikely friendships as he attempts to teach the villagers that even "no beans no" is a full sentence.

Project Hail Mary
PRIME VIDEO

PROJECT HAIL Mary follows Ryland Grace (Ryan Gosling), who wakes up on a spaceship light years from home with no recollection of who he is or how he got there. As his memory returns, he begins to uncover his mission: solve the riddle of the mysterious substance causing the sun to die out. The film is directed by Phil Lord and Christopher Miller.

ALAKA SAHANI

CLASSIFIEDS & TENDERS

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,Ankita Dixit W/o Madhur Dixit R/o B-15, Sector-71, Noida-201304, have changed my name from Ankita Dixit to Ankita Kala. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Ankita Kala for all future purposes. 0040863971-3

I,hitherto known as ABHAWYA CHITKARA,W/O-PARAS SIKKA,R/O-1010, POCKET-A/SEC-A,VASANT-KUNJ,VASANT-KUNJ,S.O,DIST:SOUTH-WEST-DELHI, DELHI-110070,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME AND SHALL HEREAFTER BE KNOWN AS ABHAWYA SIKKA. 0040864029-8

I,DEEPESH KUMAR MITTAL S/o KARAM CHAND MITTAL R/o-D-15/175-176, 2ND FLOOR,SECTOR-3,ROHINI,DELHI-110085 have Changed my name to DEEPESH MITTAL. 0040864014-3

I,SHASHI KALA W/O-NARESH CHANDOLIYA R/O-C-121/B, NEAR TAAR FACTORY, VISHWAS PARK,UTTAM NAGAR,NEW DELHI-59, inform that SHASHI KALA and SHASHI CHANDOLIA, both are one and the same person. 0040863924-3

I,Naresh Gola,S/o Sh.Om Prakash Gola,R/o H.No-1111,Sector-15 Part-II,Gurugram,Haryana 122001,have changed my name from Naresh Kumar Gola to Naresh Gola,for all,future purposes. 0040864029-1

I, Ansika Gupta W/o Vipul Gupta, R/o G-501, Rashmi Appartments, Pitampura, Harsh Vihar, Delhi-110034. have changed my name to Anshika Gupta for all future purposes. 0040863973-1

I, hitherto known as Arhaan bhat S/o Shishir Jana R/o Plot No. 4, Harijan Colony,Sector-43, Distt. Gurugram Haryana, have changed my name and shall hereafter beknown as Samiya Jana. I have changed my name not my religion. 0071045669-1

I Rajesh Kumar S/o Parsuram R/o H. No. 103, Block-C, Prem Nagar, Nagafgarh SouthWest Delhi-110043, I have changed the name of my minor son Shailander to Salendar aged 17 years. 0071045562-1

I,Noor Ahmad S/o.Mohammad Maqsood R/o.2235,Gali Dakotan Turkman Gate Delhi-110006,have changed my name to NOOR AHMED permanently. 0040864029-10

I Akella Subba Laxmi , Alias Akella Subba Lakshmi , Alias Laxmi A S , Alias Laxmi L S , D/o A V Suryanarayana W/o Lakkavajjala Bala Subrahmanya Venkatarama Vara Prasad R/o D-908, Splendour Apartments, Near UMCC Hospital, Gajularamaram Qutubullapur, K.V. Rangareddy, Telangana - 500055, have changed my name to Lakkavajjala Subba Laxmi 0071045639-1

I,SUBHASH CHANDRA,S/o Sh.DWARIKA PRASAD DIMRI R/o-Flat.no.F-308, Alaknanda Apartment,Rampuri Surya-Nagar,Chander-Nagar,Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201011,have Changed my Name,from SUBHASH DIMRI to SUBHASH CHANDRA,for all Purposes. 0040864014-5

I Arvind Kumar S/o-Late Prem Chand Gupta R/o-A-59, Gali-No.4, Badli Extension,North Delhi-110042 have-changed my-name to Arvind Kumar Gupta for all-purposes. 0040863920-1

I,Main Pal Singh,S/o Late.SH.Dharamveer Singh,R/o-Mohalla Lepran,Village+Post Office-Sisauli,PS Bora Kallan,District-Muzaffarnagar,State-Utter Pradesh-251319,have changed my name to Men Pal Singh,for all future purposes. 0040863904-1

I,TAFSEER,S/O-FAIYAZ AHMAD,F-196,Ground Floor,Dilshad Colony, Jhilmil, East Delhi,Delhi-110095,has changed my name to TAFSEER AHMAD permanently for all future purpose. 0040864029-3

I, Pauitri Devi W/o No 4053032 Rank Ex SEPOY Rajendra Prasad R/o Plot -593, Flat - F2, Shalimar Garden- Ext. -1 Sahibabad, Dist: Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh-201005 have changed my name to Pavetri Devi vide affidavit date 2-7-26 before Delhi. 0071045585-1

I,Bhagwan Dass Choudhary,S/o Sh.Munna Lal,R/o-4/16C,DDA,Slum Janta-Flats,Sarai-Kale Khan,Hazrat Nizamuddin,delhi-110013,have changed my name Bhagwan Das Chaudhary to Bhagwan Dass Choudhary,for all purpose 0040863966-2

I,RASHMI KUMARI,W/O,SUSHIL KUMAR MISHRA,R/O G-210,EAST AVENUE APPARTMENT,SECTOR-73,NOIDA,GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH - 201301,have changed my name to RASHMI MISHRA. 0040864029-12

I Shah Nawaz S/o Shamsul Haque R/o Village Bahuara, Post Bishunpur Mahanand, PS Kanti, District Muzaffarpur, Bihar- 843109, have changed my name to Mohammad Shahnawaz 0071045644-1

I,Sona D/o Hira singh R/o D-17,Mansarovar park Shahdara,Delhi-110032,Have Changed My Name To Sona Kaur for all future purpose 0040864014-7

I,Gopesh alias Gopesh Kumar,S/o-Ashish Kumar,R/o-E-2/3,Shastri Nagar Po-Ashok Vihar Delhi-110052,have changed,my name and,shall hereafter be known,as Gopesh Gurditta,for all purposes. 0040864029-5

I,KRISHNA NAND CHAUHAN,S/O-SHRI BHAGWAN SINGH CHAUHAN,R/O H.NO-28,BLOCK-O,SOURABH-VIHAR JAIT PUR SOUTH,DELHI-110044,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO KRISHANA NAND CHAUHAN. 0040864017-5

I, Shivram Gopal S/o L.S.Gopal Krishnan R/o-A1/002, Purvanchal Royal Park, Sector-137, Noida have changed my name to Shivram Gopal Iyer. 0071045612-1

I, Hamanshu Kawatra S/o Gopal Dass Kawatra R/o S2-302, 3rd Floor, Tower-S-2, Eldeco Aamantran, Sector-119, inform that in my Passport no L8326183, Mine, My father name & Mother name has wrongly mentioned as Hamanshu, Gopal Dass & Kamlesh instead of Hamanshu Kawatra , Gopal Dass Kawatra & Kamlesh Kawatra. 0040864012-1

I Surender Kumar alias Surender R/o 11 F-6, 2nd Floor, Near Town Square-2, Sector-82, PO: Sikanderpur, Gurgaon, Haryana-122004 have changed my name to Surender Sharma 0071045544-1

I, Surinder Kaur Rakhra w/o Palvinder Singh Rakhra R/o 34E, MIG Flats, Mayapuri, Delhi-110064 have changed my name to SURINDER KAUR 0040863914-1

I, KARTIK KUMAR JANGID S/o KISHOR KUMAR R/o B-107 S/F, GALI NO-3, NORTH CHAJJUPUR, GOKAL PUR, PO: GOKAL PURI, DELHI-110094 have changed my name to KARTIK KUMAR VASHISHTHA for all purposes. 0071045566-1

I,SHALU W/O-KARAN KAUSHIK,R/O-HOUSE NO.107 2ND FLOOR,JEEWAN NAGAR,DELHI-110014,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHALU CHOUHAN FOR ALL PURPOSES 0040864038-2

I, Sonu S/o Mohd Furkan, R/o House No. C-63-D, Third Floor, D D A Flats, ShivajiEnclave, Raghubir Nagar, Vtc: Tagore Garden, Po: Tagore Garden, District: West Delhi,State: Delhi -110027, have changed my name to Sonu Salmani. 0071045661-1

I,ARUSHI D/o Vipin Gautam R/o-C-8/250 Sector-8,Rohini Delhi-110085 have changed my name to ARUSHI SHARMA 0040864014-2

I,Ishaq Khan,S/o-Maqbool,R/o-H.No.787,Pragati-Marg,Hindon Vihar,Ghaziabad,U.P.201001,have changed my name,from Ishaq Khan to Mohammad Ishaq.Ishaq Khan and Mohammad Ishaq are one and the same-person.My-mother's name is Zubeda,and my-wife's name is Samina. 0040864014-9

I,Madhur S/o Rajender Kumar Sharma R/o B-15, Sector-71, Noida-201304, have changed my name from Madhur to Madhur Dixit. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Madhur Dixit for all future purposes. 0040863971-2

I,Jai Rangi,D/o-Kanwar Singh Chhillar,R/o-209/2,Padam Nagar,Street no.5 Delhi-7,have changed,my name,from Jai Chiller,to Jai Rangi,for all purposes,after marriage to Vivek Rangi,S/o-Ram Narayan,R/o-615 Sector-22-A,Gurugram,Haryana. 0040864029-7

I Samriddha Lodh Alias Samriddha Sengupta Lodh Alias Sammriddhya Lodh Alias Sammriddhya Sengupta Lodh D/o Samar Lodh and W/o Sumanta Sengupta R/o 5/1 Nischintapur Lane, Santipur, Nadia, West Bengal - 741404, have changed my name to Sammriddhya Sengupta Lodh 0071045628-1

I,NARESH CHANDOLIYA S/O-KUNDAN LAL R/O-C-121/B, NEAR TAAR FACTORY, VISHWAS PARK,UTTAM NAGAR,NEW DELHI-59, inform that NARESH CHANDOLIYA, NARESH KUMAR CHANDOLIYA and NARESH KUMAR, all are one and the same person. 0040863924-2

I, Jaswinder w/o Jitender Kumar R/o CA-21-C, DDA Flats, Hari Nagar, Delhi-110064 have changed my name to JASVINDER KAUR 0040863914-3

I,Yash Kumari Sharma, R/o 133-A,Pocket-C,Siddharth Ext,Delhi-110014,declare Yash Kumari Sharma & Yash Sharma are same person.Henceforth known as Yash Sharma. 0040864018-2

I Pradeep Singh S/O Rajender R/O H. No.2155,Sector 12,Sonipat, Haryana- 131001 Have Changed My Name Pradeep Singh To Pardeep Singh Permanently. 0040863970-1

I,Shikha Gulati D/o surinder Gulati R/o F-13/9A, Krishna Nagar,Delhi-110051, have changed My name to Shikha Gohri For all Purposes 0040864014-11

I, hitherto known as Tejpal S/o Shiv Kumar, R/o B-5/102, Nand Nagri, VTC: NandNagri, District: North East, State: Delhi-110093, have changed my name and shallhereafter be known as Tarun. 0071045561-1

I,Mohammad Asad,s/o.Ghulam Nabi,R/o.5417,Unchi Gali,Kucha Rehman, Chandni-Chowk,Delhi-110006,have changed my name to MOHD ASAD permanently 0040864029-9

I, Yalamudi Goutham S/o Yalamudi Krishnaiah R/o Door Number 6-2, M M Tower jammibanda khammam Telangana 507001, have changed my minor son's name from Yalamudi Viraansh Aged 02 Years to Yalamudi Jai Viraansh forever 0071045635-1

I, Bhooma W/o Yam Bahadur R/o 281/D-2, Ward No.2, Mehrauli, Delhi-110030, have changed my name to Bhooma Khatri. 0040864014-4

I, Mohit Chugh, S/o Late Sh.Harbhagwan Chugh, R/o A-1/6B Keshav Puram Lawrence Road Delhi-35 have changed my minor daughter's name from Keertana to Keertana Chugh for all purposes 0040863923-1

I,Sajani Modak father of Hav Sanjib Kumar Modak, resident of Vill-Jhapusabari,PT-V,PO- South Jhapusabari,Teh- Agomani,Dist-Dhubri,State-Assam,pin-783335,have changed my Name from Sajani Modak to Sajani Kanta Modak.vide affidavit dated-30/06/2026,before Shashi Thakur,Advocate,Delhi Area-NCT,Delhi. 0040864017-1

I Virender Rana S/o Bhagwan Singh Rana R/o H.No. 54, Rehre Wali Gali, Zindpur, North West Delhi, Delhi - 110036 have changed the name of my minor daughter from Hunny to Himani for all purposes. 0040863907-2

I, Narasa Ram,S/o Ghuni Devi,R/O Pothedi Rasta,Ruchiyar-Bhagal Seeta,Jalore,Rajasthan-343029,have changed my name to Naresh Kumar for all future purposes. 0040864029-2

I, Yasoda Devi W/o No 1534201K Rank HONY NK Raghunath Singh R/o F-527, Ram Park Vistar, Loni Dehat Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh - 201102 have changed my name to Yashoda Devi vide affidavit date 2-7-26 before Delhi. 0071045581-1

I,kapil Choudhary,S/o Sh.Bhagwan Dass choudhary,R/o-4/16C,DDA,Slum Janta-Flats,Sarai Kale Khan,Hazrat Nizamuddin,delhi-110013,have changed my name Kapil to kapil Choudhary,for all purpose 0040863966-1

I,Mohd Shah Fasal,S/o.Abdul Aziz R/o.303,Gali No.11,Kardampuri Bistar, Ashrfiya Masjid,Pur Shahdara,North East Delhi-110094,have changed my name to MOHD SHAH FAISAL,permanently 0040864029-11

I Devshree Jitpure D/o Asharam Jitpure and W/o Arun Azad R/o Genhubarsa, Betul, Madhya Pradesh-460668, have changed my name to Devshree Azad 0071045643-1

I,SUMAN RANI,W/o Jitender Kumar R/o 3891 A,Gali No.13,Kanhaiya-Nagar, Tri Nagar,Onkar Nagar,Delhi-110035, have changed my name to SUMAN permanently. 0040864014-6

I, Chandan Ram Arya S/o, Prem Ram Arya R/o 16-C , 2nd Floor Vijay Mandal Enclave New Delhi -110016 have changed my name to Chani Ram Arya for all purposes 0040863919-1

I,Iran Fatma W/o Sher Mohammad R/o Q-26, Gali No-19 Brahampuri,Delhi-110053,inform that Iran Fatma & Iram Fathma both name are of one and same person 0040863949-1

I,SAMEER RAWAL,S/o-N M RAWAL R/o House.No.105,1st Floor,Pocket-8,Sector-21 Rohini,Delhi-110086,have changed my minor daughter name YASHVI aged-14-years to YASHVI RAWAL 0040864029-4

I Akash Kumar S/o Sunil Kumar R/o RZ-M-50, Flat No-A-3, 3rd Floor, Front Side, Vijay Enclave Palam, Palam Village, Delhi- 110045, have changed my name to Manish Kumar 0071045601-1

I M.A. Azad S/o Raza R/o H.No. D-31 New Seelampur, Delhi-110053 have changed My name from M.A. Azad to Mohd Ajaz Azad for all future purposes. 0071045543-1

I, Ranajit Singh S/o Pramod Singh, R/o E-2/13, Gali No.3, 5th Pusta, Sonia Vihar, Delhi-94, do here by declare that Ranajit Singh and Ranjeet Kumar are the one and same person. Henceforth, I have changed my name from Ranajit Singh to Ranjeet Kumar for future purposes. 0040863915-1

I, hitherto known as Anirudh Kumar Verma S/o Satish Kumar Verma R/o 113 Savarkar Apartments I.P. Extension, Delhi Pin: 110092, Delhi,India,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Anirudh Verma. 0071045564-1

I,KHUSHI AGGARWAL,W/o Vaibhav Agarwal,R/o M-58, Residence,Greater Kailash Part-1, Delhi-110048,have changed my name to KHUSHI AGARWAL,for all future purposes. 0040864038-1

I Punam Chandel W/O Varun Pratap Singh R/O 30 Block A Omiron 1A Greater Noida Dist Gautam Buddha Nagar-201310 have changed my minor daughter name from Rudrani Singh Kachhwani to Samriddhi Singh Kachhwah. 0130066444-1

I,km.Rajani W/o Pramod Butola R/o-415,pocket -6-II nd, Sector-2,Rohini,Delhi-110085.have changed my,name to Rajni Butola,for all future,purposes. 0040864014-8

I,Vijay Lakhanpal S/o Updesh Krishan Lakhanpal R/o 11094, ATS One Hamlet, Sector-104, Noida(U.P) have changed my name to Vijay Kumar Lakhanpal for all future purposes. 0040863971-1

I,Mohd Shan E Qadir,S/o-Maqsood Ali,R/o-100,Block-313,Tulsi Nagar,Onkar Nagar Delhi-110035,have changed,my name,and shall hereafter be known,as Mohammad Shan E Qadir,for all,future purposes 0040864029-6

I, Vijay Chikhale S/o Madhavrao Seshrao Chikhale, Flat-1304, Tower-3, Lutus Panache, Sector-110, Noida, UP-201304 have changed my name to Vijay Madhavrao Chikhale. 0071045615-1

I,YOGITA SHARMA,D/O-NARENDAR KUMAR SHARMA,residing at,CV7-304,SUPERTECH CAPETOWN, SECTOR-74,NOIDA,UTTAR PRADESH-201301,have changed my name From YOGITA SHARMA to YOGITA VASHISHTHA,for all,future purposes. 0040864014-1

I, Ritender Kumar S/o Zile Singh R/o H. No. 162, Vasant Enclave, Vasant Vihar-1 SouthWest Delhi-110057, I have changed the name of my minor Son Hariakul to Oviyaanaged 1 years. 0071045667-1

I,Anchal Sirohi W/o Sandeep Sirohi R/o C-1/8,RAMA VIHAR,Mohammad Pur Majri,North West Delhi, Delhi-110081,have changed my name from Anchal to Anchal Sirohi for all future purposes. 0040864018-1

I, Tamnna Pokhriyal D/o No 4078036K Rank Ex NK Anil Kumar R/o 364 R P S, D D A Flat Mansarover Park, Shahdara, Delhi-110032 have changed my name to Tamanna Pokhriyal vide affidavit date 2-7-26 before Delhi. 0071045573-1

I, Jitender s/o Dharam Pal R/o CA-21-C, DDA Flats, Hari Nagar, Delhi-110064 have changed my name to JITENDER KUMAR 0040863914-2

I, Kunal S/o Kishore Kumar, R/o E-576 J J Colony, Raghubir Nagar, VTC: Tagore Garden S.O, PO: Tagore Garden S.O, District West Delhi, State Delhi-110027, have changed my name to Kunal Masson. 0071045663-1

I Subash chand s/o Niranjan Dass Suri R/o -110-A, Rani Garden,East Delhi-10031, have changed my name to Subhash Chander Suri,For all Purposes 0040864014-10

I,VIMAL RAINA,S/O VISHAMBER NATH RAINA,R/O H-4/30,FIRST FLOOR, SECTOR-11,ROHINI,DELHI-110085,have changed my name to VIMAL VISHAMBER RAINA. 0040864017-6

I,Anu Bala Vermani W/o Pradeep Ranawat,R/o-H.No.166,Third Floor,Gali No.-4,Master Block,Shakarpur,Delhi-110092,have changed my name to Anu Ranawat,for all Purposes. 0040864017-8

I,Rekha D/o-Ram Kanwar,W/o-Ram Avtar Rana,R/o-B-213,New Palam-Vihar Phase-2,40,Feet Road,Choma(62),Gurugram (Haryana)-122017,have changed my name to Rekha Rana,for all Purposes 0040864017-10

I,Shazia Rashid Rehman W/o Rashid Rehman R/o 91,Gagan-Vihar, Karkari-Mod, Vikas-Marg,Krishna-Nagar,East-Delhi-110051,have changed my-name to Shazia Rehman. 0040864017-12

I,HARNISH BEDI,S/o-RAJESH BEDI,R/o,A-38,39 HIMGIRI-ENCLAVE CHANDER VIHAR,NILOTHI EXTN NANGLOI DELHI 110041,have changed the name to HARNISH SINGH BEDI. 0040864017-7

I,AYUSHI GOEL,W/O-AKSHIT JINDAL,R/O-D-37 UPPER,GROUND FLOOR ANAND VIHAR,EAST DELHI 110092 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO AYUSHI JINDAL 0040864017-3

I,NARYAN DASS,S/o AMAR SINGH,R/0-186A,Gali-5,Block-D,Mukund-Vihar, Karawal-Nagar,North East-Delhi,Delhi-110094,declare that name of mine and my-wife has been wrongly-written as NARAYAN DAS and MANJANA KUMARI in my minor son SACHIN THAKUR, aged-16-years in his 10th Class Educational Documents.The actual-name of mine and my wife are NARYAN DASS and MANJANA, which may be amended accordingly. 0040864017-13

I,Gian Devi D/o Budh Ram,W/o Sh.Ashok Kumar,R/o-House.No.194,Ward No.11,Barwala(Rural)(128),Hisar,(Haryana)-125121,have changed my name to Gyan Devi for all Purposes. 0040864017-9

I,MUKESH JINDAL,S/O-DEVI PRASAD GUPTA,R/O D-37,UPPER GROUND FLOOR ANAND-VIHAR EAST,DELHI 110092,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MUKESH KUMAR GUPTA. 0040864017-2

I,Mohammed Nuh Rehman,S/o-Rashid Rehman,R/o 91,Gagan-Vihar, Karkari-Mod, Vikas-Marg, Krishna-Nagar,East-Delhi-110051,have changed my-name to Muhammad Nuh Rehman. 0040864017-11

I,AASHISH BHATNAGAR,S/O-ASHOK BHATNAGAR,R/O C-5,SECOND FLOOR PLOT NO-162 GYAN KHAND 1 INDIRAPURAM GHAZIABAD 201014,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ASHISH BHATNAGAR. 0040864017-4

I, Saanvi Krishnan (Father's name Ramakrishnan Krishnan) R/o B-44, Second Floor, Gulmohar Park, New Delhi 110049 have changed my name to Savitr Sriniv Krishnan for all purposes as per affidavit dated June 24, 2026 notarised by Advocate Sanjay Kumar Singh, New Delhi (Regn number 51053). 0040863259

I,Taufeeq Elahi s/o Late Tarif Elahi R/o HN NO-335-B,2nd Floor,Katra Budhan Rai, Bazar Delhi Gate,Darya Ganj,New Delhi-110002,Declare That My Father name Has Been Wrongly Written AS Tariq Elahi in my 10th marksheet and passport no-P6654809,The Correct Name Of My Father is Tarif Elahi. 0040863497-1

LOST & FOUND

I, Rohtash Kumar S/o Gyan Singh and Mukesh W/o Rohtash Kumar R/o House No. C-074, Pocket P-3, Greater Noida, G.B Nagar, U.P. We have lost our Allotment Intimation Letter dated 26/06/96. Possession Certificate dated 03/01/07. Allotment No. R01-39210 related Transfer dated 6/5/98. Allocation of specific Plot Number to the Allottees of R01 Residential Scheme dated 06-11-98. 0071045560-1

LOST original title documents, including the complete chain of Sale Deeds and other related ownership documents, pertaining to: Property No. 9/46, Geeta Colony, Delhi - 110031, standing in the name of Mr. Raj Kumar Gulyani, S/o Late Shri Harish Chand Gulyani; and Shop No. 436, Jheel Khuranja, Delhi - 110051, standing jointly in the names of Mr. Raj Kumar Gulyani and Mrs. Neelam Gulyani as co-owners. NCR/complaint regarding the loss of the said documents has already been filed vide NCR/DD No. 70019136/2026 dated 18.06.2026 at PS Geeta Colony/ ePolice station. Finder please contact on 9810070765. 0071045545-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby, informed to the General Public that I, Dr Chandeep Singh R/o E-148 Classic Apartments Plot No. 11, Sector 22 Delhi 110075 dated 3rd July 2026, S/o – Mr. Harjit Singh have lost the Original Provisional Allotment Letter (PAL) no.46260/386427/BS204A1402 dated 16th July 2013 in respect of Plot/ Apartment (Unit) bearing no. BS204A1402 in JAYPEE GREENS SPORTS CITY EAST projects at Jaypee Greens, Anyone finding the said documents is requested to kindly return the same to the Company or to me.in City on dated

Name: Dr Chandeep Singh

Address: E-148 Classic Apartments Plot No. 11, Sector 22 Delhi 110075

Phone No.: 9810561829

Email Id: drchandeepsingh

PUBLIC NOTICE

Information is given to general public at large upon instruction from Mr. Akash Garg & Mr. Suraj Garg who are the owners of Plot No. 6/4, area measuring 239.25 sq. mtrs. (northern side), situated at Scheme No. 6, Sector-4, Jagriti Vihar, Meerut, Uttar Pradesh, 250004 who was the owner through from Sale Deed dated 26.10.2020 executed by Mr. Ravindra Kumar Jindal in favour of Mr. Akash Garg & Mr. Suraj Garg in respect of the northern portion area measuring 239.25 sq. mtrs., Document NO. 7259 who was the owner through Gift Deed dated 13.06.2011 executed by Mrs. Mayavati in favour of Mr. Ravindra Kumar Jindal in respect of the northern portion area measuring 239.25 sq. mtrs. Document No. 5950 read with Freehold Deed dated 16.5.2015 executed between Uttar Pradesh Evam Vikas Parishad in favour of Mr. Pradeep Kumar & Mr. Ravinder Kumar Jindal in respect of Plot No.6/4, area measuring 478.50 sq. mtrs., situated at Scheme No. 6, Sector-4, Jagriti Vihar, Meerut, Uttar Pradesh vide Doc. No. 4206. Any person(s), institution(s) having any claim and/or objection in respect of the said property shall communicate the same to the undersigned at our address within 14 days from the publication of this notice with documentary evidence in support thereof, failing which all the claim, of such person(s)/ institution(s) shall not be binding upon the said property or Godrej Finance Limited.

Mohd K. Hussain (Advocate)
D-21, Basement, Block-D, Jangpura Extn. New Delhi-110014, 8810391672

सार्वजनिक सूचना

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि मेरे मुवक्किल श्री सतपाल शर्मा पुत्र स्व०. देवीदत्त शर्मा एवं श्रीमती दयावती देवी पत्नी श्री सतपाल शर्मा दोनों निवासी B-281 Upper Ground Floor गली न0.14, तोमर कालोनी बुराड़ी, दिल्ली-110084 ने अपने पुत्र अरुण शर्मा उम्र करीब 22 वर्ष को उसके गलत संगत एवं गलत आचरण के कारण अपनी समस्त चल-अचल सम्पत्ति आदि से बेदखल कर सारे सम्बंध समाप्त कर लिया है। कोई भी व्यक्ति जो अरुण शर्मा से किसी भी प्रकार का कोई लेन-देन या संबन्ध इत्यादि रखता है वह उसके लिए स्वयं जिम्मेदार होगा, भविष्य में अरुण शर्मा के किसी भी प्रकार के सिविल एवं क्रिमिनल कार्य आदि के लिए मेरे मुवक्किल जिम्मेदार नहीं होंगे।

SANJEEV JAIN (Advocate)
Enrl. No.D/226/1991

PUBLIC NOTICE

This Notice is in continuation of Public Notice issued in Indian Express & Jansatta on 03.07.2026 (edition), on behalf of Mr. Nand Lal for First Floor (Back Side), without roof rights, of Property No. RZ-220, 221 & 220-A whereby a minor revision has been made in the last line of last para of the notice where the name of Godrej Finance Limited was wrongly mentioned and the same shall be read without **Godrej Finance Limited.** That the remaining contents of the said public notice shall remain same without any changes.

Mohd K. Hussain (Advocate)
D-21, Basement, Block-D, Jangpura Extn. New Delhi-110014, 8810391672

PUBLIC NOTICE

Information is given to general public at large upon instruction from Madhu Khurana & Subhash Khurana who intends to purchase Ground Floor & Basement Floor of Shop Plot No.16, Block-M, area measuring 195 sq. yds., in the residential colony known as Greater Kailash-II, situated at village Bahapura, Delhi-110048 from Mr. Manu Mago, Mr. Surinder Nath Mago, Mr. Kewal Krishan Mago, Mrs. Saroj Mago and Mr. Vivek Mago who are the owners through Will dated 06.10.1995 executed by Mr. Dilbagh Rai Mago in favour of Manu Mago as owner of ¼ share of property No.M-16, Greater Kailash, New Delhi along with Mrs. Archana Mago and Mrs. Archana Mago and Manu Mago and Mrs. Archana Mago and Manu Mago with respect to other properties read with Mutation Letter dated 04.02.1986 issued by MCD in the name of Mr. Dilbagh Rai Mago, Mr. Surinder Nath Mago, Mr. Kewal Krishan Mago & Mr. Satish Kumar Mago consequent upon the death of Mrs. Shanti Devi in respect of said property post demise of Mrs. Shanti Devi who was the owner through Deed of Conveyance dated 10.12.1973 executed between M/s DLF United Ltd. vide Doc. No. 7152, Regd. on 14.12.1973 (SR New Delhi). That Original Will dated 06.10.1995 is lost and not traceable. Online F.I.R. has been lodged on dated 03.07.2026 by Mr. Subash Khurana vide L.R. No. 417140/2026, P.S. Greater Kailash N. Delhi. Any person who finds the Will dated 06.10.1995 is requested to return/submit to the above mentioned address. Misuse of the same shall be liable for action under relevant provisions of the law of the land. Any person(s), institution(s) having any claim and/or objection in respect of the said property shall communicate the same to the undersigned at our address within 07 days from the publication of this notice with documentary evidence in support thereof, failing which all the claim, of such person(s)/ institution(s) shall not be binding upon the said property or Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited.

Mohd K. Hussain (Advocate)
D-21, Basement, Block-D, Jangpura Extn. New Delhi-110014, 8810391672

COURT NOTICE

COURT NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF SH. YASHDEEP CHAHAL, LD. CIVIL JUDGE-02 SOUTH DELHI, SAKET COURTS, NEW DELHI (CS SCJ/244/2026)

Chander Sharma
Versus
Manjula Bhanot and Ors.

To

(1) Manjula Bhanot, W/o Sanjeev Bhanot (2) Umang Bhanot, S/o Sanjeev Bhanot (3) Uday Bhanot, S/o Sanjeev Bhanot, All At R/o 499/5, Readymade Galli, Mehrauli, Near Riwaz Sari, New Delhi - 110030

Whereas, you are intentionally evading the service of Summons, it is hereby notified that if you shall not defend the case on **18.07.2026**, the case will be heard and determined ex-parte.

Given under my hand and the seal of the Court this 12th day of June, 2026.

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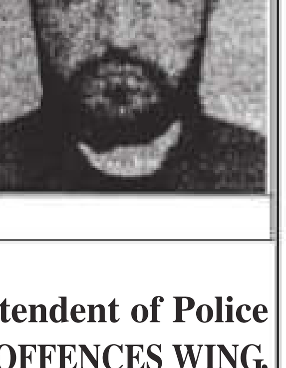
HUE & CRY NOTICE

Case FIR No. 34/2017 U/S 420, 467, 468, 471, 120-B, RPC is under investigation with Police Station Economic Offences Wing, Crime Branch Kashmir. The individual whose description/particulars are given below, is involved in the said case, is absconding and is evading his arrest to scuttle the due process of law.

Please have a sharp look out, if the accused persons is traced /found he be apprehended /detained and this agency be informed instantly on phone numbers 01942, 471836 /6005378850, for further appropriate action.

The description of the accused absconder is as under:

Particulars of the person.	**Ghulam Mohammad Sheikh S/o Abdul Ahad Sheikh R/o Sachin Banit Beerwah Budgam**
Aadhar No.	**4314-2992-1075**
Pan No.	**Nil**
D/L No.	**JK,0420150028579**
Date of Birth	**56 Years**
Height	**5:8"**
Hair	**Black**
Pin code No.	**193411**



Sr. Superintendent of Police
ECONOMIC OFFENCES WING, SRINAGAR

DIP/J-4943/26- DATE July/3/2026

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE BAWANI KHERA	COMPLETION AND UPGRADATION OF ATAL JI COMMUNITY CENTRE MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE, BAWANI KHERA + 4 WORKS	02.07.2026 15.07.2026	AS PER DNIT	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9802401200 mc.bawanikhera1@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 46817/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE ROHTAK CO OP MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED	2026_HBC_528918_1,2026_HBC_528924_1,2026_HBC_528929_1,2026_HBC_528869_1,2026_HBC_528906_1	DATE EXTENDED UPTO 06.07.2026 AT 16:00PM OPENING ON 07.07.2026 AT 11:30AM	vitaindia@gmail.com	9896401185 vitarohtak@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 46781/HRY

Government of Jammu & Kashmir
SKIMS MEDICAL COLLEGE-HOSPITAL

Bemina, Srinagar, J&K – 190017
Department of Materials Management
[Phone Number], email: mmo@skimsmc.edu.in

Sub:- Procurement of reagents and consumables for Electrolyte Analyzer on Proprietary Article basis – Notice for invitation of objections thereof.

SKIMS Medical College-Hospital, Bemina, Srinagar J&K, intends to procure reagents and consumables for Electrolyte Analyzer (Model EL 120) from OEM - AGD Biomedicals Pvt. Ltd through their authorized dealer M/s GC Biotech, Alipur, Delhi on PAC basis as per provisions of Rule 166 of GFR.

In this connection, objections (if any) from companies manufacturing/ marketing/developing such services capable of delivering the same result as intended from the above items, regarding the proprietary nature of the above services, should be communicated on the above-mentioned email id within a week's period i.e., by or before 09th of July, 2026 up to 04:30 PM.

After due date, it will be presumed that no manufacturer/ company has any objection/ comments to offer and the claim for the proprietorship of the item, shall be accepted.

Sd/-
Sr. Materials Management Officer
(SKIMS MCH Bemina)

DIPK-NB-937/26 – DATE 02 JULY 2026 **No: SKIMS/MCH/MMD, Dated: 02/07/2026**

FIRST LADY TEACHER MATA SAVITRI BAI PHOOLE
GOVERNMENT GIRLS COLLEGE, REWARI

Tender Notice for Hostel Mess for the Year 2026-27

Applications are invited under the sealed cover for the Hostel Mess contract for one year from 20th July 2026 to 19th July 2027. The relevant details related to Hostel Mess contract can be obtained from the college office during working days (10:00 AM to 4:00 PM). The important dates and information are detailed below.

Time Schedule of Bidding Process

Date of Publication of tender notification on official website	6th July, 2026
Last date for receipt of filled in tender document	14th July 2026 (upto 4:00 PM)
Date and time of opening of bid	16th July 2026 at 11:00 AM (Room No. 7)
Commencing date of the Tender	20th July 2026

Note:- This tender Document contains 12 pages and bidders are requested to sign on all the pages.

- Bidding document is free and can be downloaded from the college website or from the office of undersigned during office hours.
  College website Link: http://gcwrewari.ac.in/Download Forms
  (To download the form)

Sd/-
Principal
F.L.T. M. S. B. P.
Girls College Rewari

RO. No. 46823/HRY

CHHATRAPATI SAMBHAJINAGAR MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

PHONE NO: (0240)-2333536-40,2348001-05(PBX); FAX-(0240)-2331213
Website:-http://www.aurangabadmahapalika.org/

No./CSMC/2026/25 **Date: 29/6/2026**

TENDER NOTICE (Second Call)
E-Tender Notice No. 2026_AMCA_1283163_2

Development of Commercial Complex (Shops & Offices), Banquet/ Exhibition Hall on Build Operate and Transfer Basis situated at CTS No.3208, Nehru Bhavan, Buddilane, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar Municipal Corporation, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar.

Details Such as bid document last date of submission, date of Pre bid conference etc. will be available from 2/7/2026 from 17.00 hrs. On https://www.mahatenders.gov.in portal. All interested bidders may apply online through this portal.

Sr. No	Description	Details
1.	Name of Work	Development of Commercial Complex (Shops & Offices), Banquet Exhibition Hall on Build Operate and Transfer Basis for 30 years (extendable add on 30 years, total up to 60 years), situated at CTS No.3208, Nehru Bhavan, Buddilane, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar Municipal Corporation, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar.
2.	Department	Build Operate and Transfer (BOT)
3.	EMD (Online payment only)	Rs.40,00,000/- (Rupees Forty Lakhs only)
4.	Bid Validity	120 Days
5.	Form Fee (Online payment only)	Rs.11,800/- (Including GST)
6.	Time Limit of Work	12 Months
7.	Performance Bank Guarantee (For successful bidder only)	5% of Project cost in the form of Bank Guarantee of Nationalized bank
8.	Date & Time of Publishing/ Downloading of Tender	Dt.02/07/2026, Time17:00Hrs
9.	Date of pre-bid meeting	Dt.14/07/2026, Time 13:00Hrs
10.	Date & Time of Submitting the Tender	Dt.27/07/2026, Time17:30Hrs

Digitally signed by, Amol Jagannath Yedage
Commissioner, Municipal Corporation
Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar

RESULTS

ROUND OF 32

Spain 3-0 Austria
Los Angeles Stadium

Portugal 2-1 Croatia
Toronto Stadium

Switzerland 2-0 Algeria
Vancouver Stadium

MATCH SCHEDULE

ROUND OF 32

Colombia vs Ghana
Kansas City, **7.00 am** (Saturday)

ROUND OF 16

Canada vs Morocco
Houston, **10.30 pm** (Saturday)

Paraguay vs France
Philadelphia, **2.30 am** (Sunday)

ZEE5 OTT & UNITE8 CHANNELS

Julian Nagelsmann was the youngest manager in this edition at just 38 years old. AP

Germany coach Nagelsmann steps down

GERMANY COACH Julian Nagelsmann stepped down on Friday following the team's early World Cup exit, and the German Football Association said its board was in talks with Juergen Klopp to replace him. Germany's defeat to Paraguay on penalties marked a third consecutive disappointing World Cup campaign after first-round exits in 2018 and 2022. The four-time world champions last lifted the trophy in 2014. "My top priority has always been the team's success. After such a bitter disappointment, they deserve the chance for a fresh start," Nagelsmann said in a statement. REUTERS

Kane can be England all-time best: Carragher

HARRY KANE has been the highest scorer ever for England with 84 goals. However, he does not have the silverware in his cabinet, which would have complemented his individual brilliance. Former England defender Jamie Carragher opined that if Kane had better teammates, as Sir Bobby Charlton did, Kane would have eclipsed Charlton's greatness. "For us, Kane in 2026 is exactly what Charlton was to the country 60 years ago – the beacon of hope which made the supporters believe we can finally win a major tournament. Sadly, he does not have Bobby Moore, Gordon Banks or Alan Ball alongside him to make those dreams a reality," wrote Carragher in *The Telegraph*. ENS

CONTRASTING FORTUNES

Showdown of legends has one clear winner

EXPRESS AT WORLD CUP

While Modric exited the World Cup, Ronaldo advanced to the Round of 16 in a thriller of a match filled with emotion and drama

Sandip G
New York, July 3

IN HIS most euphoric moment, Cristiano Ronaldo did not forget his two old friends, Luka Modric and the late Diogo Jota. After the 20 minutes of a stoppage time, filled with drama, every possible shade of emotion exhausted, with Portugal beating Croatia 2-1 to enter the round of 16, Ronaldo wrapped Modric in a deep embrace. He whispered something in his ears, he held his face like a brother would and wiped a drop of tear off Modric.

In that poignant moment of brotherhood, the relevance of the result blurred.

Shortly, he went to the pitch-side dugout and changed to a jersey of Jota, the Portuguese forward who died tragically in a car crash last year, and winked at the skies, offering a silent prayer. It was perhaps the most emotional day in Ronaldo's career.

Had the whims of destiny differed, the scenes would have been different too. Ronaldo could have left the stage with his dream unfulfilled; it was the turn of his former Real Madrid companion to bow out. Modric would be remembered as one of the greatest and toughest that has played the game; yet his last game ended in a heartbreak in the most heartbreaking way.

VAR drama

In the 13th minute of an unusually long stoppage time, Modric thought his team had found the equaliser, that he would live a little longer in the tournament. Josko Gvardiol seemed to have directed the ball into the goal (or did the final touch come from Ruben Dias?) But in the build-up to the goal, Igor Matanovic, the VAR adjudged, had feathered the ball according to football's version of a snicko. At that precise moment, Mario Pasalic, whose miscued shot Gvardiol slid in, was off-side. Numerous replays were played, managers and support staff were pacing down the touchline; players and substitutes were predicting and debating the outcome. Escalating the suspense, the PA system in the stadium failed. The referee had to wait a few more minutes to announce the decision. And when it came, one side burst

The end of the game was always going to be cruel. For so long it seemed like the dream was over for Ronaldo. After a first half that buzzed with a scrappy energy, fast transitions, speedy counterattacks, manic defending and horrendous finishing, Ivan Persic, 37 years old and a Croatian legend himself, seized the lead for his side. Ronaldo wore the face of a man that knew there would be no tomorrow. For Portugal and Ronaldo, the recovery was not instant, even though they resisted a second goal.

Then in a split second of pure instinct and the shine that refuses to leave its master, Ronaldo warped time and travelled back a decade to score the equaliser. Or what it then seemed to be, before VAR intervened and spotted that Ronaldo was marginally off-side. The first touch with the outside of the ball to control the cross and the flick of the ankle to ferry the ball goalwards was peak Ronaldo-esque. He bounced to the touchline and struck a restrained version of SIU. But he turned around and saw no one. He gazed at the referee, and he knew his fate. It perhaps was not his day. Yet, it was. The clock struck 67 minutes and destiny smiled on him. Portugal were awarded a penalty. Ronaldo instinctively placed the ball on the spot. There was no question who would take it. What followed was heightened theatre.

The moment froze to the ball and the man. The man stood still, legs wide, eyes fixed on the ball's perimeter, the mind processing the ball's destination, and his own destiny. Beads of sweat trickled down his temple. He took a deep, long, breath. Again. Then again. Cristiano Ronaldo has taken 211 penalties; he has converted 178. Yet, he was nervous. But this one was different.

This one could be his last; his dream and nightmare, his obituary and rebirth. Everything unfolded in slow motion.

The whistle blew. Ronaldo took a stride, then paused. Then he coiled his body and swept the ball through the middle of the goal, the goalkeeper Dominik Livakovic flinging the wrong way. He screamed in joy, spun to the touchline, leapt as high as he could and unfurled the famous SIU.

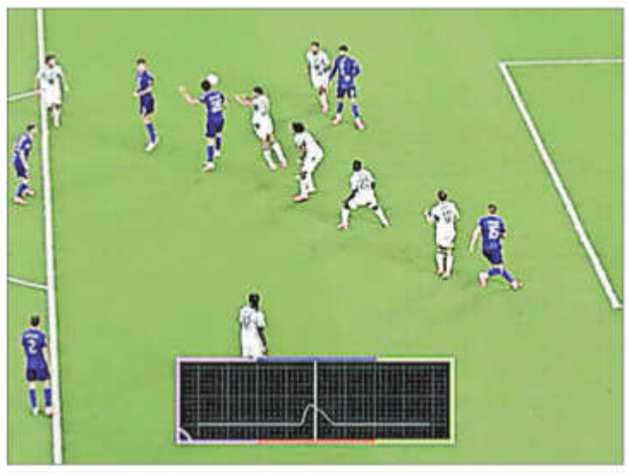
The final twist

Twelve minutes on, he was substituted. This could be his last bow, Ronaldo's final act of the World Cup. Seconds ticked by with the length of microseconds. The match seemed to drift into extra time, and then the twist arrived, for both Modric and Ronaldo. Goncalo Ramos sprung high, as high as Ronaldo would in his peak and spanked a header past the goalkeeper Livaković to secure Portugal's passage to the round of 16, and keep Ronaldo's dream flickering.

One of the greatest careers ended, and another found a rebirth.

Cristiano Ronaldo, 41, after converting a penalty against Croatia to level the score at 1-1. (R) The 2-1 loss to Portugal is likely to be 40-year-old Luka Modric's last World Cup appearance. AP

Chip in ball helps Portugal win by hair's breadth



The ball touching Igor Matanovic's hair was proved conclusively by VAR's 'Connected Ball' technology. FIFA MEDIA/X

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, July 3

BESIDES GONCALO Ramos' late header, Portugal had a technology akin to cricket's 'Snickometer' to thank for their Round-of-32 victory over Croatia. A hair's breadth was literally all it took.

What happened

Trailing 1-2 with the final whistle imminent, Croats attacked the rival box via Ivan Perisic's probing ball. Renato Veiga tried to nod it away, only managing to flick it Mario Pasalic's way. The latter brought it down clumsily, but Josko Gvardiol rushed in to fire it home.

Pasalic was deemed onside, the goal stood on field and would have remained so post the video assistant referee (VAR) check, if not for a microchip installed in the Trionda. The 2026 World Cup match ball detected a miniscule touch by Igor Matanovic, which made Pasalic offside before his assist, and the equaliser was snatched away from Gvardiol and Croatia. Amid the despair, Matanovic later admitted to feeling "a slight contact" with his hair, as quoted by Portuguese daily *A Bola*.

The tech

The aforementioned microchip houses an inertial measurement unit sensor that captures motion data a whopping 500 times per second. This 'connected ball technology', launched by FIFA and makers Adidas, employs waveform tech to track the ball's real-time acceleration and granular movement in three dimensions.

It is meant to speed up the VAR decision-making process, which otherwise relies on videos available at around 50 frames per second. By measuring the precise moment when a player makes contact with the ball, referees can ascertain the decisive pass in a potential offside scenario. On Friday, it was broadcast as a 'heartbeat graphic', and Norwegian referee Espen Eskas could thus rule that Matanovic's deflection rendered Pasalic offside.

The technology is similar to cricket's Snicko, in the sense that both display spikes upon finding the faintest of touches — be it player on ball in football or bat on ball in cricket. While Snicko detects sound, the connected ball tech checks for a physical touch.

> **"VAR kills emotions. We have gone too far with VAR. You were able to see to what extent emotions had been killed and altogether, all these decisions take you back and actually take the joy out of football"**
>
> **CROATIA MANAGER ZLATKO DALIC,** AFTER HIS SIDE'S LAST-MINUTE GOAL WAS RULED OUT.

Previous interventions

Sweden's fourth goal against Tunisia in their Group F clash at Guadalupe was awarded with the help of this waveform technology. Mattias Svanberg was adjudged to be offside on the pitch, but subsequent VAR review showed that Alexander Isak got a tiny touch which pegged Svanberg onside, and the goal was given.

The technology was employed at the 2022 World Cup and 2024 European Championships as well.

In Qatar, it proved that Bruno Fernandes, and not Cristiano Ronaldo, scored Portugal's first goal in a 2-0 win over Uruguay. At the Euros, Romelu Lukaku netted for Belgium versus Slovakia, but the goal was disallowed after a review showed Lois Openda handling the ball.

The reactions

Croatia manager Zlatko Dalic said "VAR kills emotions" after his side was knocked out of the tournament. "It kills everything within you. We have gone too far with VAR," he added. "You were able to see to what extent emotions had been killed and altogether, all these decisions take you back and actually take the joy out of football."

Portugal coach Roberto Martinez, understandably, differed. "There's no bad decision or lucky decision. It was a clear moment. The balls now have a chip and the sensor shows the ball was touched."

Ronaldo in tears after tribute to departed Jota

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 3

AFTER LEADING Portugal to the Round of 16 with a thrilling 2-1 victory over Croatia in a gripping encounter, an emotional Cristiano Ronaldo was seen in tears, wearing Diogo Jota's No. 21 jersey as a tribute to his former teammate.

Jota lost his life in a road accident in Spain last year at the age of 28, shortly after playing a key role in Portugal's second Nations League triumph.

Ronaldo pointed to the sky while wearing Jota's jersey after the final whistle, as emotions ran high. "We knew it before the game, it was a so special moment. We speak today, our group, about the coincidence of life, it's unbelievable. I was amazed because the situation of today it means a lot to us, not only because we won the game but also the way," Ronaldo told Fox.

July 4, 2026, will mark exactly one year since Jota and his brother André Silva died in a car accident in western Spain.

Jota and his brother Silva, who played for Penafiel in the Portuguese second division, were believed to have been driving to a ferry in Spain to travel to Britain when their Lamborghini veered off the road and burst into flames after midnight.

They were buried in their hometown of Gondomar in northern Portugal.

"We know he is present with us and it only made sense to win today to honor him in the best way," added Ronaldo to Portugal's *Sport TV*.

Keeping the suspense

Ronaldo has dismissed his sister Katia Aveiro's claims that he might retire from international football after the World Cup, stating he won't decide until Portugal's tournament is over. Katia appeared on Portuguese media outlet *Sport TV* and said: "Enjoy it while it lasts. It's ending soon."

"It is not important now," Ronaldo told reporters. "I will have time to talk about that after winning or losing the tournament; I will talk to my family, and then I will make the most appropriate decision."

Ronaldo with the Portuguese team, holding Diogo Jota's jersey. AP

TIMED TO PERFECTION

How CR7's missed header and Ramos' winner vindicated Martinez's subs

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, July 3

FOR DIOGO Jota, he became the face of Portugal's grief. For Luka Modric, the consoler. For broadcasters, the only agenda. For his nation, a hero they were starting to fall out of love with. At full-time in Toronto, Cristiano Ronaldo wore multiple hats. He was Portugal's saviour.

A narrative-defier. A record-breaker. His penalty resuscitated Portugal, and his performance earned yet another age-defying milestone. Oldest ever to score at a World Cup knockout, and to win a player of the match award. The one thing he no longer looked like was the Ronaldo football once knew.

He could have been. In the ninth minute, Pedro Neto whipped in an inswinging cross so inviting that it seemed designed exclusively for one man. Leaping for it was the master of leaps. Ronaldo. For well over a decade, the outcome was an inevitability. Here, though, he missed – the ball, the flight of it, the timing of the jump. For several seconds, Neto simply stood still, both hands planted on his head, struggling to comprehend what he had witnessed.

An hour and three-quarters later, another cross was flung in. On this occasion, a floaty instepper from the right, by Rafael Leao. Goncalo Ramos drifted between Josko Gvardiol and Marin Pongracic, timed his leap perfectly and powered a header into the corner. 2-1. The knockout specialists were dealt a knockout punch. Between Ronaldo's missed header and Ramos' decisive one lies the story of Portugal's night — the one that you might have missed.

Coming into this fixture, Ronaldo featured in every minute of every game. Neither was he prolific, nor was Portugal indomitable. DR Congo and Colombia held them to stalemates. Yet, Martinez has consistently defended his decision not to substitute his captain. In-substitute-able. Until the 81st minute in Toronto.

Tactical shift

Ruben Neves replaced Ronaldo, and it sparked a domino.

Nineteen minutes earlier, Martinez's quadruple substitution had left Portugal with only one holding midfielder. Croatia expectedly seized control of the midfield, registering four attempts in that period, while Portugal managed none save from Ronaldo's penalty. Neves restored numerical balance in midfield. More importantly, it allowed Ramos to occupy a position unavailable with Ronaldo.

Of Ramos' 1,026 minutes for Portugal before facing Croatia, 200 had come alongside Ronaldo. During those minutes, he scored just once. Without Ronaldo, however, he had scored ten goals in 826 minutes. His goals-per-minute rate improves from one every 200 minutes to one every 82. The numbers suggest Martinez's two-striker approach may be counterproductive. If not for the change, Ramos might not have been the farthest figure forward. Getting there was only a part of the equation. The more telling detail, though, lies in the heading numbers.

Goncalo Ramos came on for João Cancelo in the 63rd minute and scored the winner in the sixth minute of stoppage time. AP

Fading edge

Here, we recall Sampdoria 2019. Playing for Juventus, Ronaldo launched himself to meet a cross with a leap that has since entered football folklore. His jump: 71 centimetres. Total elevation: 2.56 metres. End product: An exemplary headed goal. Claudio Ranieri, the opposition manager, had seen almost everything in football, but not something like that. "Ronaldo did something that you see in the NBA. He was up in the air for an hour and a half," he would say. Sampdoria's erstwhile president, Massimo Ferrero, argued: "Ronaldo had to be booked for that leap. It was as if he was taking off like an aeroplane."

Heading has always been one of Ronaldo's greatest gifts. He caresses air with a craftsman's finesse. Or at least, he used to. Till 2019, 102 of his 607 club goals (16.7%) and 24 of his 99 international goals (24.2%) came from headers.

> ***For the first time in this competition, Roberto Martinez did Cristiano Ronaldo a favour by not favouring him.***

Jose Fonte, who shared dressing rooms with Ronaldo from their youth days, has revealed that heading was once one of his weakest attributes. What was not, however, was commitment. He did what only a few could dream of — working hard enough to turn a frailty into a forte. Except acquired talents, unlike innate ones, come with an expiration date.

From 2020, Ronaldo's physical powers started to decline. Its first casualty was his aerial supremacy. The headed goals statistics in the last six years read: 23 of 223 in club football (10.3%), four out of 47 in internationals (8.6%). A significant dip on both levels. The numbers reveal what the eye increasingly suspects. The most feared aerial footballer of his generation rarely rules the skies anymore. That Neto's cross did not meet a head, or Leao had to wait till his fourth cross to find one, was not an aberration.

Ronaldo still produced plenty against Croatia. His penalty was immaculate. His ruled-out receive-and-finish was pristine. Yet he might not have extended his stay in America if not for the substitution. For the first time in this competition, Roberto Martinez did Cristiano Ronaldo a favour by not favouring him.

The streets behind France's swagger

How the cages of Paris' *banlieues* created the fearless footballers powering *Les Bleus*

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, July 3

THREE SWEDISH defenders stood almost shoulder to shoulder, forming a yellow wall between Kylian Mbappe and the goal. There was nowhere obvious to go. So, instead of forcing the issue, Mbappe simply stopped. He rolled the ball backwards, inviting the nearest defender to take a step forward. That was the cue he had been waiting for.

In an instant, he was moving again. His hips swayed one way, the ball darted another, and a crowded penalty area suddenly opened up. By the time the other Swedish defender realised what had happened, Mbappe was already wheeling away in celebration.

The goal was a result of breathtaking speed, but even more breathtaking audacity. Most footballers, confronted by three defenders, search for the safer pass. Mbappe saw them as an audience – and put on a show. Watching France at this World Cup, that feeling keeps returning. Didier Deschamps' side does not resemble a meticulously-drilled international team so much as a bunch of street footballers who happen to be wearing blue shirts. Every attack carries an extra feint, an unexpected flick or an invitation to a one-on-one duel.

That is no accident.

The footballing soul of this French team lies beyond the cafes and boulevards of central Paris. It lives in the *banlieues* – the working-class suburbs that ring the capital – where generations of children have learnt the game inside fenced cages, on concrete courts and tiny artificial pitches squeezed between apartment blocks. There, football is stripped to its essentials. Space is scarce, time even scarcer, and mistakes are punished instantly. If you cannot beat your opponent 1v1, you simply do not keep the ball.

France talisman Kylian Mbappe (No. 10) grew up playing on the streets of Bondy, a Parisien suburb, where every child learns to receive under pressure, protect the ball and glide through crowds. AP

• Number Plate

53

• Number of players in the World Cup who are born in Paris' suburbs. They are representing more than a dozen nations. In the French team, 12 players are from the Ile de France region.

> **"Before being professional, we used to play in the streets. That's where we learnt (skills)."**
> ZAIRE EMERY, FRENCH MIDFIELDER, WHO HAILS FROM PARISIEN SUBURBS

Neighbourhood skills

Those cages have quietly become the world's greatest football academy. Midfielder Zaire Emery told *FIFA* before the World Cup: "Before being professional, we used to play in the streets. That's where we learnt." Manu Kone, who plays as a double pivot, added: "You play with the skills you learned in the neighbourhood."

No metropolitan region produces elite footballers on the scale of Greater Paris. Analyses of the squads at this World Cup show that 53 players were born in the Île-de-France region, representing more than a dozen countries, while 99 France-born footballers are featuring across the tournament. Only 23 of them play for France. The rest wear the colours of Algeria, Morocco, Democratic Republic of Congo, Senegal, Tunisia, Ivory Coast, Haiti and several other nations. The suburbs of Paris have become football's most remarkable export source, supplying talent to much of the world. It is remarkable that so many of those players, regardless of the badge on their chest, seem to share the same footballing language.

In the cages of Bondy, Sevran, Sarcelles, Clichy-sous-Bois, Montreuil and Aulnay-sous-Bois, tricks are not performed for applause. They are practical solutions. A body feint buys half a yard of space. A roulette escapes a tackle. A nutmeg keeps possession alive. Lose the ball, and you might spend the next five minutes watching from the sidelines while others play. Every child quickly learns to receive under pressure, protect the ball and glide through crowds.

Distinct identity

That education never leaves them. It explains why French football has developed an identity unlike any other major nation. If Spain – another major contender – is built on geometry and collective possession, France is the home of the individual duel. Its best players seem to view defenders not as obstacles to avoid but as puzzles waiting to be solved.

Mbappe is the finest expression of that culture. And he is hardly alone – 11 others in this French team – have benefited from the system. By the time many of these youngsters arrive at Clairefontaine, France's celebrated national academy, the essential qualities have already been formed. The academy teaches structure, positioning and decision-making. The cages have already taught them courage, balance, deception and instinct. That is why this French side often feels different from every other heavyweight at the tournament. Their football possesses a swagger. For opponents, it is maddening. For spectators, irresistible.

There is, of course, far more to France's success than street football. Deschamps has built a tactically disciplined side, physically imposing and defensively resilient. Yet, what elevates this team beyond being merely efficient is the freedom its players bring from the places where they first fell in love with the game.

Which is why Mbappe's goal against Sweden was the latest reminder that somewhere beneath the choreography of elite football still lives a child from the cages of Bondy. With three defenders in his way, he stops and waits. Then, with a feint, a burst and a flash of imagination, he turns a World Cup knockout match into a street game once again.

Jesse Marsch's Canada will hope to record an upset vs Morocco. AP

Canada have a 'free hit' against Morocco

Sandip G
New York, July 3

THE DAY after beating South Africa in the Round of 32, Canada manager Jesse Marsch made a quick change of plan and travelled to Monterrey while his players boarded the flight to Houston for the game against Morocco.

Marsch wanted to watch the match between his team's potential Round-of-16 opponents, the Netherlands and Morocco. He returned to the hotel terrified: "Preparing for Morocco is like a gory, horrible nightmare," he later told the media. "It's like, I don't want to watch them play. They're too good."

Not that Morocco have scaled the dizzying heights of the Qatar World Cup yet. They have been disjointed at times and dug deep to accrue points, but they begin as outright favourites to flush the co-hosts out of the tournament.

The expectations are so meagre that Marsch calls the game a "free hit", where his team would play sans the burden of expectations, or the pressure of playing in front of the home crowd, as was evidenced in their nervous last group game against Switzerland. Whether Marsch, a grisly midfielder in his day, was playing the underdog card is uncertain, but Canada's ouster wouldn't shock the world. Already, this is the deepest they have ever progressed in a World Cup. The country would not wallow in mourning. "Let's go for it like we have nothing to lose. Everyone's gonna expect us to lose anyway, so let's really go for it," he said.

But they could drink from the oasis of hope. The tournament has been a hymn to the underdog spirit. And Canada, theoretically, has a stronger, systematic group of individuals than the aforementioned sides.

They have deeper gears than teams think they have. The team's identity was a high-energy, emotion-fuelled game underpinned by shapeshifting structures. There was an element of chaos, like Marsch's Leeds days under Marcelo Bielsa. But against South Africa, and a pre-World Cup friendly against Colombia, they showed they could be a better organised group when they defend in a compact mid-block, press aggressively and stifle adversaries.

Against South Africa, they were happy without possession, and ventured onto the front foot only when the opportunity was too welcoming. Morocco are not the happiest when tasked with breaching well-knit defensive blocks.

The Canadians could switch seamlessly through the gears, their transitions are fast, and unlike most other teams they have encountered thus far, Morocco's wont is to attack, not sequester into low blocks.

> **"Preparing for Morocco is like a gory, horrible nightmare. It's like, I don't want to watch them play. They're too good."**
> JESSE MARSCH, CANADA COACH

Living on hope

They have pace on the flanks and would look to exploit left-back Noussair Mazraoui immobility, even though defensively he has been excellent, compared to right-back Achraf Hakimi's blinding pace.

The Dutch frustrated them with five men at the back, suffocating the channels and dishevelling their fluidity. Morocco's defence is a stop-gap one with injuries to the first-choice centre-back pairing of Ez Abde and Nayef Aguerd.

Almost all their build-ups are through the right side as well. Restricting Hakimi's clout would be central to stopping them. If Alphonso Davies were optimally fit, it could have been the headline match-up.

But with the imaginative Ismael Kone out of the World Cup with a broken leg, Davies could potentially start. For a more compact midfield, Marsch could employ Mathieu Choinière to break down Morocco's midfield.

But Morocco, most of them bred in robust European football academies, are not only an incredibly technical side but also an intensely physical one. Marsch's men have to match them physically. A fleeting relief is that Morocco have been aimless with their finishing, except when they pumped four goals against Haiti. In all other games, they nicked just a goal, that sufficed for a victory or draw. The defence is not entirely fool-proof, as Haiti showed, pumping two goals.

Morocco manager Mohamed Ouahbi has not been in a buoyant mood himself. "If we get things wrong, we'll go home," he warned.

Among bookmakers, Morocco are the odds-on favourites to clinch the game, and Canada could be the first co-hosts to crash out of the tournament. But upsets have flavoured this World Cup and Canada could add the seasoning. It could be a nightmare as Marsch commented, but for Canada's dream to carry on, they need to live through it.

Cucurella, with old-school virtues, is vital in Spain's engine room

Sandip G
New York, July 3

THE HAIR, Marc Cucurella says, is sacred. But he promises he will go bald if Spain lifts the World Cup. But when the moment arrives, the larrikin in him could deny, "Did I say that really?" He had made the promise before. A Barcelona product, as recently as April, he claimed he would rather chop the locks he had been nourishing for over a decade than join Real Madrid.

Come May, he signed a 60-million pound contract to join the Spanish powerhouse. "Hair is not essential to my personality, it is my personality," he told Spanish outlet Marca.

The springy curls, girdled by a hairband that is about to burst, is part of what has made him a cult figure in Spain and England, where he played for five years. The full-back, who assisted two goals and saw a goal he scored chalked off in Spain's dismembering of Austria, is the European champions' wind-up merchant. The provocateur, his friends call him. When his goal was ruled out, he rushed to the referee, and commanded rather than implored him to check the VAR. Replays only justified the referee's verdict, even though Pau Cubarsi infringement on Austria's goalkeeper Xaver Schlager was soft. But he sought a detailed explanation from the referee, voiced his displeasure, and walked away shaking his head.

Six minutes later, after Mikel Oyarzabal scored from Cucurella's low cross and put Spain in front, he pounced in front of the referee and asked him, sarcastically, if the goal stood. The referee pointed to his pocket, suggesting he would flash a yellow card. Cucurella turned away and joined his teammates in celebration. He is an antithesis to the modern La Masia-raised footballer, the elegant, soft-spoken stylist, economical with his words and moves. He is the old-school hard tackling rogue. His manager at Eibar once summed him up precisely. "He's not quick, he's not strong. All those things we measure with all those machines we have, he doesn't register on any of them; you would never sign him," he said. "But he's a footballer."

Integral part

But he has become an integral part of Luis de la Fuente's mould-breaking side. Since the tiki taka era, the stereotype of La Rojas as a tessellation of fine-tuned technicians have clung on, as a burden first and as a convenient shield later. His orchestra is not a harmony of similar notes, but a medley of diverse tunes, but each combining perfectly to produce tuneful music.

Marc Cucurella (C) recorded two assists against Austria. AP

Take for instance the brace-scorer Oyarzabal. He is not a classical nine, or a neo-classical false nine. He is not a centre forward, or a playmaker. But he does some of all their functions. He scores like a No.9; both his strikes were ripped off the classical manual. He drops back like a false nine; he wears the playmaking duties when Dani Olmo or Pedri is engaged somewhere else. He is the antithesis of Cucurella, who provided both his assists, and found time to complete his masters in business management.

Lamine Yamal and Alex Baena flank him. Yamal ghosts through defences. He didn't score against Austria, but he lingered like a throbbing headache for the defenders. Baena, nurtured in Atletico Madrid, is a muscular, rumbustious winger, who employs the strength of his body as much as the gift of technique.

Behind them is Dani Olmo, the invisible creator. Like Cucurella, he left Barcelona at 16, and rejoined them 16 years later. Some of the La Masia virtues remain, like the preternatural spatial awareness and passing range, but in Germany and Croatia, he learned to adjust to a more direct and vertical style.

Pedri is perhaps the lone classic chip off the Barcelona old-school, a figure of supreme grace. To Xavi, reminded him of Andrés Iniesta – "the greatest talent I've ever seen". He is quick, without looking hurried; he only touches the ball, finds space without ever looking strained, never loses the ball or is ever out of position. "He dominates space and time perfectly: he's a superlative player," Xavi waxed eloquently.

Pedri was omnipresent. The first goal originated from his sublime pass to Cucurella. Spain kept the ball so well, because Pedri kept the ball so well. When Spain's attacking midfield triangle function, their defence becomes impenetrable and empowers the full-backs with the liberty to blitz upfield. Right back Pedro Porro's headed goal was a classic example of how control in midfield could liberate the defence.

Until the Austria game, Spain had looked blunt, even blasé. But against Austria they half resembled the unstoppable force they were in the European Championship. And they have uncanny, quirky protagonists, when the lead acts like Yamal doesn't turn up. Like Cucurella, the man who takes u-turns on promises attached to his curly halo.

Djokovic matches Federer with 105th Wimbledon win

Reuters
London, July 3

NOVAK DJOKOVIC has spent the latter half of his glittering career equalling records set by former rival Roger Federer and the Serb was at it again as he notched up win number 105 at Wimbledon to reach the fourth round on Friday.

The 39-year-old, eyeing Federer's men's record eight Wimbledon singles crowns, suffered a third-set wobble against Frenchman Arthur Rinderknech and was pushed hard before closing out a 7-5, 6-4, 1-6, 7-6(4) victory. Another one against Russian qualifier Roman Safiullin will take him to second alone on the all-time Wimbledon match win list behind only Martina Navratilova's 120.

The way Djokovic dispatched Stefanos Tsitsipas in a round-two masterclass proved that very few players can touch him on grass and it was a similar story against 30-year-old Rinderknech for the opening two sets on a sun-bathed Centre Court.

Trademark elasticity

His precision shot-making and trademark elasticity had the crowd roaring their approval and Djokovic lapped it up.

Rinderknech was great value though, playing his full part in an absorbing duel littered with stunning rallies that sometimes had both players diving around the turf. The 25th seed romped away with the third and came close to handing Djokovic his first 6-0 bagel set at Wimbledon. Dialling up the power and accuracy of his serve, Rinderknech suddenly became a real threat but Djokovic steadied the ship and played a flawless fourth-set tiebreak.

• ENGLAND VS INDIA, 2nd T20I

Tilak's deficiencies against spin make him a misfit at No. 5

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, July 3

IN THE first T20I against England at Chester-le-Street, when Tilak Varma walked in, India were 88/3 in 8.2 overs with the run-rate hovering over 10.73 runs per over. By the time he headed back in the 14th over after making 13 off 13, it had reduced to 9.25 and until Shivam Dube managed to inject the impetus in the end, India had let England back in the game.

It would be too harsh to put the blame on Tilak, who is playing a similar role that KL Rahul has been pushed into in ODIs. So far in his 52 T20Is, Tilak has played at No 3, 4, 5, 6, 7 and has become the fix wherever there is a hole. A career strike-rate of 142.7 and an average of 43.44 are numbers that suggest there isn't anything alarming. Yet, Tilak finds himself in positions where he hasn't been able to increase the tempo.

It invariably boils down to his game against spinners. Even in the IPL, whenever Tilak walked in, oppositions preferred to bring in spinners as he is known to be a slow starter against them. At Chester-le-Street, Harry Brook did the same, turning to Adil Rashid, Liam Dawson and Will Jacks. And Tilak pressed on the breaks. Before this tour, Tilak has been striking at 100 in 8 innings against spinners. Compared to his overall strike-rate of 142.7, it comes down to 126.2 against tweakers.

Given this, that India have slotted him at No 5 is slightly surprising as they happen to be a team that is calculative in terms of the match-ups. And among all the positions that Tilak has batted, it is at No 5 where he has gone slow at 136.6.

Even in the IPL, when Tilak Varma walked in, oppositions brought on spinners as he is known to be a slow starter against them. ANI

At No 3 and 4, he has been able to play the role of the enforcer and when pushed down to No 6 or 7, he has struck over 200.

Among all his peers in the Indian team, Tilak is probably cut from a different cloth. As he admitted a couple of years back, the real struggle for him is to adjust his game to white-ball cricket. "Actually, since childhood I'm used to playing a lot of red-ball cricket. Because of IPL, many people know me as a white-ball player, but I know I'm a red-ball player, who is used to playing 500 deliveries. It is not new to me. For me, the pace of cricket is what I learned from IPL. Red ball cricket is my first priority. But I've to adapt to T20 cricket with practice and improving my mindset," he told the *BCCI.tv*.

Two years on, he still remains a work in progress. At the T20 World Cup, India's plan was to slot him at No 3, one who would glue an attacking batting line-up. But with a tempting top three at hand, India moved Tilak down the order in place of Rinku Singh, who is more comfortable in the role of a finisher. Yet, the left-hander played vital knocks against the West Indies as well as against England.

In the first of those games, India's plan to hold back Shivam Dube worked as Brook still ended up exposing two of his spinners to the left-hander, who didn't need any second invitation to feast on. Given Dube's failure as a finisher for CSK in the IPL and Tilak's shortcomings against spinners, swapping their positions going forward is what India perhaps need when there is no Rinku.

For a series where Hardik Pandya and Nitish Kumar Reddy weren't available, the omission of Rinku itself raised eyebrows as it is a specialist role that no other batsman has managed to embrace successfully. Only Tilak managed to do it, and there was a reason too. With a strong game off the square and his ability to use the depth of the crease means, he was able to covert the lengths to his advantage. That sort of creativity has lacked in Tilak when it comes to batting in the middle-overs when the spinners operate with tight leg-side fields denying him the length to slog-sweep. For a batsman of his calibre, Tilak has left it too long without addressing it, but the time to level up, may have finally come now.

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MOVE IS AIMED AT IMPROVING DISCLOSURE STANDARDS AND CURBING RAMPANT MISSELLING

Insurance regulator likely to tighten commission norms

IRDAI is working on a draft proposal to limit commission payouts by insurers to distributors

George Mathew
Mumbai, July 3

THE COUNTRY'S insurance regulator, Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI), has proposed tighter transparency norms for insurance intermediaries, asking them to disclose commission earnings to the public and the regulator.

It is also considering a cap on commissions and bringing some order to the industry, according to insurance sources.

The move is aimed at improving disclosure standards and curbing rampant mis-selling while giving regulators, policyholders and other stakeholders a clearer picture of how intermediaries make their earnings in a segment where commission-driven competition is intense.

Insurance intermediaries include agents, brokers, corporate agents, banks, web aggregators and third-party administrators. In the life insurance segment, high commission adds to the cost of policies.

In the non-life segment, for an airline with a fleet worth $20 billion and annual premium of $30 million, insurance commission to brokers can range from 2.5-10%, according to sources. According to the IRDAI consultation paper issued two weeks ago, insurance intermediaries whose commission income exceeds a prescribed threshold will be required to make detailed annual disclosures to the regulator. These disclosures would include commission earnings, related-party transactions, profits generated from operations, and any dividend repatriation to promoters or parent entities.

The regulator believes that enhanced reporting will help monitor business practices and ensure that intermediary compensation structures remain transparent and aligned with policyholder interests.

The proposed framework also seeks to strengthen public accountability by mandating that such information be published on the websites of the intermediaries.

The latest proposal comes at a time when the regulator is planning to put a cap on commission earnings, a move that could disrupt the segment.

The total commission shelled out by 26 life and 28 non-life insurers crossed the Rs one lakh crore mark in FY25. The gross commission expenses of public sector general insurers, private general insurers, standalone health insurers and specialised insurers stood at Rs 9,335 crore, Rs 30,498 crore, Rs 7,365 crore and Rs 67 crore respectively for 2024-25, thus cumulatively amounting to a total gross commission expense of Rs 47,266 crore for the entire non-life insurance industry, according to the IRDAI Annual Report.

During 2024-25, life insurers paid a total amount of Rs 60,800 crore as commission.

The commission expenses ratio (commission expenses expressed as a percentage of premium) slightly increased to 6.86% in 2024-25 from 6.21% in 2023-24. While the IRDAI has not yet formally proposed a cap on commissions, it is reportedly working on a draft proposal to limit commission payouts by insurers to distributors, a move enabled by the January 2026 amendment to the Insurance Act that empowered the regulator to prescribe commission ceilings.

Cut-throat competition

Insurance distribution is widely regarded as one of the most fiercely competitive segments of the financial services industry. Commission earnings in the insurance sector — particularly among intermediaries such as agents, brokers, web aggregators, corporate agents and insurance marketing firms — have long been a subject of intense competition, especially in high-growth segments such as health, motor, corporate and retail insurance.

With many insurers offering products that are broadly similar in terms of coverage and pricing, intermediaries often place significant emphasis on commission structures, incentive payouts and other commercial arrangements when deciding which products to distribute. "As a result, insurers compete aggressively to secure access to distribution channels, frequently offering higher commissions, performance-linked incentives and other benefits to attract and retain intermediaries," said an official.

Intense race for customers

Intermediaries generally favour products that generate recurring renewal commissions, prompting strong competition to acquire new policyholders and policy contracts from big corporate clients. There is also considerable mis-selling and under-cutting by insurers to get business. The emergence of digital platforms, web aggregators and insurtech companies has further heightened competition by lowering customer acquisition costs, expanding market reach and increasing price transparency.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• COMMISSION SURGE

Gross commission expenses for 2024-25
- Public sector general insurers - **Rs 9,335 cr**
- Private general insurers: **Rs 30,498 cr**
- Standalone health insurers: **Rs 7,365 cr**
- Specialised insurers **Rs 67 cr**

- Total commission paid by 26 life and 28 non-life insurers crossed the **Rs 1 lakh crore** mark in FY25.
- During 2024-25, life insurers paid a total amount of **Rs 60,800 crore** as commission.

Free Whatsapp Channel https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

FM SPOKE AT A PANEL TALK AT AIX-MARSEILLE UNIVERSITY, FRANCE

FM: Middle class consumption powering India's eco growth

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, July 3

FINANCE MINISTER Nirmala Sitharaman on Friday said India's expanding middle class has emerged as the country's engine of growth, with consumption-led demand helping the economy remain the world's fastest-growing major economy after the Covid-19 pandemic.

The middle class is no longer merely a beneficiary of economic growth but the principal driver of it, Sitharaman said speaking on the theme 'How to Promote the Rise of a New Middle Class?' at the Rencontres Économiques d'Aix-en-Provence, a major economic forum, at Aix-Marseille University, France. "In India, the middle class is the engine of growth. After Covid, India remained the fastest-growing large economy primarily because of the consumption which is triggered from the middle class and turns around into a virtuous cycle generating economic activity," she said.

The minister said India's middle class has expanded at an average annual rate of 6.3% since 1995, following the country's economic liberalisation. Citing OECD projections, she said India is expected to surpass China in the absolute size of its middle-class population between 2030 and 2035.

She also referred to World Economic Forum estimates showing a fundamental shift in India's consumption patterns, with nearly 500 cities emerging as new centres of economic activity. "By 2036, 93% of all spending in India will be because of the middle class or the slightly affluent consumers," she said. Emphasising that India's growth is geographically broad-based, Sitharaman said the middle class is increasingly concentrated in tier-II and tier-III cities rather than only in metropolitan centres, leading to a wider distribution of wealth.

Listing the government's initiatives to expand the middle class, the minister highlighted financial inclusion through Jan Dhan accounts, saying 248 million people have moved out of multidimensional poverty, citing World Bank and IMF estimates. She said the government-backed credit guarantee programme has enabled first-time entrepreneurs to access concessional loans without collateral, while widespread digital connectivity and digital payments have improved the creditworthiness of small businesses. Sitharaman also pointed to lower GST rates, investments in girls' hostels, skill development in animation, visual effects, gaming and digital media, and university townships focused on training. **FE**

By 2036, 93% of all spending in India will be because of middle class or slightly affluent consumers, Sitharaman said. PHOTO: @NSITHARAMAN

India and France to deepen cooperation in critical minerals

Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

New Delhi: India and France on Friday agreed to deepen cooperation in critical minerals, economic security, investment, financial services and high-speed rail as Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and French Economy Minister Roland Lescure co-chaired the India-France Economic and Financial Dialogue (EFD) in Aix-en-Provence.

The meeting, held under the broader India-France strategic partnership, reviewed the global economic outlook and explored ways to strengthen bilateral economic engagement. The dialogue follows the commitment made by Emmanuel Macron and Narendra Modi during the French President's visit to India earlier this year to convene the EFD in 2026.

According to a finance ministry statement, the two sides discussed "the roll-out of the India-France cooperation on critical minerals" as part of a broader conversation on "policies towards economic sovereignty and security." **FE**

HCLTech bags $1.14bn AI deal from EU firm

The company did not disclose the client, but industry sources identified it as Mercedes-Benz. REUTERS

Poulomi Chatterjee
Bengaluru, July 3

HCLTech on Friday said that it has won a strategic contract valued at $1.14 billion deal from a Europe-headquartered Fortune Global 50 company to transform and manage its digital workplace and enterprise networks.

While the company did not disclose the client, industry sources identified it as Mercedes-Benz.

The development marks one of the largest AI-led deals secured by an Indian IT services company in recent years and offering a rare bright spot for the sector amid weak discretionary technology spending.

The agreement, running from July 2026 to December 2031 with an option to extend it by another five years, will see HCLTech establish an AI-driven operating model to transform and manage the client's global digital workplace and enterprise networks.

The deal is entirely net new business and is estimated to contribute about $228 million in annual revenue during the initial five-year term.

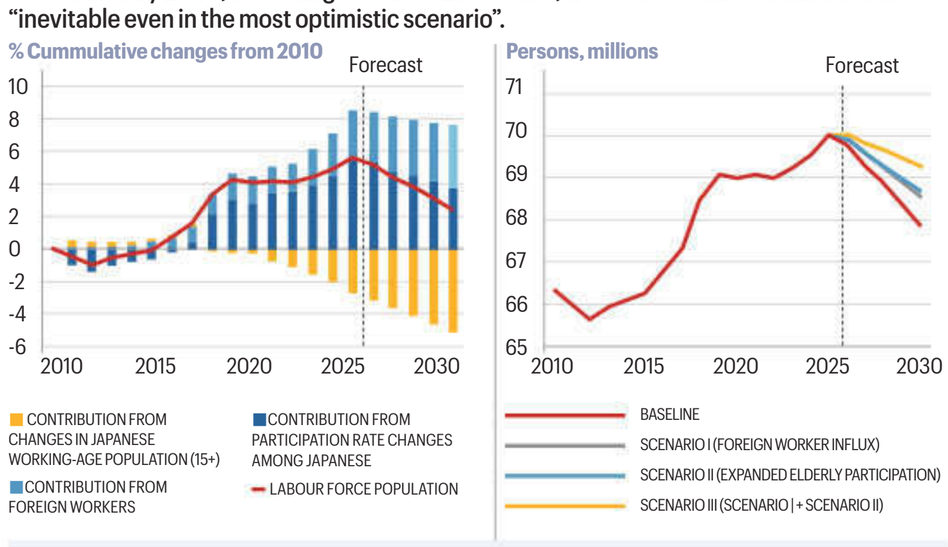
The timing is significant. Indian IT companies are preparing to report June-quarter earnings against the backdrop of slowing discretionary spending, delayed conversion of large deals into revenue and increasing pressure on pricing as AI improves delivery efficiency.

The scale of the latest contract reinforces a broader theme that has increasingly been articulated by industry leaders over the past year: enterprises are beginning to commit to AI-led transformation programmes rather than isolated pilot projects.

Infosys Chairman Nandan Nilekani has described AI adoption as root-and-branch surgery. **FE**

• FOREIGN WORKERS CAN'T REPLENISH JAPAN'S WORKFORCE

Despite a record number of foreign workers, Japan's labour force may fall by more than 10% to 61 million by 2040, according to Oxford Economics, whose economists think a decline is "inevitable even in the most optimistic scenario".



- The size of Japan's labour force has been increasing since 2013 — even though its working-age population has been on the decline — thanks to higher labour participation among the Japanese and a rapid increase in foreign workers.
- In 2025, the number of foreign workers in Japan increased by 300,000 to 2.6 million, crossing the 2.5-million mark for the first time.
- However, the rise in foreign workers has led to several problems: poor working conditions, illegal employment, visa overstays, and human rights concerns are increasing, while Japanese citizens are becoming less welcoming.
- Senior citizens will be key to boosting the domestic labour force, with those aged 65+ making up 30% of the population. But older workers typically work fewer hours, which limits the increase in labour input.

SOURCE: OXFORD ECONOMICS

RBI levies Rs 63 lakh penalty on BoB

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has imposed a penalty of Rs 63.60 lakh on Bank of Baroda (BoB) for non-compliance with provisions of directions issued by the RBI on charging interest rates under the Fair Practices Code for Lenders and Know Your Customer (KYC) guidelines.

In a statement, the RBI said it found that the charges against the bank were substantiated, warranting the imposition of a monetary penalty, as the bank had charged interest in certain loan accounts at rates higher than those contractually agreed upon and had failed to upload the KYC records of certain customers to the Central KYC Records Registry (CKYCR) within the prescribed timeline, it said on Friday.

The statutory Inspection for Supervisory Evaluation (ISE 2025) of the bank was conducted by RBI with reference to its financial position as on March 31, 2025, it said, adding a notice was issued to the bank advising it to show cause. **ENS**

India's services sector growth hits 17-month low in June: PMI

New Delhi: India's services sector growth fell to a 17-month low in June as challenging market conditions and reduced client interest for some services reportedly stymied total sales and output, a monthly survey said on Friday.

Several firms indicated that challenging market conditions and reduced client interest for their services dampened sales at their units, resulting in stagnant hiring activity and lower business confidence.

The seasonally adjusted HSBC India Services PMI Business Activity Index fell to 57.4 in June, from 59.8 in May, registering the weakest upturn in 17 months.

The HSBC India Services PMI Business Activity Index — based on a single question asking how the level of business activity compares with the situation the month before — was comfortably above both the neutral mark of 50.0 and its long-run average.

Behind the softer increase in services output was the slowest expansion in new order intakes in over two-and-a-half years. **PTI**

• BRIEFLY

India's forex kitty drops $5.65 bn to $666.93 bn

Mumbai: India's forex reserves dropped $5.654 billion to $666.933 billion during the week ended June 26, the RBI said on Friday.
In the previous reporting week, the kitty jumped $963 million to $672.587 billion. The kitty had expanded to an all-time high of $728.494 billion during the week ended February 27 this year before the onset of the West Asia conflict, which led to several weeks of a drop as the rupee came under pressure and the RBI had to intervene in the forex market through dollar sales. **PTI**

SK Sinha takes charge as GAIL's director (fin)

New Delhi: SK Sinha on Friday took over as director (finance) of GAIL (India) Limited. Prior to joining the Board of Directors, he has served as Executive Director (Finance & Accounts). A qualified cost and management accountant with a career spanning over three decades in oil and gas sector, Sinha possesses extensive expertise in Corporate Finance, Corporate Accounts, Management Accounting, Investor Relations, Taxation, Treasury & Banking Operations and mergers & acquisitions. Throughout his career, he has played a pivotal role in strengthening GAIL's financial systems. **ENS**

Targeting 16-17% growth in goods exports in FY27, says Goyal

New Delhi: India is targeting an ambitious 16-17% growth in merchandise exports to about $530 billion in the current fiscal year, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Friday. Speaking at the Board of Trade meeting here, Goyal said the target for the services sector is 11% growth to about $470 billion in 2026-27.
"We want to grow to $1 trillion export this year. And to reach $1 trillion, our goods export will have to increase from (USD) 442 (billion) to about (USD) 530 billion, $90 billion increase," Goyal said.

Nestle India sees strong growth opportunity in rural markets

New Delhi: FMCG major Nestle India is pinning its growth ambitions on the rural and semi urban markets, where aspirations are rising, said its Chairman & Managing Director Manish Tiwary. India remains a market of immense opportunity, where consumption growth will increasingly be driven by deeper household penetration, wider distribution and stronger engagement with consumers across geographies, said MD Tiwary. **PTI**

• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▲	US Dollar ▼
77,763.91	24,270.85	₹1,46,344	₹95.22
261.79	95.15	Silver ▲	Oil ▼
0.34%	0.39%	₹2,33,858	$67.16

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JULY 2, 2026

• THE US REMOVED CURBS ON ANTHROPIC'S AI MODELS ON TUESDAY

OpenAI pitched US govt stake model for all AI firms

Reuters
Washington, July 3

OPENAI HAS discussed giving the US government a 5% stake, the *Financial Times* has reported, as AI firms face scrutiny in Washington over the likely misuse of advanced models and whether Americans would benefit from the industry's massive valuations. The ChatGPT creator has proposed that other US AI firms also give Washington similar stakes, although it is unclear whether they would agree, the report said, citing two people familiar with the talks.

The move follows growing public backlash in the US over AI's potential to cause economic upheaval, including layoffs, and could help OpenAI sweeten ties with an administration that is increasingly taking an active role in regulating the technology.

A Trump administration request prompted OpenAI to delay the wide release of its latest AI model, GPT-5.6, last week, days after rival Anthropic suspended access to its most advanced models, including Fable 5, due to a government order to keep the technology out of the hands of foreign nationals.

The US removed curbs on Anthropic's AI models on Tuesday. *Reuters* could not immediately verify the FT report. Alphabet's Google declined to comment. OpenAI, Anthropic, xAI parent SpaceX and the White House did not immediately respond to requests for comment. Half of Americans fear that the rise of AI could put them or someone in their household out of work, according to a Reuters/Ipsos poll published in June. Managing regulatory uncertainty is critical for OpenAI and Anthropic ahead of their planned initial public offerings. Last month, President Donald Trump said he was exploring options to give the public a stake in leading AI companies, in response to concerns that individual Americans will not share in the sector's expected profits. Left-leaning US Senator Bernie Sanders has also advocated for the government taking a 50% stake in big AI companies, arguing the technology is built on human knowledge used without permission and compensation. Forrester analyst Indranil Bandyopadhyay said a pre-IPO government stake could ease investor risk concerns about regulation in the US but may trigger similar demands from other countries.

"Expect other jurisdictions to demand analogous arrangements as a condition of market access and expect enterprise buyers in Europe and Asia-Pacific to reassess data sovereignty and neutrality assumptions about US model providers." The structure OpenAI executives have suggested would see leading US AI firms allot 5% of their equity to a vehicle modeled on the Alaska Permanent Fund, a state-owned corporation seeded with oil revenue that pays annual dividends to residents.

• TECH STAKE

DONALD TRUMP has said he was exploring options to give the public a stake in leading AI companies amid concerns that Americans will not get share in sector's profits

FORRESTER ANALYST Indranil Bandyopadhyay said a pre-IPO government stake could ease investor risk concerns about regulation in the US but may trigger similar demands from other countries

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Akshay Soni, S/o Anand Kumar Soni R/o Khasra No.22/23, Gali No.2, Near MCD School, Jharoda, Delhi and Permanent Address Ward No.10, Talbehat Range, District Lalitpur, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.662/2024 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act 2009, P.S. Wazirabad, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Akshay Soni** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Akshay Soni** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Akshay Soni** of **FIR No.662/2024 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act 2009, P.S. Wazirabad, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.08.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Aakash Mohan Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-12, (Central)
Room No. 264, 2nd Floor
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9090/N/2026

Annexure-i

कार्यालय कार्यपालन अभियन्ता,

ग्रामीण यांत्रिकी सेवा संभाग दन्तेवाड़ा जिला दक्षिण बस्तर दन्तेवाड़ा (छ०ग०)

// ऑनलाईन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना प्रथम बार (कमांक-02) //

क्रमांक /680/ निविदा/ग्रा.यां. सेवा/2025-26 दन्तेवाड़ा दिनांक-30/06/2025

1. एकीकृत पंजीयन प्रणाली अंतर्गत सक्षम श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारो से निम्नलिखित निर्माण कार्य हेतु ऑनलाईन (Online) ई-निविदा दिनांक 20/07/2026 तक आमंत्रित की जाती है :-

कार्य का विवरण	अनुमानित लागत (रू.लाख में)	कार्यालय में निविदा की मैनुअल दस्तावेज जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि
1	2	3
प्रशिक्षण एवं कौशल विकास केन्द्र का निर्माण कार्य दन्तेवाड़ा (बोर खनन पम्प, वाटर हार्वेसटिंग, सेनेटरी फिटिंग एवं विद्युतीकरण सहित)	165.50 लाख	दिनांक 23/07/2026 शाम 5.00 बजे तक

2. उपरोक्त निर्माण कार्य की निविदा की सामान्य शर्ते, धरोहर राशि, विस्तृत निविदा विज्ञप्ति, निविदा दस्तावेज व अन्य जानकारी विभागीय वेब साईट http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in में दिनांक 06/07/2026 से 20/07/2026 तक देखी/डाऊनलोड की जा सकती है।

हस्ता./-
कार्यपालन अभियन्ता
ग्रामीण यांत्रिकी सेवा संभाग दन्तेवाड़ा
जिला दक्षिण बस्तर दन्तेवाड़ा (छ०ग०)

RO No. 262701827-7

BIHAR STATE MILK CO-OPERATIVE FEDERATION LTD.

Dairy Development Complex; Post :- B.V. College, Patna-800014
Phone No- 2224083, 2228953, 2228347, 2220387, Fax No-0612-2228306
Website :- www.sudha.coop Email:- marketingcomfed@gmail.com

NIT No.: Comfed: Mktg.:3464 Date: 03.07.2026

TENDER NOTICE

TENDER NOTICE FOR GRANTING THE LICENSE FOR OPERATING SUDHA CAFÉ & RESTAURANT (Pure Veg)

Online e-Tenders are invited from reputed Proprietorship/Partnership Firms/Companies/Agencies for granting the license for operating the newly built G+1 Sudha Café & Restaurant for a period of 5 (five) years, extendable for a further period of 2 (two) years, at Dairy Development Complex, opposite B.V. College, Patna, Bihar – 800014, constructed by Bihar State Milk Co-operative Federation Ltd. (COMFED). The premises comprise a newly constructed G+1 building having a total built-up area of approximately 4,910 sq. ft. The Café & Restaurant shall serve only vegetarian food items.

The minimum reserve license fee shall be Rs. 3,00,000/- (Rupees Three Lakhs only) per month, plus applicable GST.

Interested parties can participate in the bidding process as per following time schedules/date:

Particulars	Scheduled Date & Time
Tender document availability	04.07.2026 onwards on **www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in**
Tender Bid queries through E-mail by Bidder	04.07.2026 to 08.07.2026
Pre-Bid Meeting at COMFED Hqr	09.07.2026 at 12:00 PM @ Bihar State Milk Co-operative Federation Ltd., Dairy Development Complex, P.O.- B.V. College, Patna- 800014
Final Tender Document upload by COMFED with amendments if any	10.07.2026
Last Tender submission date & time for bidder	On or before 17.07.2026
Technical Bid opening date	18.07.2026 at 1:00 PM
Financial Bid opening date	Will be communicated later to technically qualified bidders

The detailed terms, conditions and operational requirements containing in the tender bid document are available on **www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in.**
The undersigned reserves the right to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. For all legal matters & disputes, Patna court will be our jurisdiction.

CHAIRMAN-CUM-MANAGING DIRECTOR

BENGALURU SOUTH CITY CORPORATION

Office of the Deputy Chief Engineer,
2nd Floor, 9th Main Road, Jayanagara South
2nd block, Bengaluru -560 011

No: DCE/BSCC/TEND/02/2026-27 Date: 03-07-2026

SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION

(TWO TENDER DOCUMENT SYSTEM)
(Through GOK KPP Portal only)
Website: https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in

The Deputy Chief Engineer, Bengaluru South City Corporation, Bengaluru invites tenders from eligible contractors registered in Greater Bengaluru Authority (BBMP) or equivalent registration with CPWD / KPWD/ Railways / MES or any State Government Organizations for the works in the table below.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1)	Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Bengaluru South Assembly Constituency for one year. Approximate value of work (Rs. in Lakh): **560.00.** EMD: **Rs.8,40,000/-.**
2)	Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Jayanagara Assembly Constituency for one year. Approximate value of work (Rs. in Lakh): **161.00.** EMD: **Rs.2,50,000/-.**
3)	Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Padmanabhanagara Sub Division Assembly Constituency for one year. Approximate value of work (Rs. in Lakh): **45.00.** EMD: **Rs.90,000/-.**
4)	Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Banashankari Sub Division Assembly Constituency for one year. Approximate value of work (Rs. in Lakh): **30.00.** EMD: **Rs.60,000/-.**
5)	Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in BTM Layout Assembly Constituency for one year. Approximate value of work (Rs. in Lakh): **230.00.** EMD: **Rs.3,50,000/-.**
6)	Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Bommanahalli Assembly Constituency for one year (package-1). Approximate value of work (Rs. in Lakh): **200.00.** EMD: **Rs.3,00,000/-.**
7)	Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Bommanahalli Assembly Constituency for one year (package-2). Approximate value of work (Rs. in Lakh): **190.00.** EMD: **Rs.2,90,000/-.**
8)	Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Kasavanahalli ward of Mahadevapura Assembly Constituency for one year. Approximate value of work (Rs. in Lakh): **35.00.** EMD: **Rs.70,000/-.**

Calender of Events: 1) Availability of Tender Document in KPPP portal: **06.07.2026. 2)** Pre bid meeting will be held on **09.07.2026 at 3:00 p.m.** in the **office of The Chief Engineer, Jayanagar Zone (Zone-1), Bengaluru South City Corporation, 9th Main, 9th Cross, Jayanagar 2nd Block, Bengaluru-560011. 3)** Last Date & Time for receipt of Tenders : **14.07.2026 at 4:00 p.m. 4)** Opening of Technical bid: **16.07.2026 at 4:30 p.m. 5)** Opening of Financial bid (if possible) After the approval of Technical Evaluation.

Sd/- Deputy Chief Engineer, BSCC.

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE (Through e-tendering)

Name of work with its location : Reinstallation of dismantled VSS i.e. CCTV & Wifi Infrastructure at Amrit Bharat stations over Delhi Division in view of upgradations of stations

App. Cost of the work : Rs. 89,95,910.76/- only.

Earnest Money Deposit : Rs. 1,79,900.00/- only.

Address of the office : Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3rd Floor, Annexe-1, DRM office, New Delhi-110055.

Date & Time for upload the tender / closing of tender : Tender uploading / closing date & time- 27.07.2026 up to 15.00 hrs.

Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc. : See the Northern Railway website **www.ireps.gov.in** & Notice board at S&T branch, 3rd Floor, DRM office, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055.

No.: 558-Sig-16-Tele-OT-1041 Dated: 03.07.2026 **2281/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

KARNATAKA POWER CORPORATION LIMITED

(A Government of Karnataka Enterprises)

No.KPCL/2026-27/SE0368 Date: 01.07.2026

TENDER NOTICE

(Through KPP Portal only) (Two Cover System)

Bid is invited from KPP Portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** for the work of "Appointment of Cost Auditors/Firm of Cost Accountants for carrying out Cost Audit of KPCL from Financial year 2026-27. (For one year, extendable by another two years viz 2027-28 to 2028-29)". **Last Date for receipt of the completed bids is 16:00 hrs on 18.07.2026.**

Further details can be had from: **General Manager (Finance),** KPCL, No.82, Shakti Bhavan, Race Course Road, Bengaluru-560 001. **e-mail: karnatakapower@gamil.com , website: www.kpcl.karnataka.gov.in, Mobile: +91 8046010000, +91 8068948777.**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Kamal S/o** Jai Prakash **R/o** 223 D, Raj Nagar, Loni Dehat, near Canal, Ghaziabad, U.P. have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 245/2018 U/s 323/342/365/34 IPC.**, has been registered at **PS: Farsh Bazar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Kamal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Kamal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Kamal** of under has been under **FIR No. 245/2018 U/s 323/342/365/34 IPC.**, registered at **PS: Farsh Bazar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.08.2026.**

By Order
Akhil Malik
JMFC, Room No. 38
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/9017/SHD/2026
(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Manpreet Singh @ Billi S/o Sh. Rahgubir Singh R/o A-21-C, Tilak Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 224/2018 U/S 24/54/59 Arms Act, PS Tilak Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Manpreet Singh @ Billi** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Manpreet Singh @ Billi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Manpreet Singh @ Billi** of **FIR No. 224/2018 U/S 24/54/59 Arms act, PS Tilak Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **04.08.2026.**

By Order,
Sh. Vikas Madaan
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07(West)
Room No. 289
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/8930/WD/2026(Court Matter)

GOVERNMENT POLYTECHNIC UMRI, KURUKSHETRA

MEMO NO. 2005 (रिक्त सीटों हेतु प्रवेश सूचना) date: 02/07/2026

व्यक्तिगत रूप से आवेदन फॉर्म जमा कराने की अंतिम तिथि

07.07.2026 शाम 05:00 बजे तक

राजकीय बहुतकनीकी, उमरी में तीन साल के डिप्लोमा इंजी. एवं डिप्लोमा इंजी. (लेटरल एंट्री) कोर्स की बची हुई रिक्त सीटों पर प्रवेश हेतु संस्था स्तर पर सीट आवंटन की प्रक्रिया संस्था स्तर की मैनुअल ओपन काउंसलिंग द्वारा नीचे दिए गए कार्यक्रम के अनुसार आयोजित की जाएगी। इसमें अभ्यर्थी को व्यक्तिगत रूप से प्रस्तुत होना होगा।

S.No.	Date & Time	Event
01	08.07.2026, 5:00 PM	Declaration of fresh Inter-se-Merit/Rank at https://gpumri.ac.in
02	09.07.2026, 10:00 AM	Institute Level Manual Counseling for all categories (1st Round)
03	10.07.2026, 10:00 AM	Institute Level Manual Counseling without any reservation (by merging all reserved categories (2nd Round)

- वे अभ्यर्थी जिनको दिनांक 09.07.2026 की ओपन काउन्सलिंग में भाग लेने के बाद भी पसंद की सीट नहीं मिली, वो सारे अभ्यर्थी दोबारा दिनांक 10.07.2026 को सुबह 10 बजे भी, 2nd राउंड की ओपन काउन्सलिंग में भाग ले सकते हैं।
- दिनांक 10.07.2026 2nd Round के बाद सारी बची हुई खाली सीटों को 14 जुलाई से 14 अगस्त 2026 (या प्रवेश की अंतिम तिथि, जो भी बाद में हों) तक प्रतिदिन आधार पर दोपहर 12 बजे तक प्राप्त आवेदनों की मेरिट अनुसार भर जाएगा।

- **उमरी गाँव के निवासियों के लिए डिप्लोमा इंजी. (3 वर्षीय) की हर ब्रांच मे 2-2 सीटें (कुल 16 सीटें) आरक्षित हैं। उनके लिए भी आवेदन की अंतिम तिथि 07.07.2026 शाम 05:00 बजे तक रहेगी। इसके लिए अभ्यर्थी के पास उमरी गाँव का मूल निवास प्रमाण पत्र होना आवश्यक है।**
- EWS/TFW/KM/HGST/PMCARE/HARIHAR/UMRI वर्ग की सीटें संबंधित वर्ग के अभ्यर्थियो से ही भरी जाएंगी।
- दाखिला लेने के लिए पात्रता जानने के लिए डिप्लोमा प्रॉस्पेक्टस 2026-27, जो की ल्ररळएर पंचकूला की वेबसाइट www.hstes.org.in पर उपलब्ध है, को ध्यान से पढ़ें।
- उपरोक्त काउन्सलिंग के लिए आवेदन फार्म व eligibility criteria इस संस्था की वेबसाइट https://gpumri.ac.in से डाउनलोड किया जा सकता है। आवेदन फार्म का प्रिंट एक ही पेज पर आगे-पीछे (Back to Back) लेना जरुरी है।
- भरे हुए आवेदन फॉर्म के साथ दसवीं की मार्कशीट, वांछित योग्यता की अंक तालिका/प्रमाण पत्र (for lateral entry) आधार कार्ड, परिवार पहचान पत्र, category प्रमाण पत्र, चरित्र प्रमाण पत्र, दो पासपोर्ट आकार की रंगीन फोटो अवश्य संलग्न करें।
- सेमेस्टर फीस लड़कों के लिए 4600/- तथा लड़कियों/TFW के लिए 3100/- UPI/Online mode से सीट मिलते ही तुरंत जमा करवानी होगी।
- अधिक जानकारी के लिए हमारे टेलीफोन न. 01744-278875, 7988601448 पर किसी भी कार्यालय दिवस पर 9 से 5 बजे तक संपर्क करें।

हस्ता/-
प्रधानाचार्य

No. 46822/HRY

Rajasthan Water Grid Corporation Limited

(Formerly known as "Eastern Rajasthan Canal Project Corporation Limited")
Sinchai Bhawan, JLN Marg, Jaipur 302017, Tel: 0141-2700669 Email: ceercpc@gmail.com

No. :- 3487 Date :- 25/06/2026

Short Term NIB No – RWGCL/09/2026-27

Managing Director, RWGCL invites bid for " Procurement of Oracle Data Base, Oracle PRIMAVERA P6 Licenses, Technical Support (TS) of new PRIMAVERA Licenses, maintenance & Support services for software and PRIMAVERA software Training " from interested bidders upto07.07.2026 (06.00 PM). Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal **(https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in/sppp/** of the state. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs 124.00 Lacs.

NIB Code: ERP2627A0017, UBN No: ERP2627SLOB00017

Managing Director
RWGCL, Jaipur

Raj.Samwad/C/26/6167

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Gufran, S/o: Mohd. Jafar, R/o: L-314, G No-24, Janta Colony, Welcome, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 288/2013, U/s: 392/411/34 IPC, P.S. Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Gufran** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Gufran** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Gufran** of **P.S. Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.08.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
JMFC-03, Shahdara Distt., Room No. 19, 1st Floor, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/9039/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2) (ii) Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused persons namely **1.Veeru Shaikh S/o** Ruhab Shaikh **2.Talim S/o** Rahul Shaikh **R/o** Free Colony Jhuggi, Daulatpur, Delhi (adrees same for boths) have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 105/2020 U/s 380/411/34 IPC.**, has been registered at **PS: K.N.K Marg, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **1.Veeru Shaikh 2.Talim** namely cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **1.Veeru Shaikh 2.Talim** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **1.Veeru Shaikh 2.Talim** of under **FIR No. 105/2020 U/s 380/411/34 IPC.**, Registred at: **PS: K.N.K Marg, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.08.2026.**

By Order
Aakash Sharma
JMFC-03, Room No. 213
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9032/RD/2026
(Court Notice)

कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता
नलकूप निर्माण खण्ड, आगरा

पता-लॉयर्स कॉलोनी के सामने, खंदारी क्रासिंग, आगरा 282002 (उ0 प्र0)
दूरभाष-0562-2522057, **ईमेल**:- eetwcdidupag-up@gov.in
पत्रांकः 486/न०नि०ख०आ०/निविदा/2026-27/ **दिनांकः**-25-06-2026

ई-टेंडरिंग के माध्यम से कराये जाने वाले कार्यों की निविदा निविदा सूचना सं0- 02/अधि.अभि.-2026-27

महामहिम राज्यपाल, उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से निम्नलिखित कार्यों हेतु ऑनलाइन http://etender.up.nic.in के माध्यम से निविदा, सिंचाई विभाग में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से दिनांकः-13-07-2026 को अपरान्ह 12.00 बजे तक आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं, जो अधिशासी अभियन्ता, नलकूप निर्माण खण्ड, आगरा कार्यालय में दिनांकः 13-07-2026 को अपरान्ह 01.00 बजे गठित समिति के समक्ष ऑनलाईन खोली जायेंगीं। निविदा दिनॉक 06-07-2026 को दोपहर 12.00 बजे से दिनॉक-13-07-2026 को दोपहर 12.00 बजे तक डाउनलोड/अपलोड की जा सकती है। कार्यालय बन्द होने अथवा छुट्टी होने की दशा में यह बिड अगले कार्यालय दिवस में उसी समय खोली जायेंगीं।

धरोहर धनराशि एन०एस०सी०/एफ०डी०आर० अथवा नियमानुसार अनुमन्य अन्य प्रतिभूति के रूप में जो की **अधिशासी अभियन्ता नलकूप निर्माण खण्ड, आगरा** के पक्ष में बंधक होगी, जमा करना अनिवार्य होगा अन्यथा निविदा स्वीकार नहीं की जाएगी। एक या समस्त निविदाओं को विना कारण बताये निरस्त करने का पूर्ण अधिकार अधोहस्ताक्षरी को होगा। कार्यों का विवरण निम्नलिखित हैः-

क्र० सं०	लाट सं0	कार्य का विवरण	मात्रा (मी० में)	कार्य की अनुमानित लागत (लाख रुपये में)	जमानत धनराशि (रुपये में)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य + जी.एस.टी (रुपये में)	पंजीकृत श्रेणी
01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09
01	01	1750 असफल राजकीय नलकूपों की पुनः निर्माण परियोजना के अंतर्गत जनपद आगरा के विकास खण्ड-जैतपुर में 08 अदद राजकीय नलकूपो के छिद्रण का कार्य।	1440	29.52	59100.00	30 दिवस	354.00 जी०एस०टी० सहित	"ए" श्रेणी वार्षिक एवं 03 वर्ष का अनुभव
02	02	1750 असफल राजकीय नलकूपों की पुनः निर्माण परियोजना के अंतर्गत जनपद फिरोजाबाद में 01 अदद राजकीय नलकूपो के छिद्रण का कार्य।	170	03.05	6200.00	30 दिवस	177.00 जी०एस०टी० सहित	"ए" श्रेणी वार्षिक एवं 03 वर्ष का अनुभव
03	03	1750 असफल राजकीय नलकूपों की पुनः निर्माण परियोजना के अंतर्गत जनपद मैनपुरी में 10 अदद राजकीय नलकूपो के छिद्रण का कार्य।	1300	20.60	41200.00	30 दिवस	354.00 जी०एस०टी० सहित	"ए" श्रेणी वार्षिक एवं 03 वर्ष का अनुभव
04	04	1750 असफल राजकीय नलकूपों की पुनः निर्माण परियोजना के अंतर्गत जनपद अलीगढ में 19 अदद राजकीय नलकूपो के छिद्रण का कार्य।	2090	33.11	66300.00	30 दिवस	354.00 जी०एस०टी० सहित	"ए" श्रेणी वार्षिक एवं 03 वर्ष का अनुभव
05	05	1750 असफल राजकीय नलकूपों की पुनः निर्माण परियोजना के अंतर्गत जनपद एटा में 02 अदद राजकीय नलकूपो के छिद्रण का कार्य।	270	4.28	8600.00	30 दिवस	177.00 जी०एस०टी० सहित	"ए" श्रेणी वार्षिक एवं 03 वर्ष का अनुभव
06	06	1750 असफल राजकीय नलकूपों की पुनः निर्माण परियोजना के अंतर्गत जनपद कासगंज में 15 अदद राजकीय नलकूपो के छिद्रण का कार्य।	2025	32.08	64200.00	30 दिवस	354.00 जी०एस०टी० सहित	"ए" श्रेणी वार्षिक एवं 03 वर्ष का अनुभव

नोट-
1. जीएसटी नियमानुसार अलग से देय होगा।
2. Lowering Assembly Plus 07 Mtr. Margin के अनुसार वास्तविक ड्रिलिंग का भुगतान प्रति मीटर दर के अनुसार किया जायेगा।
3. यह निविदा/बिड सूचना व शर्ते आदि http://etender.up.nic.in एवं सिंचाई विभाग की वेबसाइट http://idup.gov.in पर उपलब्ध हैं।
4. निविदादाता बिड डॉक्यूमेंट में उल्लिखित शर्ते, निविदा की सामान्य शर्ते, तकनीकी शर्ते व विशिष्टियां, बिल ऑफ क्वांटिटी, अन्य शर्ते इत्यादि का समुचित संज्ञान लेने के उपरांत ही निविदा डालेंगे।

(अशोक कुमार सिंह)
अधिशासी अभियन्ता
नलकूप निर्माण खण्ड, आगरा

UPID-253219 Dt. 02/07/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER PWD ZONE KOTA

No.802 Dated 22.6.2026

NIT No. 10/2026-27
Notice Inviting Bid
NIB No. PWD2627A1316

Bids for PWD Zone Kota are invited Road Work from interested bidders upto 6.00 pm, 15.07.2026 other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.raj.nic.in) of the Rajasthan and http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 504.78 lacs. (1 Work)
UBN No. PWD2627WLOB05628

Sd/-
Addl. Chief Engineer
PWD Zone Kota

DIPR/C/11315/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Yogesh Sharma S/o** Sh. Dev Dutt **R/o** H. No. 114, Gram Sabha, Village Pooth Kalan Delhi. has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 15/2003 U/s 279/338 IPC PS: Kanjhawala Delhi.** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Yogesh Sharma** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Yogesh Sharma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Yogesh Sharma** accused of **FIR No. 15/2003 U/s 279/338 IPC PS: Kanjhawala Delhi.** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.08.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Apoorv Bhardwaj
JMFC-02, Room No. 113
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/8966/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pankaj, S/o Arvind R/o House No. A-40, Gali No.9, Sushant Vihar, Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in case **E-FIR No.032531/2024 u/s 305(B)/3/7(Q) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pankaj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pankaj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Pankaj** of **E-FIR No.032531/2024 u/s 305(B)/3/7(Q) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.08.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, North
Court No. 6, Ground Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/8970/ON/2026

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

e-tender Notice No. 25 of 2026-27 (Open)-Engg/DDU. On line (through e-tendering) for the following work is invited by DRM/Engg/DDU for and on behalf of the President of India from experienced and financially as well as technically sound contractors including those enlisted with the Railway, CPWD, BSNL, MES, PWD and other public sector undertakings.

Tender No. 14-DDU-SR DEN- I -26-27, Name of work with its location : Provision of divyangjan amenities like ramp, waterbooth, seating arrangement, tactile pathway etc at stations in GC section under SR DEN/I/DDU. Advertised Value:₹3,78,78,195.58 Earnest Money : ₹7,57,600/-

Tender No. 15-DDU-SR DEN- I -26-27, Name of work with its location : Development of road at PIRO and GQN station under ADEN/XBKJ. Advertised Value:₹1,89,10,375.18, Earnest Money : ₹3,78,200/-, Closing Date & time for submission of e-tender : 23.07.2026, Up-to 12:00 hrs. Website particulars of e-tendering:www.ireps.gov.in

Divisional Railway Manager/
ECR/Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya

PR/0489/DDU/Engg/T/26-27/36

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

E-TENDERING NOTICE

On Line Bid based open E-Tenders are invited by Sr. D.M.E./C&W/Co./North Eastern Railway/Lucknow for and on behalf of the President of India for the following works.

S.No.-1, Tender Notice No.: 27-2026-CW, Description of works: "Supply & Application of Retroreflective Stickers on different type of Destination Boards & Indiacation Boars (As per the Drawing Nos. G/SD3-1423, G/SD3-1424, G/SD3-1425 and G/SD3-1426) installed on the coaches of LJN Division in a period of 01 Year. Approx. Value (in Rs.): ₹ 46,86,237.84, E.M.D. Money (in Rs.): ₹ 93,700/-, Contract period: 01 Year.

- E-Tender can be uploaded by tenderer, up to 15:00 hrs. on 24-07-2026 and will be opened after 15:00 hrs. on 24-07-2026.
- Detailed information, minimum eligibility criteria, Terms and conditions regarding this e-tender are available at website ***www.ireps.gov.in*** • Tenderer should check any correction/corrigendum related to this e-tender notice on website before uploading their offer.

Sr. Divl. Mech. Engineer/C&W/Co., Lucknow
CPRO/Yantrik-48

Never travel on roof and foot boards.

"IMPORTANT"

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Government of India, Department of Space
ISRO Propulsion Complex (IPRC)
Mahendragiri P.O., Tirunelveli District, Tamil Nadu– 627 133, India

E-TENDER NOTICE Dated : 03-07-2026

On Behalf of the President of India, item-rate tenders are invited through **e-tendering** for the following work:

Sl. No.	NAME OF THE WORK	Estimated Cost ₹ (in Lakhs)	Period of completion	EMD(₹)
1	NIT no:IPRC/CMG/TD/e-22/MW/CMP-05/2026-27			
	External services including Roads and Electrical works for Antenna structure at Spacecraft Control Centre (SCC), Palayamkottai, Tirunelveli (Phase-II)-SBC-3. (Electrical & Civil works)	503.46	04 (Four months)	10,07,000

Dates for Online Request : From 04-07-2026 [10.00 hours] To: 17-07-2026 [23.30 hours]

Due Time & Date of Submission : 28-07-2026 [14.00 hours] For further details visit : www.isro.gov.in/tenders (or) www.tenderwizard.com/ISRO.

Note : All future correspondence (Corrigenda) for the above work(s) shall be published only on the websites mentioned above.

GROUP HEAD, CMG, IPRC.

आमेर विकास एवं प्रबन्धन प्राधिकरण

पुरानी विधानसभा भवन, हवामहल के पास, जयपुर, टेलीफोन नम्बर - 0141-2600032
ई-मेल आई.डी. :- adma.jaipur@gmail.com

क्रमांक :- ADMA/ACEO/2026/784 दिनांक :- 30/06/2026

ई-बिड़ संख्या - 04/2026-27

राजकीय संग्रहालय व महल आमेर, नाहरगढ़ दुर्ग, जन्तर–मंतर एवं ईसरलाट, राजकीय संग्रहालय हवामहल, राजकीय केन्द्रीय संग्रहालय अल्बर्ट हॉल, सिसोदिया रानी का बाग, विद्याधर का बाग, विरासत संग्रहालय, राजस्थान धरोहर संग्रहालय (सवाई मानसिंह टाउनहॉल, पुरानी विधानसभा) एवं प्राधिकरण कार्यालय के सम्पूर्ण परिसर क्षेत्र में जॉब बेसिस पर सफाई व्यवस्था से सम्बन्धित कार्य हेतु इच्छुक बिडदाताओं से दिनांक 01.07.2026 से दिनांक 20.07.2026 तक खुली ई–निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है, जिसका विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाईट **http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in** पर देखा व पढ़ा जा सकता है। बिड की कुल अनुमानित लागत राशि रू. 281.00 लाख है | **NIB Code : ADA2627A0005**

बिड यू.बी.एन. नम्बर :– **ADA2627SLOB00011, ADA2627SLOB00012**

राज.संवाद/सी/26/6157 अतिरिक्त मुख्य कार्यकारी अधिकारी

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-Auction Notice

The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/ G, Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi invites e-Auction through IREPS (https://ireps.gov.in/) for allotment of contracts of Water Vending Machines (WVMs) at following railway stations/locations:-

Auction Catalogue No.	Date & Time for e-Auction	Cluster No.	No. of WVMs at Railway Stations
CTG-WVM-03-2026	16.07.2026 at 11:00 hrs	D	Total 07 WVMs (03 WVMs at Panipat, 02 WVMs at Samalkha and 02 WVMs Bhodwal Majri Railway Station).
		F	Total 06 WVMs (03 WVMs at Kurukshetra, 02 WVMs at Karnal and 01 WVM at Shahbad Markanda Railway Station).
		E	Total 06 WVMs (02 WVMs at Badli, 02 WVMs at Ganaur and 02 WVMs at Sonipat Railway Station).
Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen.			https://ireps.gov.in/ (E-Auction-Leasing)

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

- Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module - Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module.
- Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Updation of Turnover Details.
- A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism.
- The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions.
- Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender /E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query	Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi 110055, Email: catering.delhidivision@gmail.com, Tel: 011-23743084.

No. 23 AC/Ctg./e-Auction/WVM/2026 Date: 02-07-2026 2278/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Govt. of Bihar

Public Health Engineering Department
Public Health Engineering Division, Teghra

SHORT TERM NIT No –02/O&M-PHED/TEGHRA/2026-27(Re-Tender-1)

National Competitive Bidding

(Through e-procurement mode on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

1	Designation and Address of Advertiser	Executive Engineer, P. H. Division, TEGHRA
2	Date of issue of Tender Notice	02.07.2026
3	Period of sale (downloading) of tender Bid Document	10.07.2026 to 18.07.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4	Date, time & place of pre-bid meeting	13.07.26 at 11.30 hrs. hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer of concerned P. H. Division ,Teghra
5	Last date and time of receipt (uploading) of tender	18.07.26 up to 17:00Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
6	Date and time of opening of technical bid	18.07.26 at 17:30Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
7	Date and time of opening of financial bid	To be informed later after the approval of technical bid.

Group No	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (in Lakh)	Amount of Earnest Money (in Lakh)	Cost of Tender Document (non-refundable) in Rs.	BSEDC Bid Processing Fee (in Rs.)	Completion Period (in months)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Comprehensive operation and maintenance and Special repair of (i) Rural Piped Water Supply Scheme (**PWS-12 Nos.**) (ii) Single Village Piped Water supply scheme (**SVS-10 Nos**) (iii) Ward level Piped Water Supply Schemes (**WLS Quality- 576 Nos.**) (iv) Ward level Piped Water Supply Schemes (**WLS _Non Quality- 110 Nos.**) based on item rates; constructed by the Public Health Engineering Department including payment to the pump operators, electricity bill for five years.	**8371.723**	**93.72**	**10,000.00**	**Applicable as per e-proc2**	**60 months**

For further details please visit website **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

PR- 007008 (P H E D) 2026-27

Executive Engineer
Public Health Division, Teghra

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

Govt. of Bihar

Urban Development and Housing Department
Office Of Municipal Executive Officer Nagar Panchayat Hasanpura (District- Siwan)

LOCAL / NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING
STANDARD BIDDING DOCUMENT PROCUREMENT
(CIVIL WORKS)
TENDER NOTIFICATION (e-tender) – 02/2026-27

Tenders are invited through Electronic Tendering System only for the works detailed below:

BID NO	NAME OF WORK	ESTIMATED COST	AMOUNT OF EARNEST MONEY (RS IN LAKH) ONLINE OR OFFLINE MODE	COST OF BOQ IN RS (NON REFUNDABLE) TO BE PAID ONLINE.	BID PROCESSING FEE IN RS (NON REFUNDABLE PAYMENT ONLY THROUGH ONLINE MODE)	TIME OF COMPLETION (IN MONTHS)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1.	Construction work of Administrative Building for Nagar Panchayat Hasanpura District-Siwan	**2,67,13,964/-**	**5,35,000/-**	10,000.00	AS PER E-PROC2	18 MONTHS (INCLUDING NON-WORKING PERIOD) FOR CONSTRUCTION WORK

2. OFFICER INVITING BIDS : Municipal Executive Officer, Nagar Panchayat Hasanpura
3. DATE OF ISSUE OF NOTICE INVITING BID : - 30-06-2026
4. BID SUBMISSION START DATE : - FROM 23-07-2026 (11.00 AM) Through website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in only
5. TIME, DATE AND PLACE OF PRE-BID MEETING : - DATE 24-07-2026 11:00 AM to 11:45 PM) Nagar Panchayat Hasanpura Office, Siwan
6. LAST DATE AND TIME FOR UPLOAD OF BIDS : - DATE 30-07-2026 TIME (3.00 PM)
7. PHYSICAL DOCUMENT SUBMISSION END DATE AS ALLOWED IN THE TENDER DOCUMENT (EMD, EXISTING COMMITMENT, AFFIDEVIT etc.) : - DATE 30-07-2026 TIME TILL (04.00 PM)
8. TIME AND DATE OF OPENING TECHNICAL BIDS : - DATE 31-07-2026 TIME (11.00 AM)
9. TIME AND DATE OF OPENING FINANCIAL BIDS : - TO BE ANNOUNCE LATER
10. PLACE OF OPENING OF BIDS :-Through website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in only
11. BID VALIDITY PERIOD : - 120 Days

For further details please visit website **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

PR- 007011(B & C) 2026-27

(Mukesh Kumar Raj)
Municipal Executive Officer
Nagar Panchayat Hasanpura (Siwan)

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
R.W.S&S DIVISION, SAMBALPUR.

25001/635/2627

E-mail :- eerwsssbp@gmail.com

"e"-PROCUREMENT NOTICE
Bid Identification No. RWSS (SBP):- 02 / 2026-27

1.	**Name of the Work**	:	**Execution of RPWS Scheme to left out village 1) Badakundeswar, 2) Sareipali & Balarama, 3) Budhikuntuni and 4) Kundankhol under Jamankira block of Sambalpur District.**
2.	**Total No. of works**	:	04 Nos (Four)
3.	**Estimated Cost**	:	Rs. 96.31 Lakhs to Rs.131.19 Lakhs
4.	**Class of contractor**	:	**B & A**
5.	**Other details**	:	Six months

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender Online for Bidding	
		From	To
Superintending Engineer RWSS Division Sambalpur	RWSS (SBP) : - 02/2026-27	06.07.2026	up to 5.00 PM of 15.07.2026

Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal "www.tendersorissa.gov.in" Subsequent corrigendum if required shall be appeared in the website only.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer,
R.W.S&S. Division, Sambalpur

OIPR- 25001/25015/1/26-27/0002

समाहरणालय, दरभंगा

(मद्यनिषेध एवं उत्पाद विभाग)
अल्पकालीन आम नीलामी सूचना
(बिहार मद्य–निषेध और उत्पाद अधिनियम–2016 (यथा संशोधित अधिनियम–2018/2022) के अन्तर्गत जप्त एवं अधिहरित वाहनों के वाहन स्वामियों के लिए अल्पकालीन सूचना)

एतद् द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि बिहार मद्यनिषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम के अधीन दरभंगा जिला के अन्तर्गत विभिन्न थाना काण्डों में जप्त वाहनों को समाहर्त्ता–सह–जिला दण्डाधिकारी, दरभंगा / प्राधिकृत न्यायालय द्वारा राज्यसात किया गया है। जिसमें निम्नलिखित वाहनों के स्वामी को सूचित किया जाता है की आपके वाहन की नीलामी, नीलामी कमिटी द्वारा **डा0 भीमराव अम्बेदकर सभागार, समाहरणालय परिसर, लहेरियासराय, दरभंगा / कार्यालय सहायक आयुक्त मद्यनिषेध, दरभंगा** में दिनांक **21.07.2026** को **10:30 बजे** पूर्वा0 से की जाऐगी। आप अपना पक्ष रखने हेतु दिनांक **18.07.2026** तक जिला विधि प्रशाखा, दरभंगा / कार्यालय सहायक आयुक्त मद्यनिषेध, दरभंगा में उपस्थित होकर वाहन विमुक्ति हेतु आवेदन समर्पित कर सकते है। यदि आप निर्धारित तिथि तक उपस्थित नहीं होते हैं, तो यह माना जाएगा की आप वाहन छुड़ाने के इच्छुक नहीं हैं और आपके वाहन को उल्लिखित तिथि को नीलाम कर दिया जाएगा। वाहनों की सूची निम्नवत है :–

उत्तर प्रदेश राज्य

क्र0	अधिहरण वाद संख्या	विभाग / थाना का नाम एवं कांड संख्या	वाहन का प्रकार	वाहन का निबंधन संख्या / चेसिस संख्या / इंजन संख्या	निर्माण वर्ष	निर्धारित मूल्य	अवघटन राशि	वाहन स्वामी का नाम एवं पता
01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09
1	137/23	EXCISE PS 93/23	TRUCK TATA MOTORS	UP14FT-9389 MAT448037H5A01355 61M84358256	2017	350000	70000	KANPUR DELHI GOODS CARRIERS LTD, C/O- FIRM, ADD- H NO-A106 PATEL NAGAR II, GHAZIBAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201001
2	143/25	MORO 34/24	TRUCK M & M	UP84T-9797 MA1PFALBCG6A48440 8EGZA10432	2016	40000	8000	RAJESH SINGH, C/O- RAMNATH SINGH, ADD-156 SARAY CHAK, GOVINDPUR, MAINPURI, UTTAR PRADESH

PR- 006943 (Excise) 2026-27

समाहर्त्ता दरभंगा

विस्तृत सूचना **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

समाहरणालय, दरभंगा

(मद्यनिषेध एवं उत्पाद विभाग)
अल्पकालीन आम नीलामी सूचना
(बिहार मद्य–निषेध और उत्पाद अधिनियम–2016 (यथा संशोधित अधिनियम–2018/2022) के अन्तर्गत जप्त एवं अधिहरित वाहनों के वाहन स्वामियों के लिए अल्पकालीन सूचना)

एतद् द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि बिहार मद्यनिषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम के अधीन दरभंगा जिला के अन्तर्गत विभिन्न थाना काण्डों में जप्त वाहनों को समाहर्त्ता–सह–जिला दण्डाधिकारी, दरभंगा / प्राधिकृत न्यायालय द्वारा राज्यसात किया गया है। जिसमें निम्नलिखित वाहनों के स्वामी को सूचित किया जाता है की आपके वाहन की नीलामी, नीलामी कमिटी द्वारा **डा0 भीमराव अम्बेदकर सभागार, समाहरणालय परिसर, लहेरियासराय, दरभंगा / कार्यालय सहायक आयुक्त मद्यनिषेध, दरभंगा** में दिनांक **21.07.2026** को **10:30 बजे** पूर्वा0 से की जाऐगी। आप अपना पक्ष रखने हेतु दिनांक **18.07.2026** तक जिला विधि प्रशाखा, दरभंगा / कार्यालय सहायक आयुक्त मद्यनिषेध, दरभंगा में उपस्थित होकर वाहन विमुक्ति हेतु आवेदन समर्पित कर सकते है। यदि आप निर्धारित तिथि तक उपस्थित नहीं होते हैं, तो यह माना जाएगा की आप वाहन छुड़ाने के इच्छुक नहीं हैं और आपके वाहन को उल्लिखित तिथि को नीलाम कर दिया जाएगा। वाहनों की सूची निम्नवत है :–

दिल्ली राज्य

क्र0	अधिहरण वाद संख्या	विभाग / थाना का नाम एवं कांड संख्या	वाहन का प्रकार	वाहन का निबंधन संख्या / चेसिस संख्या / इंजन संख्या	निर्माण वर्ष	निर्धारित मूल्य	अवघटन राशि	वाहन स्वामी का नाम एवं पता
01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09
1	166/ 23	BISHA NPUR 14/23	CAR (TATA NEXON) TATA MOTORS	DL9CAS-5482 MAT627268 KLK41139 REVTRN03K PYK82695	2019	150000	30000	BHUPINDER SINGH, S/O RAJ SINGH, ADDRESS-WZ-268B, GALI NO-5 PREM NAGAR, UTTAM NAGAR, WEST DELHI-110059
2	266/ 2025	EXCISE PS SADAR 212/2025	CAR BREZZA LXI	DL14CJ-9271 MA3RYHK1 SRH475031 K15CN7528563	2024	499000	99800	SARITA RANI, W/O-RAJEEV KUMAR, ADD-C683, 3RD FLOOR GALI, BACK SIDE SHAKARPUR GANE, EAST DELHI-110092
3	321/ 2025	EXCISE PS SADAR 273/2025	PASSION PRO MOTORCY CLE	DL8SBL-1793 MBLHA10A6EG A09169 HA10ENEGA143 86	02/14	14000	2800	RAJESH KUMAR, S/O-VINOD, AT-KH-1273, GALI NO-15, SWAROOP NAGAR, DEHLI 11042
4	308/ 2025	EXCISE PS SADAR 249/2025	CAR HONDA CITY ZXG	DL3CBA-0535 MAKGD852FN3 72981 L15A30120194	2007	30000	15000	VIKRAM OVERSEAS LTD, C/O-FIRM, ADD- E44/3, OKHLA INDL, AREA PHASE-II, NEW DELHI

समाहर्त्ता, दरभंगा

विस्तृत जानकारी **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

PR. No.006939 (Excise) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

BIHAR STATE TOURISM DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LTD

A Govt of Bihar Undertaking

Govt. of Bihar

NATIONAL COMPETITIVE E-BIDDING INVITATION
VERY SHORT-RE-TENDER NO. 25/E-TENDER/ BSTDC/2026-27

File No. 84/Engg/2026/931/engg/26

(Through e-procurement mode only – www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

1. Bihar State Tourism Development Corporation Limited (BSTDCL), a nodal agency for executing tourism infrastructure projects in the state of Bihar, India, intends to execute tourism infrastructure projects at its tourism potential locations.
2. Any Contractor registered with Central Government/any State Government or any PSU or an agency of International or National repute may participate in the tender but registration with any works department, Bihar will be essential after issue of L.O.A. and before executing the agreement.

Gr. No	Name of work	Estimated Cost (In Lac)	Bid Processing fees (Beltron)	Bid Document Cost	Bid Security (EMD) (in Lac)	Contract Duration
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1.	MAINTENANCE OF SOLAR STREET LIGHT INSTALLED AT VARIOUS LOCATION IN KANWARIYA ROUTE STARTING FROM AJGAIVINATH TEMPLE TO DUMMA BORDER.	Rs-24.81	Rs- 590.00	Rs-5,000.00	Rs-0.48	10 Days

3. Date of Inviting tender : Date- 01.07.2026
4. Date of downloading of bid document : From 06.07.2026 to 08.07.2026 up to 3:00PM. Through website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in only
5. Place & Date of Pre-bid meeting : Date 07.07.2026 Time 03:00PM. (Office of Chief Engineer B.S.T.D.C. Patna)
6. Last date and time for receipt on eproc2 : Date 08.07.2026 up to 3:00PM
7. Last date and time for Submission of Original instrument of EMD & Affidavit : Date 09.07.2026 up to 3:00PM
8. Time and date of opening of technical bids : Date 09.07.2026 Time 3:30PM Through website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
9. Time and date of opening of financial bids : To be communicated latter on
10. Place of opening of bid : Through website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
11. Period of bids validity : 120 days
12. Officer inviting bids : Executive Engineer (South), BSTDC Ltd.

For participating in E – tendering process, the contractor shall have to get themselves registered to get user ID, Password and Digital signature. This will enable them to access the website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in and download/participate in E– tender. All tender queries related to this tender shall be communicated at contactbstdc@gmail.com

For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

Executive Engineer (South)
BSTDC Ltd, Patna

PR- 006963 (B & C) 2026-27

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,Ankita Dixit W/o Madhur Dixit R/o B-15, Sector-71, Noida-201304, have changed my name from Ankita Dixit to Ankita Kala. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Ankita Kala for all future purposes. 0040863971-3

I,hitherto known as ABHAWYA CHITKARA,W/O-PARAS SIKKA,R/O-1010, POCKET-A/SEC-A,VASANT-KUNJ,VASANT-KUNJ,S.O,DIST:SOUTH-WEST-DELHI, DELHI-110070,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME AND SHALL HEREAFTER BE KNOWN AS ABHAWYA SIKKA. 0040864029-8

I,DEEPESH KUMAR MITTAL S/o KARAM CHAND MITTAL R/o-D-15/175-176, 2ND FLOOR,SECTOR-3,ROHINI,DELHI-110085 have Changed my name to DEEPESH MITTAL. 0040864014-3

I,SHASHI KALA W/O-NARESH CHANDOLIYA R/O-C-121/B, NEAR TAAR FACTORY, VISHWAS PARK,UTTAM NAGAR,NEW DELHI-59, inform that SHASHI KALA and SHASHI CHANDOLIA, both are one and the same person. 0040863924-3

I,Naresh Gola,S/o Sh.Om Prakash Gola,R/o H.No-1111,Sector-15 Part-II,Gurugram,Haryana 122001,have changed my name from Naresh Kumar Gola to Naresh Gola,for all,future purposes. 0040864029-1

I, Ansika Gupta W/o Vipul Gupta, R/o G-501, Rashmi Appartments, Pitampura, Harsh Vihar, Delhi-110034. have changed my name to Anshika Gupta for all future purposes. 0040863973-1

I, hitherto known as Arhaan bhat S/o Shishir Jana R/o Plot No. 4, Harijan Colony,Sector-43, Distt. Gurugram Haryana, have changed my name and shall hereafter beknown as Samiya Jana. I have changed my name not my religion. 0071045669-1

I Rajesh Kumar S/o Parsuram R/o H. No. 103, Block-C, Prem Nagar, Nagafgarh SouthWest Delhi-110043, I have changed the name of my minor son Shailander to Salendar aged 17 years. 0071045562-1

I,Noor Ahmad S/o.Mohammad Maqsood R/o.2235,Gali Dakotan Turkman Gate Delhi-110006,have changed my name to NOOR AHMED permanently. 0040864029-10

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

GORKHA RIFLES

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart No 9422897 Late Rfn Arun Kumar Rai of 1/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during OP VIJAY (Kargil) on 04 Jul 1999.

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart No 9414616 Late Hav Jhanak Bhadur Rai of 1/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during OP VIJAY (Kargil) on 04 Jul 1999.

Colonel 11 GR & Sikkim Scouts and All Ranks

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

NAIK KRISHAN KUMAR NAIR 113 BN BSF 15.12.1960 – 04.07.1994

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Naik Krishan Kumar Nair on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in area of Sarkoot, Kishtwar (J&K) and succumbed to his injury during evacuation to Govt. Medical College Jammu.

SUB INSPECTOR AJIT SINGH 116 BN BSF 07.10.1947 – 04.07.1999

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Sub Inspector Ajit Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in Counterpart firing in area of Army FDL Surender, Rajouri (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

Veer Balidani Constable Udheshwar Das 118 Bn 30-07-1949 To 04-07-1994

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Udheshwar Das of 118 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being seriously injured in an encounter with militants in Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir on 4 July 1994. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable Gurnam Singh 38 Bn 30-09-1973 To 04-07-1999

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Gurnam Singh of 38 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating militants during an area domination patrol in Doda district, Jammu & Kashmir on 4 July 1999. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable G. Venkataiah 113 Bn 05-02-1966 To 04-07-2002

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable G. Venkataiah of 113 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice on 4 July 2002 after sustaining grievous injuries while bravely protecting his fellow troopers during a rifle grenade attack by militants in Kupwara, Jammu & Kashmir on 24 June 2002. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Shri Hira Kumar Jha Second-in-Command.7 Bn 15-08-1969 To 04-07-2014

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Second In Command (2IC) Shri Hira Kumar Jha of 7 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Jamui district, Bihar on 4 July 2014. For his unparalleled valour, courage, and devotion to duty, he was posthumously awarded the Shaurya Chakra. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable Dibakar Das 138 Bn 01-03-1982 To 04-07-2016

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Dibakar Das of 138 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice on 4 July 2016 after sustaining grievous injuries while performing law and order duties in Daporijo, Arunachal Pradesh on 3 July 2016. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE(ITBP)

Assistant Commandant Pawan Chaudhary

ITBP salutes its braveheart Assistant Commandant Pawan Chaudhary of 20th Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty on this day in Leh in 2000.

बिहार सरकार

कार्यपालक अभियंता, पी0आई0यू0–01, पटना नगर निगम का कार्यालय
मौर्यालोक कॉम्पलेक्स ब्लॉक–सी0 मौर्याटावर , पटना।

NIT NO-01/EMP/PIU/2026-27

SHORT TENDER

Patna municipal Corporation Area invites online bids through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.infor following works from the bidders fulfilling eligibility criteria.

S.No	Name Of work	Cost Of Tender (Non- Refundable) Paid Through www. eproc2.bihar.gov.in)	EMD (Paid Through www. eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
01	EMPANELMENT OF AGENCIES FOR CIVIL WORK UNDER ESSENTIAL SERVICES AND FACILITIES FOR CITIZEN SAFETY IN EMERGENT SITUATIONS under, Patna Municipal Corporation Area.	2,500.00	25,000.00

In case of Bank Guarantee, EMD Shall Be Payable in Favor of " Executive Engineer, PIU-Division Patna Municipal Corporation-Patna" payable at Patna.

Key Dates:

Start Of Online bid : From 12.07.2026(10:00 Hrs.) www. eproc2.bihar.gov.in
Pre-Bid Meeting : 12.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs. (As per RFP)
Last date Of Online Bid Submission : 22.07.2026 Till 16:00 Hrs.
Technical Bid Opening Date : 22.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs.

The Preferred Company/ agencies would be empanelled through a single-stage one -part competitive bidding process based on evaluation of technical proposal. The Bidders are expected to submit their proposal in accordance with the instruction provided in the RFP. Detailed Request for Proposal (RFP) incorporating instruction for submission of bid and other relevant information's is available on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in.

Amendment/corrigendum to NIT, if any would be published on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in only.

For further details please visit website **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

PR- 006889 (B & C) 2026-27

Executive Engineer
(P.I.U)
Patna Municipal Corporation

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

समाहरणालय, दरभंगा

(मद्यनिषेध एवं उत्पाद विभाग)
अल्पकालीन आम नीलामी सूचना
(बिहार मद्य–निषेध और उत्पाद अधिनियम–2016
(यथा संशोधित अधिनियम–2018/2022) के अन्तर्गत जप्त एवं अधिहरित वाहनों के वाहन स्वामियों के लिए अल्पकालीन सूचना)

एतद् द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि बिहार मद्यनिषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम के अधीन दरभंगा जिला के अन्तर्गत विभिन्न थाना काण्डों में जप्त वाहनों को समाहर्त्ता–सह–जिला दण्डाधिकारी, दरभंगा / प्राधिकृत न्यायालय द्वारा राज्यसात किया गया है। जिसमें निम्नलिखित वाहनों के स्वामी को सूचित किया जाता है की आपके वाहन की नीलामी, नीलामी कमिटी द्वारा **डा0 भीमराव अम्बेदकर सभागार, समाहरणालय परिसर, लहेरियासराय, दरभंगा / कार्यालय सहायक आयुक्त मद्यनिषेध, दरभंगा** में दिनांक **21.07.2026** को **10:30 बजे** पूर्वा0 से की जाऐगी। आप अपना पक्ष रखने हेतु दिनांक **18.07.2026** तक जिला विधि प्रशाखा, दरभंगा / कार्यालय सहायक आयुक्त मद्यनिषेध, दरभंगा में उपस्थित होकर वाहन विमुक्ति हेतु आवेदन समर्पित कर सकते है। यदि आप निर्धारित तिथि तक उपस्थित नहीं होते हैं, तो यह माना जाएगा की आप वाहन छुड़ाने के इच्छुक नहीं हैं और आपके वाहन को उल्लिखित तिथि को नीलाम कर दिया जाएगा। वाहनों की सूची निम्नवत है :–

हरियाणा राज्य

क्र0	अधिहरण वाद संख्या	विभाग / थाना का नाम एवं कांड संख्या	वाहन का प्रकार	वाहन का निबंधन संख्या / चेसिस संख्या / इंजन संख्या	निर्माण वर्ष	निर्धारित मूल्य	अवघटन राशि	वाहन स्वामी का नाम एवं पता
01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09
1	25/2024	बहादुरपुर 315/22	APACHE MOTOR CYCLE	HR26DU-1725 MD634BE41J2G26652 BE4GJ2126042	2018	26000	5200	RAVI SHANKAR KUMAR, S/O-SOCHIT RAY, ADDRESS - PLOT NO-278, 1ST FLOOR, ROOM NO-18 NEAR SHIV MANDIR, SCHOOL SARHAUL SEC-18, GURGAON, HARYANA-122015
2	324/2025	मद्यनिषेध थाना (सदर) 328/2025	10 WHEELER CONTAINER	HR56B-5600 MAT448203GAJ09955 61J84335994	11/16	750000	150000	MOHIT, S/O -BALRAJ SINGH, AT-NASIRPUR, CHOLKA, KHANDA, SONIPAT, HARYANA 131402

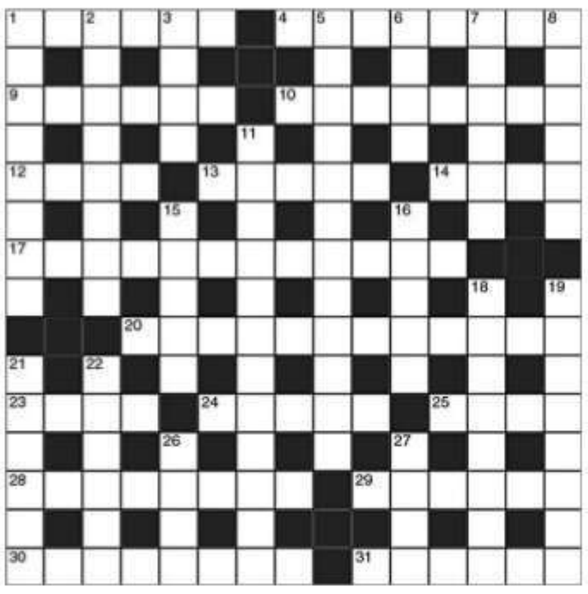
PR- 006979 (Excise) 2026-27

समाहर्त्ता, दरभंगा

उक्त सूचना **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

• CROSSWORD 6032



ACROSS

1 Village tragedy (6)
4 A body-builder showing a heavenly body (8)
9 Treated with care (6)
10 Someone not suited for running (8)
12 I come back to a matter of trivial importance (4)
13 Credit is tied up we're told (5)
14 He has to live with a goddess (4)
17 You'll be lucky to win one (4,2,6)
20 His pupils are encouraged to make notes (5,7)
23 Abraham Lincoln to start with was murdered (4)
24 Silver down but looks healthy (5)
25 Study occupied by a college head (4)
28 No-one doubts what this signal means (3,5)
29 In direct opposition before guillotine's used? (4-2)
30 Pass on the takings (8)
31 A game bird for example all of a flutter (6)

DOWN

1 Draperies rejected by most modern societies (8)
2 Note when the army order is given (4,4)
3 It's flat and square (4)
5 A challenging demand (12)
6 Some seed enables one to make a garden (4)
7 Name of the girl who shot to fame from Yale, OK? (6)
8 Strode round an English county (6)
11 As set by one out to break a record? (8,4)
15 Extra payment on getting into public transport (5)
16 Applause as powder magazine finally goes up (5)
18 Strung up (8)
19 I leave the law to the big guns (8)
21 Empty one container into another (6)
22 It's a strange leader who won't lead (6)
26 Singer improved a lot (4)
27 Truly a king for only 12 months (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6031 ACROSS: 1 Ambit, 4 Careful, 8 Tea, 9 Absentees, 10 Essence, 11 Waste, 13 Stamps, 15 Dynamo, 18 Banjo, 19 Bad debt, 21 Suffocate, 23 Obi, 24 Engaged, 25 Lotus **DOWN:** 1 Actress, 2 Boatswain, 3 Train, 4 Cashew, 5 Runaway, 6 Fee, 7 Lisle, 12 Scapegoat, 14 Prolong, 16 Outfits, 17 Aboard, 18 Baste, 20 Dwell, 22 Fig

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

A good __ and a good ____ are always a formidable combination. - Nelson Mandela (4,..,5)

MNAEE

AESWDT

EOTAR

HEIGHT

SOLUTIONS: Enema, Orate, Wasted, Eighth
ANSWER: A good **head** and a good **heart** are always a formidable combination. - Nelson Mandela

• OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

• CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON

• MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG

SUDOKU 6369

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 4s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

		5			7	4		
		9	6		3		1	
7								8
						8	2	9
5								1
1	8	7						
3								4
	4		7		1	3		
		8	5			1		

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6368

4	6	2	5	8	9	7	1	3
8	3	1	2	7	4	9	6	5
9	5	7	1	6	3	2	8	4
5	7	9	3	4	8	1	2	6
1	2	4	7	5	6	3	9	8
6	8	3	9	1	2	4	5	7
3	1	5	8	2	7	6	4	9
2	9	6	4	3	5	8	7	1
7	4	8	6	9	1	5	3	2

• ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Think before you speak or act today because something going on behind the scenes might affect your daily routine. Sudden changes, new information and different plans are likely. Be careful, as this is a mildly accident-prone day. Tonight: Privacy matters.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): A dispute with a friend about money, the cost of something or perhaps a possession that you own might arise today. This issue also might take place with a group. Keep your eyes open to avoid losses. Tonight: Warm friendships.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Relations with bosses, parents, VIPs and the police are subject to sudden burst of rebellion or something surprising today. Be careful when dealing with authority figures. Tonight: You're noticed.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Once again, travel plans are subject to changes, cancellations or new directions. If you have to make decisions today about legal, medical matters, travel or higher education, do your homework. Tonight: Explore and learn.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Unexpected issues might impact your financial assets and shared property today. This could affect your relationship with a group or a friend. You might let someone down. Late deliveries or broken items might be an issue.Tonight: Check your finances.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): This is a poor day for important discussions with authority figures, as well as spouses or close friends. People don't agree with each other. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Work-related travel plans might go awry today or be delayed. Efforts to deal with foreign countries, deliveries to schools, legal or medical matters or keeping schedules on track are thwarted today by unexpected obstacles. Do your best. Tonight: Get busy.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Be patient with your kids today. Romantic partners have to be patient with each other as well, especially if disputes about shared property or the cost of something arises.Be aware and patient to prevent potential accidents. Tonight: Enjoy socialising.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Patience is your best friend today because interactions with partners, spouses and close friends are completely unpredictable. If you keep cool, you are best equipped to deal with whatever happens. Tonight: Relax at home.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Work-related issues as well as your daily routine are up for grabs today. Therefore, be aware. Pay attention to everything you say and do. Nothing will unfold as expected. Be mindful and vigilant. Tonight: A clarifying conversation.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Money issues, especially related to your kids, or social outings or vacations, might blow up in your face today. It could also be a disagreement about the cost of something. Tonight: Check your possessions and assets.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Today is unpredictable, perhaps even explosive. It's also accident-prone. Keep your wits about you. Patience will be your best friend. Take it easy. Tonight: You win.

S. E. RAILWAY – E-TENDER

Tender Notice No.: PCMM/GENL/TP/2026/26, dated 02.07.2026. Open e-Tenders for "E" Procurement system are invited by Principal Chief Materials Manager, S.E.Railway, Headquarters Office (5th Floor), New Administrative Building, 11, Garden Reach Road, Kolkata-700043 for and on behalf of the President of India, which have been uploaded on website **www.ireps.gov.in** as follows. All the tenders will be closed at 14.00 hrs.

Sl.No.	Tender No.	Closing Date	Brief Description	Qty.	EMD (in ₹)
1	60260006A	22.07.2026	HVN-66 INSULATING LINER FOR USE WITH PSC SLEEPER etc.	600000 Nos.	6,35,760/-
2	38263898	15.07.2026	Slack adjuster Type IRSA - 600 complete.	1850 Nos.	3,28,280/-
3	38263894	07.08.2026	Key bolt with nut, spring washer and 4mm dia Split pin	880000 Nos.	5,39,620/-
4	38263932	05.08.2026	New Doorway Stiffining Cross Bar for BOXNHL Wagon	20500 Nos.	13,54,650/-
5	38261545	10.08.2026	Modified key for Brake shoe etc.	149600 Nos.	1,49,190/-
6	38263883	17.08.2026	7/8" (22.22 mm) Dia Zinc Plated/Galvanized Lock Bolt etc.	57750 Nos.	1,16,910/-
7	38261554	10.08.2026	Inner Spring for bolster of CASNUB 22HS Bogie.	14430 Nos.	3,17,010/-
8	77260012	25.07.2026	Set of items for anti corrosive Epoxy Paint etc.	2275 Set	1,55,710/-
9	77261745	28.07.2026	Alkyd modified synthetic Enamel UV resistant.	57950 ltrs.	1,14,060/-
10	77261751	30.07.2026	Paint Aluminium for General purpose etc.	42158 ltrs.	1,09,240/-
11	77263024	06.08.2026	Gentian Blue (RAL 5010) Paint etc.	96980 ltrs.	1,82,890/-
12	77263042	04.08.2026	Paint, Black, Enamel, Synthetic Exterior etc.	93880 ltrs.	1,19,640/-
13	33261534	29.07.2026	BOGIE FRAME ASSEMBLY etc.	24 Nos.	1,40,680/-
14	33263044	24.08.2026	Secondary Spring Generator Car etc.	250 Nos.	3,07,930/-
15	33263049	31.07.2026	Secondary Lateral Damper etc.	1170 Nos.	1,29,920/-
16	31265013	24.07.2026	Traction Motor with pinion etc.	05 Nos.	3,58,950/-
17	85261839A	10.08.2026	SET OF TAPER ROLLER BEARING.	210 Set	1,81,270/-
18	81260019	27.07.2026	R-407 Refrigerant Gas.	8782 Kgs.	1,50,680/-
19	60260021	23.07.2026	FISHPLATES FOR 60 KG. UIC RAIL (1 METER LONG) etc.	34000 Nos.	15,85,550/-
20	81261879	20.07.2026	Red Dye Penetrant Kit.	23830 Set	3,04,810/-
21	IF265113B	17.07.2026	Supply and Installation of One Set CT 16 Slice Scanning System (Computed Tomography) etc.	01 Set	3,90,000/-
22	46263094B	11.08.2026	MOTOR PROTECTION CIRCUIT BREAKER RATING 1.6-2.5 AMPS etc.	3172 Nos.	1,14,090/-
23	47255020A	18.08.2026	Supply, erection, testing & commissioning of Automatic supply Change Over color light signaling panel etc.	74 Nos.	1,97,480/-
24	33263124	31.08.2026	FOOT STEP COMPLETE etc.	3300 Nos.	3,16,040/-
25	33263081	27.08.2026	Pad for secondary Suspension FIAT etc.	2100 Nos.	4,20,770/-
26	43263016	03.08.2026	Voltage phase control (MMR-Measuring & Monitoring Relay) etc.	2422 Nos.	2,92,640/-
27	90263113	22.07.2026	Slip free finish Stainless Steel Sheet etc.	62544 Kgs.	2,98,160/-
28	90263067A	03.08.2026	MS Wire (for general Engg. Purpose) etc.	81815 Kgs.	1,25,380/-
29	5626RGC_RELAY_QNN1	27.07.2026	Running Contract/Price Agreement for supply of Relay QNN1 etc.	3500 Nos.	4,43,100/-
30	5626RGC_RELAY_QN1	03.08.2026	Running Contract/Price Agreement for supply of Relay QN1 etc.	14000 Nos.	15,54,510/-
31	60260002	10.08.2026	Manufacture and Supply of Metal Liner for use with ERC MK-III flat toe on concrete sleeper etc.	800000 Nos.	3,46,400/-

Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/description/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. **N.B. :** Prospective Bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all other tenders & any corrigendum published thereafter. **(PR-412)**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **Rajendra Kumar, S/o:** Hemchand **R/o:** H.No. C-138, Gali No. 06, Bhajanpura, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 413/2020, U/s: 138 NI Act, PS: Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Rajendra Kumar,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Rajendra Kumar,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Rajendra Kumar,** of **FIR No. 413/2020, U/s: 138 NI Act, PS: Bhajanpura, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.08.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Kirandeep Kaur
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/8877/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sonu, S/o Birju, R/o Jhuggi No. 24, Sanjay Basti, Timarpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 395/2023, U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Burari, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sonu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sonu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sonu** accused of **FIR No. 395/2023, U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Burari, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.08.2026.**

By Order - Ms. Payal Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-09
Central District, Room No. 286
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9048/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Chandan S/o** Banke Lal, **R/o** N-14/167, Munshi Ram Dairy, Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 539/2021, U/S 380/411/34 IPC, PS Mukherjee Nagar, North-West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Chandan** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Chandan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);
Proclamation is hereby made that **Chandan** the said accused of **FIR No. 539/2021, U/S 380/411/34 IPC, PS Mukherjee Nagar, North-West Distt., Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.08.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Amardeep Kaur
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate,
North, Court No.-117, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9061/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

E-AUCTION PROGRAMME FOR THE MONTH OF JULY, 2026

E-Auction programme for sale of Railway Scrap materials under jurisdiction of Lumding Division for the month of **July, 2026** is hereby fixed as under:

SN	MONTH	DATE FIXED
1	JULY, 2026	10-07-2026, 17-07-2026 and 28-07-2026

Interested bidders may participate in E-auction through IREPS website **www.ireps.gov.in**.

Sr. Divisional Material Manager, Lumding
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers with a smile

The Andhra Pradesh Mineral Development Corporation Limited

Door No. 294/1D, 100 feet Road (Tadigadapa to Enikepadu Road), Kanuru, Vijayawada-521137, Andhra Pradesh, India
Tel: +91-866-2429999 Fax: +91-866-2429977 Email: contracts-ho@apmdc.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tender No: APMDC/HO/P&C/Excavation and removal of overburden and Barytes (ROM) ore -M'Pet/2026-27

Date: 04.07.2026

APMDC invites E-tender from reputed Agencies for **"Selection Of Contractor For Excavation And Removal Of Overburden And Barytes (ROM) Ore At Mangampet Barytes Project, Mangampeta (V), Obulavaripalli (M), Tirupati District, Andhra Pradesh"**. For more information on the eligibility criteria, tender fees, timelines and other details, please visit e-procurement website of GoAP www.tender.apeprocurement.gov.in) or APMDC website (**www.apmdc.ap.gov.in**). The Tender document is available for downloading from **04.07.2026** and the last date for bid submission is **24.07.2026** by 17:00 Hrs.

Sd/-
Managing Director
The A. P. Mineral Development Corporation Limited

Place: Vijayawada
Date: 04.07.2026
R.O. No. No: 5224PP/CL/ADVT/1/1/2021-22 Dt.: 03/04/2026

U.P. RAJYA VIDYUT UTPADAN NIGAM LIMITED
OBRA - SONEBHADRA
E-Tender Notice

1. **Bid No. GEM/2026/B/7699506,** Routine maintenance of CCTV enabled surveillance security system BTPS, Tender Cost: Rs. 0.00, EMD-Rs. 13,000.00, Amount:- Rs. 6,34,249.00, Last Date of Uploading Bid : 13.07.2026
2. **Bid No. GEM/2026/B/7683213,** Third Party Audit of ongoing work of Fire Detection & Protection System BTPS Obra, Tender Cost: Rs. 0.00, EMD-Rs. 30,000.00, Amount:- Rs. 15,00,000.00, Last Date of Uploading Bid : 16.07.2026

For information regarding Addendum/Corrigendum/Rejection of Bids kindly regularly visit website **https://etender.up.nic.in.**

पत्रांक: 81 / ज0स0का0 / निविदा दिनांक: 03 / 07 / 2026
"राष्ट्रहित में बिजली बचायें"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Kalicharan S/o** Brij Nandan **R/o** H.No. 708 C/o Satbir MLA Wali Gali, Bawana, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 123/14, U/s: 279/304A IPC, PS: Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Kalicharan,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Kalicharan,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Kalicharan,** of **FIR No. 123/14, U/s: 279/304A IPC, PS: Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.08.2026.**

By Order
Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, (North)
Court Room No. 114, 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/8997/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Open Tender No.- JHS-RCNK-M-EVB-26-27-03R

E-Tender Notice

E-Tenders are invited from experienced and interested contractors by **Chief Workshop Manager, Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana** on behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work-

Name of work: Attention of POH schedule for Propulsion systems, Traction Motors and Electrical Train Lighting (ETL) work with Consumable material of Vande Bharat Chair Car Trainsets in RCNK, Jhansi as per scope of work.

Cost of work: ₹ 84,89,354.57/- (Including 18% GST)

Bid Security: ₹ 1,69,800.00 | **Time of completion:** Twelve Months

Online Tender Closing Date and Time: 22.07.2026 at 11.00 hrs.

Details information about tender and tender format is available at website **www.ireps.gov.in.**

1504/26 FA

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pankaj Singh, S/o Jitender Singh, R/o 5/230, Dayal Park, Sagarpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 006/2019, U/s 392/34 IPC, P.S. Paschim Vihar West, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Pankaj Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Pankaj Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Pankaj Singh** accused of **FIR No. 006/2019, U/s 392/34 IPC, P.S. Paschim Vihar West, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.08.2026.**

By Order - Sh. Ankit Karan Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-08, West
Room No. 30, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9078/OD/2026

ANNAMALAI UNIVERSITY

(Accredited with 'A+' Grade by NAAC)

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

E-tenders are invited from reputed and eligible firms through the Tamil Nadu e-Procurement Portal (https://tntenders.gov.in) for providing catering services in 06 Catering Messes serving students residing in 08 University Hostels during the academic year 2026 - 2027.

Tender Reference	CO/AC/14/E-Tender-99/2026 - 2027
Date	03.07.2026
Scope of Work	Providing catering services in 06 Catering Messes serving students residing in 08 University Hostels during the academic year 2026 - 2027
Last Date and Time for Receipt of Tender	18.07.2026, 05.00 PM
Venue	Syndicate Hall, Annamalai University

The detailed tender document, eligibility criteria, and terms and conditions are available on the websites: www.annamalaiuniversity.ac.in and https://tntenders.gov.in.

Registrar i/c.
Annamalai University

DIPR/ 2197 /TENDER/2026